TOTAL GUIDE TO iPHONE HD MOVIEMAKING



iPad USER & iPhone

In touch, switched on & connected

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Our guide to using the greatest iPad apps

REMOTE CONTROLLER
Access your PC from your iPad

GRAPHIC NOVEL READER
How the iPad reinvents comics

CREATE ART WITH BRUSHES
iPad finger painting made easy

iPAD POWER TWEETING
How to get more from Twitter

PLUS! the lowdown on loads more apps



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116 PRODUCTS REVIEWED!

CLOCK DOCKS TESTED



APPLE'S NEW iPODS: OUR COMPLETE GUIDE

- Superfast high-resolution iPod touch
- Touchscreen, tiny iPod nano
- All new models reviewed & rated



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Shiny Shiny

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"The Scosche IDR655m headphones impressed across the board, with good range and clarity, and impressive detail and shape; a refreshingly lively sound." - *MacFormat*

techradar.com Deep into technology

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experience the difference

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www.ipadiphoneuser.co.uk



ANDY PENFOLD

Editor

Touch type

For the last two years, I've lived a double life. Not only have I been rocking the very latest iPhone, but for reasons too tedious to go into I've also been carrying (whisper it) an iPhone 1G. With no 3G. No 'S' for 'speed'. And now no iOS 4.0.

But it's as reliable as my 1996 slippers. And it's 'always on' internet connection has got me out of many a fix. Even my first-gen iPhone's GPRS internet connection is better than nothing – if you're stuck without WiFi when you need to find the last train home, the new iPod touch can't help you.

> **"As a gaming, music, and browsing device, the iPod touch is untouchable"**

So the new touch isn't, as Steve Jobs would have you believe, an iPhone without a contract, but that description misses the point. The super-fast A4 chip, dual cameras, and crystal clear display make it the best iPod yet. It's not an iPhone, but as a gaming, music, and browsing device the iPod touch is untouchable.

iPad, iPhone, iPod touch – we've got them covered!

HD SHOOTING – PAGE 33
Your complete guide to shooting great HD video on your new iPhone 4 – brand new apps, tips and tricks!

iPAD APP EXPERT – PAGE 60
Learn how to use the best apps for iPad – we've got 14 pages of tutorials covering everything from Twitter apps to art apps

REVIEWS – PAGE 38
Our reviews section is packed with the latest speakers, headphones, cases, and apps – not to mention the new iPods



GREAT £1 GAMES – PAGE 25
The App Store is bursting with bargain games, but which ones are any good? Find out with our list of the 50 best sub-£1 games

GROUP TEST – PAGE 53
Wake up happy with a great bedside iPhone dock – we test six new models

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INBOX

Email us at inbox@ipadiphoneuser.co.uk
or visit www.ipadiphoneuser.co.uk/forums

STAR LETTER

When I first downloaded the Sleep Cycle app I thought it was the answer to my prayers – I'm a really light and restless sleeper and in the normal course of things I'm almost always knackered. By leaving my iPhone on my mattress overnight, Sleep Cycle analyses how I move throughout my, um, sleep cycle and times my alarm so that it doesn't interrupt deep sleep.



On that level, it's worked wonders. I've been finding it loads easier to wake up and have found that I'm feeling way fresher all day. But there's been an unexpected side effect – Sleep Cycle also creates a neat little graph of how you've slept over the course of the night, which proves to be the most addictive thing I've ever seen. It's become the first thing I look at each morning and I've even found myself waking up in the middle of the night to check it! Not what the makers had in mind, I'm sure.

Hayley Ellis

Dozing off Sleep Cycle app renders reader too excited to sleep properly

That compulsiveness is one of the hallmarks of a really nifty app – all we can recommend here is a little self-restraint. Sweet dreams!



Win an Orbitsound T4 worth £180!

Send us a message and you could win an Orbitsound T4 Radiopod, worth £180! The best letter we receive will bag its writer this superb DAB, FM and internet radio, which delivers a whole new approach to stereo.

So don't be shy – tell us what you think of the magazine, your iPhone, iPad or iPod, or whatever else is on your mind – it could be worth your while!

www.orbitsound.co.uk

Hard case to crack

I just bought my first iPhone and can't imagine how I ever lived without one – somehow it's crept into every corner of my life already and my girlfriend has taken to introducing herself as an iPhone widow. But, there's that ugly issue of the Case Program playing on my mind. I need to fix that antenna. I was just wondering, are the cases on the iPhone 4 Case Program special in any way? Do I have to get one of those to fix the antenna problem, or will any case work? And is it really necessary? I've not had that much trouble with signal, but I have been able to make it diminish when I squeeze it.



Case in point iPhone 4 woes solved by free case?

Steve Mathis

Yep, it's a sad fact that the iPhone 4 looks its best when it's caseless, but if you want to keep it pristine and you want to fix its dodgy antenna, you need a case. Any case that covers the edges of the phone will work, the ones on the Case Program are the only free options though. If you don't like any of them, you'll have to buy your own!

Winter wondertouch

So summer's definitely on its way out now and I'm dreading the return of those chilly mornings waiting on the train platform. One of the most annoying bits of last winter was the endless scramble to remove a glove every time I wanted to change a track on my iPod touch. Any suggestions of how to avoid this?

Anjay Ghosh

Well, there are various types of clever gloves you can buy, but we've found that using your nose works too. We've also found that using a piece of fruit or vegetable works. Honestly.

Tiny but mighty

Was I the only one who came over all funny when they unveiled the newest iPod nanos? They're like something out of *Star Trek*! Yes, it's on the pricey side and sure, it's a little short on features but I can't wait for Christmas. I guess there will be thousands of wrist straps on sale by then too.

Ed Chambers

Watch out Would you wear your iPod nano on your wrist like a watch?

Yep, we expect that come Boxing Day there'll be thousands of people tapping at their watch like Knightrider.



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AluPen™

The stylish stylus for iPad



Just Mobile AluPen™ is a chunky pencil-shaped stylus that gives you precise control over your iPad, iPhone or iPod touch.

Sculpted from aluminum, with a soft rubber nib, the AluPen™ makes drawing and writing a uniquely smooth experience. That is why it's the essential accessory for creative tableteers.



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iPod family revamped

Camera-equipped iPod touch grabs headlines

Apple has introduced its all new iPod touch with video camera, a new MultiTouch iPod nano. It's also improved the iPod shuffle and upgraded iTunes to version 10, and released an Apple TV that's built for rental and streaming.

Calling the new range the "biggest change in the iPod line-up, ever", Apple CEO Steve Jobs added that 275 million iPods have been sold so far. The iPod classic wasn't upgraded this time round, but is still available.

"The biggest change in the iPod line up ever"





Happy families The new iPods side by side – the touchscreen is gradually taking over

All the news from Apple's iPod event...

- iTunes 10 (free) gains social networking features in the new Ping system. It also gains AirPlay wireless music playback to listen to your music on remote speakers using an AirPort Express or AirPlay-compatible devices from companies including Bowers & Wilkins, JBL, Denon and iHome.
- The A4 processor-powered iPod touch boasts a hi-res 'Retina' display, FaceTime video calling and HD video recording. It runs iOS 4.1 and offers up to 40 hours music playback. Prices begin at £189 for the 8GB model. 16GB and 32GB models available.
- The iPod nano gets a small touchscreen. While it doesn't play video and lacks a camera, the aluminium and glass touch-controlled device features Genius Mixes, playlist support, a built-in FM radio and 24-hours music playback. The 8GB model costs £129, 16GB costs £159.
- The iPod shuffle has been redesigned with buttons. The 2GB, £39 aluminium gadget has a built-in clip and comes in five colours – silver, blue, green, orange and pink.
- Now £99, the Apple TV is much smaller than before. It also lacks a hard drive, meaning UK users can no longer purchase content using only the device – you need to make purchases using a computer. In the US, Apple is offering selected TV shows at lower prices than before. it streams content from Netflix (in the US), YouTube, Flickr and MobileMe.

iPod killer of the month

Could these gadgets be the death knell of the iPhone? As if!



HTC Legend
Carved from a single slice of aluminium (where have we heard that before?), the HTC Legend runs the Android OS and boasts a 3.2in touch screen. Loved in some quarters we say this lacks the video camera marvellousness of an iPhone 4.



Samsung Galaxy Tab
Tipped as prime competition for the Apple iPad with a similar processor, Samsung's 7in Android-powered tablet may host front and back cameras but with UK prices announced as starting from £617, we can't see how this product will win the tablet war.

Apple goes to Barcelona

Macworld brings Apple to world's biggest mobile event

Apple takes a place at the world's biggest mobile trade show, the Mobile World Congress, for the first time next year, thanks to the people behind *Macworld* magazine.

The event takes place in Barcelona, Spain in February 2011. Now the organisation which puts the event together is working with *Macworld* to bring a new *Macworld* Mobile section to the show. This developer-focused area will be all about apps for the iPhone, iPad and iPod touch, with a series of sessions of interest to people creating apps for iOS devices. "We're excited to bring *Macworld* Mobile to Mobile World Congress," said Mary Dolaher, chief executive officer of IDG World Expo.



Barca bound iOS app developers represented at Mobile World Congress 2011

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Apple sells 7 million iOS devices each month

iOS becomes the world's third-biggest operating system

Apple is selling nearly seven million iOS – iPhone, iPod touch or iPad – devices each and every month, the company confirmed during its September music product launch. Company CEO Steve Jobs noted that activations of new devices has reached 230,000 per day, or 1.6 million devices each week. Apple revealed that the iPod touch accounts for around one-third of the iOS devices out there, 37.7 per cent. With iPad production currently set at two million units per month, and rising iPhone 4 sales estimated at two million per month, Apple is swiftly creating a vast iOS ecosystem.



Like hotcakes Apple's selling 1.6 iOS devices (iPad, iPhone and iPod touch) every week

App of the month: Shazam

Music discovery app gets even better



Shazam 3.0 introduces massive improvements to the popular iPhone app. New features include 30-second song previews, tag charts from 20 countries, faster tagging, playable videos, much easier video and music search across iTunes and a spruced-up appearance. Shazam is free, but users can upgrade to the more powerful Encore service for a fee. The app listens to and identifies any song you play it using its extensive online database.

Facebook prangs Ping

iTunes social network rejected by Facebook

Introduced as a new feature within iTunes 10, Ping is Apple's social network for music and has a potential 160 million users, but the service isn't off to an easy start.

Ping was originally intended to be compatible with Facebook Connect, so new users could easily track down and connect to their friends. A Facebook Connect button was visible for the first few hours following launch, but was then removed because Apple and Facebook couldn't reach a deal.



Ping pong Facebook causes a stink over iTunes social features

Apple CEO Steve Jobs said talks fell apart because Facebook demanded "onerous terms that we could not agree to". While the social networking giant offers the Facebook Connect API for free, it chose to disable these calls from within iTunes because Apple hadn't reached a mutually beneficial service agreement.

Thumbs up...

The iOrchestra

The iPad's amazing, and we love the iPad Orchestra, seen here playing flute, cello, violin and clarinet parts in *Sweet Dream* on their Apple tablets using Amidio's Seline HD app.



Viva Vevo

Music video service Vevo has launched an app that lets users find and watch videos, and create video playlists from 20,000 clips.



Thumbs down...

Lose Yourself

Eminem's producers have won a landmark case against Apple and Universal which could see digital music prices increased.



90 second previews

Apple intended to offer 90-second song previews within iTunes 10, but music publishers refused to give permission for the move.



GRAPEVINE

All the latest rumour, speculation, and idle chatter

AirPlay – the new FairPlay?

AirPlay is Apple's new solution for wireless music playback on remote speakers using devices such as the Apple TV or AirPort Express. The company is also making AirPlay available to third-party manufacturers for use in their products. Firms doing so at this point include Bowers & Wilkins, JBL, Denon and iHome, Apple said. Bad news is that iTunes 10 ends support for third-party NAS and streaming devices using the FireFly standard, as used by LaCie.

Apple continues to negotiate for cloud-based music services, but labels are resisting to protect growing digital sales revenues Future iOS devices will host radio receivers to allow their use as wallets and credit cards iTunes Genius services will offer automated playlist creation using the iTunes archive in the cloud Apple's social network for music, Ping, will host user comments and recommendations in future



AirPlay Third parties are taking up Apple's technology for streaming music

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WISHLIST

Six of the best new toys: top kit for you to covet

Radio contact

EVOKE-1S

The guitar amplifier brand that gave many a rock God their signature sound is now attached to a DAB radio. This is the second outing for this Marshall-styled digital marvel. The original EVOKE-1XT has had several upgrades, with a 3in custom speaker chief among them. An iPod/MP3 player port enables you to bypass the DAB radio and listen back to your favourite tunes. Other kicking features include a 24 hour rechargeable battery pack and an LED display that amends its own brightness dependent on ambient light levels.

1 **EVOKE-1S Marshall**
Price: £119.99
URL: www.pure.com marshall



War effort

Keep Calm and Carry On Gelaskin

In these trying financial times, you sometimes need a reminder to keep a stiff upper lip. Especially if you've just blown the last of your cash on an iPad. The Keep Calm and Carry On Gelaskin for your iPhone or iPad will do just that. It'll protect your device from getting scratched, too.

2 **Keep Calm and Carry On Gelaskin**
Price: £9.37
URL: www.gelaskins.com





Hi-Fidelity

Sennheiser MM450 Bluetooth Headphones

These on-ear phones are lightweight and padded for comfort, with great fidelity. They're small and fold away easily, so toting them around on the train won't be a problem. Also offers 10 hours of battery life even with noise reduction enabled.

3 **Sennheiser MM450 Bluetooth Headphones**
Price: £260
URL: www.sennheiser.com

GO WIRE FREE



GEAR GUIDE

FM Transmitters

Wirelessly play music from your iPhone or iPod through any FM radio.

Belkin TuneBase
www.belkin.com/uk
Price: £39.99
Belkin's TuneBase range offers simultaneous playback and charging of your iPod or iPhone in the car, while sending tunes to your radio.



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4 **Altec Lansing Octiv 202**
Price: £79.99
URL: www.alteclansing.com

"The Octiv 202 is capable of **charging two devices at once**"

Double trouble
Altec Lansing Octiv 202

Altec Lansing's new Octiv 202 iPhone/iPod speaker system is capable of charging two devices at once. The triangle-shaped Octiv 202 speaker is designed to fit neatly in tight spaces and corners. As well as charging the devices, the Octiv 202 also allows users to enjoy music stored on the devices through its two 2in speakers. Altec Lansing has also released two free apps that work with the speaker. Music Mix lets users control what percentage of music is being played from the two different devices, while Alarm Rock turns your speaker into an alarm clock.



5 **JVC HA-NC120**
Price: £69.99
URL: www.jvc.co.uk

CUT OUT THE NOISE

Wired for sound
JVC Noise Cancelling Headphones

If Sennheiser's Bluetooth headphones are too pricey, these iPhone compatible wired cans might do the trick. With noise cancelling capability that rivals costlier phones, it won't be a compromise to pick up a pair of these. Again, they're on-ear rather than buds.



6 **Logitech S715i Rechargeable Speaker**
Price: £150
URL: www.logitech.com

Charged up
Logitech S715i Rechargeable Speaker

The Logitech S715i packs a lot of power in a perfectly styled and portable package. With a rechargeable battery boasting an eight-hour life, it faithfully reproduces every note with its eight speakers. Beats playing your tinny built-in speakers any day.

Griffin RoadTrip
www.griffintechnology.com
Price: £59.99
Griffin's RoadTrip has been completely redesigned, and now offers SmartScan technology to find you a free FM frequency.



Monster iCarPlay
www.monstercable.com
Price: £68
iCarPlay is a simple cable for iPhone playback in the car. There are three preset settings to get you started and it charges as it works.



Dexim Dock FM Transmitter
www.dexim.net
Price: £23.49
The Dexim Dock FM Transmitter for iPod and iPhone is known for its quiet, hiss-free tuning and ease of use.



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NEW MUSIC ON iTUNES

The latest sounds on the iTunes Store and beyond...

Royal noise



Long Live the Kings

At a recent concert in Missouri, the regal US arena rockers were forced to shuffle off stage by a constant drizzle of pigeon excrement raining down from a family of unimpressed birds nesting in the rafters above them. Quite the indignity, we're sure you'll agree. How best to come back from such shame? With an album rammed full of so many potential hit singles that they'll be able to go on tour with their very own flock of pigeon-starved peregrine falcons in tow to ensure all venues remain poop-free zones. Do your bit and pick up *Come Around Sundown* on October 18.

Friends in high places



Mark Ronson – *Record Collection*

The arch pop alchemist returns, with a host of big name guests along for the ride, including Simon Le Bon, Wiley and Ghostface Killah.

Name that croon



Anthony & The Johnsons – *Swanlights*

The oddball raconteur and Mercury Prize winner releases his fourth album. It's Marmite stuff – newcomers should bring earplugs just in case.

Fast talker



Taylor Swift – *Speak Now*

The new crown princess of country unleashes her new album with each track acting as a confession to a different person. Find out what she owns up to on October 24.

Small is beautiful



Tinie Tempah – *Disc-overy*

The long-awaited debut from the South London rapper compensates for that dismal title pun with a gaggle of huge hit singles and attitude to spare.

Hear her roar



KT Tunstall – *Tiger Suit*

Plenty riding on this. The Scottish strummer's second record failed to match her debut's success. She'll be hoping first single *(Still a) Weirdo* does the business.

It takes two



Ben Folds – *Lonely Avenue*

This disc sees Ben Folds hand over lyric-writing duties to none other than *High Fidelity* author Nick Hornby. The Radio 2 crowd will lose their marbles over this one.

MORE NEW MUSIC...

Internet music radar...

Radio-friendly music sales service launches

Yet another new download service is on the way. Flow Songs, from DAB radio manufacturers PURE, allows you to download tracks as you hear them. If you hear a song you like, you press a button on your radio and Flow Songs uses Shazam to identify the track and sell it to you.



iPods blamed for 17 accidents a day

According to the AA, 17 people are injured every day on average because of 'iPhone oblivion'. Motorists, cyclists and joggers are the most common victims, with incidents up 5 per cent since last year. Pay attention to the world around you readers! It's dangerous out there.



Quarter of all UK music income from downloads

New figures suggest that digital downloads' assault on traditional retail channels continues to gather pace, with revenue from downloads now making up around a quarter of all UK music industry income. The UK spends nearly twice as much as both France and Germany on downloads too.



Beatles still not coming to iTunes

Sad news for fans of Liverpool's finest. John Lennon's widow recently confirmed that there was no sign of The Beatles' back catalogue being made available on iTunes. Fine-print wrangling led her to recommend to followers "don't hold your breath".



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Other iTunes goodies

Podcasts, games, audiobooks, iTunes U...



GAME

Helsing's Fire

There are two reasons to buy this ace horror/puzzler: firstly, its original concept, which sees you despatch Dracula and his minions by shining light on them. Secondly, it's a hoot, with Helsing and Dracula trading pithy put-downs between stages.



GAME

Flick Kick Football

Now that the football season is in full swing, it seems like as good a time as any to get stuck into this stupidly addictive time waster. The concept is basic: you have to flick the football past the keeper. The only thing that's missing is the *Match Of The Day* music.



APPLICATION

Dragon Search

Got your hands full or can't be bothered typing in your search query? Dragon Search is a voice-controlled search engine. Just speak clearly into the phone and Dragon Search does the rest. Handles regional accents better than Google's app.



APPLICATION

Timewheel

Calling all pub quiz bores! This fun little app lets you delve back into the UK charts archives and pull up all kinds of data. Find out what was Number 1 on the day you were born, check out celebrity playlists and feed your insatiable appetite for useless pop trivia.



PODCAST

Giant Bombcast

Gaming podcasts are 10 a penny but this is one of the few worth checking out. Hosted by a gang of dedicated US gaming press vets, it manages to walk the fine line between indulgent banter and authoratitive, light-hearted discussion.



GAME

Meow Meow Happy Fight

This one deserves investigation on the strength of the name alone but the game hiding beneath the moniker is great too. It's a standard top-down shooter spiced up by some brilliant visuals and a wicked sense of humour. A steal at 59p.

ESSENTIALS

The highlights from your world right now...

GIG: Alice Cooper, London, October 31

The original shock rocker stops by for Halloween

www.alicecooper.com

COMEDY: Al Murray, UK tour, from October 5

Laughs a-plently from the pub landlord

www.thepublandlord.com

SPORT: Commonwealth games, India, Oct 3-14

Check out our Olympic hopefuls going for gold in Delhi

http://www.cwgdelhi2010.org

FILM: *Wall Street 2: Money Never Sleeps*, Nov 8

Can Oliver Stone rebottle the electricity of the original?

www.wallstreetmoneyneversleeps.com

GAME: Professor Layton & The Lost Future, Oct 22

Brain-bending puzzles for Nintendo's DS detective

www.nintendo.co.uk



Money talks Oliver Stone brings us the *Wall Street* sequel



Puzzled face Professor Layton gets another outing on the DS

Video on the iTunes store

New for your iPod's screen...

Red Riding

Bleak, miserable and utterly brilliant, the recent Channel 4 miniseries about a series of murders spanning an entire decade is available for download for £5.67.



Southland

It's a good month for fans of jet-black crime drama. This gripping US police procedural drama set in LA is well worth a look. Get the full series for £12.99.



Shooting Stars

The latest series of Vic and Bob's quiz show romp should cheer you up after all that gloom. A series pass will set you back £9.99, or it's £1.89 per episode.



Sherlock

On paper this should have been horrendous folly, but the Baker Street detective's modern day makeover achieved the impossible and rocked. It's £3.99 per episode.



Veronica Mars

Now cancelled, the third season of the titular teen PI's post-modern sleuthing is now available for download for £27.99. Or it's £1.89 per episode.



Ross Kemp: Middle East

Catch up with Kemp as he tries to get to grips with the Middle East's problems. Compellingly absurd, and good value at £3.78 for the series.



Scan: worldmags®

How to do anything!

Turn your iOS device into a practical powerhouse by using apps to learn new things

By Craig Grannell

Don't listen to anyone who goes on about iOS devices only being good for media consumption. Because you can learn a thing or two using your iPhone, iPod touch or iPad. If there's ever something you've wanted to do, but that you've never got round to trying, chances are that, yes, there's an app for that. Included on these pages are some of our favourites; and if you've learned something new with the help of your iPhone or iPod touch, write in and tell us.



How to double up a plug socket

B&Q

Price Free

URL itunes.com/app/bandq

Fire up the B&Q app, tap on 'how to' and you can find out how to double up a plug socket so you can plug in more iPod chargers. Usefully, the app explains how to do plenty of other things, too, such as bending copper pipe with your knees, dealing with leaking water (from broken pipes or when it's alarmingly dripping from the ceiling), correcting sagging shelves, and replacing a rotten fence panel. DIY gurus might scoff at the succinct overviews, but given that this app is free, it's a handy download for when you need to make a quickfire repair to something on your property.

How to speak four new language

Learn a Language with Michel Thomas

Price Free previews/from £2.99 per lesson

URL itunes.com/app/learnalanguagewithmichelthomas

If you've ever encountered Michel Thomas on tape or CD, you'll know that his method for teaching languages is both unconventional and brilliant. He advocates listening and speaking rather than writing, and uses similarities in languages to provide a foundation for learning. This app offers a simple and elegant way to use Thomas' methods to learn French, Spanish, German and Italian. Previews are available so you can see if the method works for you; if it does, new lessons can be bought on an hour-by-hour basis. Flash cards also help you track your progress.



How to tune and play a ukulele

GuitarToolkit

Price £5.99

URL itunes.apple.com/gb/app/guitartoolkit/id284962368

That ukulele you have lying around won't learn to play itself! Helpfully, GuitarToolkit provides what you need to get started, including a tuner to ensure your instrument's four strings sound great, a metronome and a chord directory. And if you're one of those people who insists on having one of those guitars with an entirely different number of strings, you're catered for: the app happily works with 6- and 12-string guitars, all manner of basses, banjos and mandolins. There's even a 'lefty' mode that adjusts everything for those of you who hold your axe like Hendrix.





structables.com

How to survive in the wild

SAS Survival Guide

Price £3.99

URL itunes.com/app/sassurvivalguide

Although it's fairly unlikely that the average iPad & iPhone User will find themselves stranded in the desert, lost in the Arctic, or adrift on a large body of water, you never know. The SAS Survival Guide provides handy tips from former SAS soldier and instructor John 'Lofty' Wiseman about how to survive any situation, anywhere. You get the full text of his book, 16 videos, photo galleries of edible and poisonous plants, a morse-code signalling device, and a sun compass – perfect for when you're hopelessly off-course and alone. Well, at least until your iPhone's battery runs out.



How to drive a massive lorry

UK LGV Theory Test

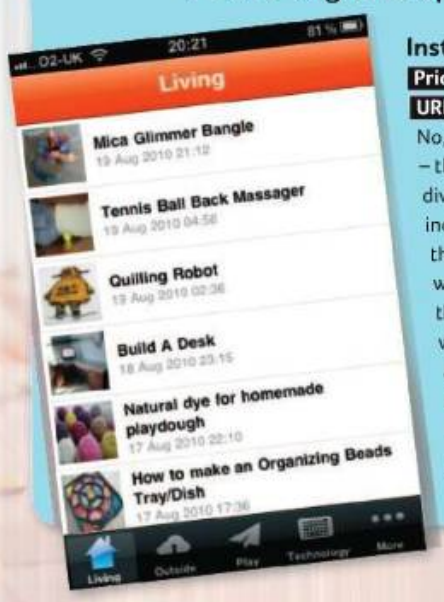
Price £5.99

URL itunes.com/app/uklgvtheorytest

You know how it is: you've spent months mastering a large goods vehicle (LGV), but all those late nights, dreaming of a life on the open road, driving a vehicle with more wheels than most, left little time to study. Luckily, UK LGV Theory Test is here to help, offering over 1,000 multiple-choice questions and a test that simulates the real format. And if you're one of those people who prefers life on just four wheels, there's the UK Car Driving Theory Test app (£1.79) from the same company, with tests, progress meters and a built-in Highway Code.



How to find 55-gallon steel drums, make a cat's wig and spool-knit a cool lizard



Instructables.com

Price Free

URL itunes.com/app/instructablescom

No, we've not quaffed one too many shandies – this app really does help you to do a rather diverse range of things, to say the least, including making a cat's wig. Essentially, the app is a front-end to the Instructables website, a place where people share what they do and how they do it. At the time of writing, the app frustratingly lacks a search, and so it's best for browsing and becoming inspired by all the crazy things people are doing; however, find something fun and you can at least share it with your friends via Twitter or email.

Master the kitchen

Find out how to cook like the pros

Jamie's 20 Minute Meals

Price £4.99

URL itunes.apple.com/gb/app/jamies-20-minute-meals/id318926433

If you're a fan of the mockney cookery master, this app provides 60 new recipes and 21 'kitchen skills' videos. Each recipe handily provides step-by-step photos, and portion sizes can be amended to suit varying numbers of diners. It's a polished app – usable and good looking.



Nigella Quick Collection

Price £4.99

URL itunes.apple.com/gb/app/nigella-quick-collection/id366478575

Nigella's app provides more recipes than Jamie Oliver's (70) but fewer 'exclusives' (just 10). It also has tip videos, step-by-step guides and shopping lists. Usefully, there's also voice control, for when you're covered in sesame peanut noodles and need to know what to do.



Epicurious

Price Free

URL itunes.apple.com/gb/app/epicurious-recipes-shopping/id312101965

Epicurious is a fantastic cooking app. It boasts tens of thousands of recipes, many of which have been reviewed by Epicurious members. Favourites can be saved, and interactive shopping lists help you remember to buy ingredients for dishes you've never made.

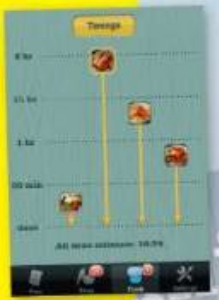


Dishy

Price £2.99

URL itunes.apple.com/gb/app/dishy-cooking-made-easy-christmas/id331939802

Sleeker (due to its lack of videos) and cheaper than the celeb chef apps, Dishy also manages to pack in more recipes (95 in all). It's also feature-rich, enabling you to combine dishes into a menu, easily generate shopping lists, and use interactive timers.



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Healy hands



Travis have been responsible for some of the most lovable songs of the last 15 years. The likes of *Sing*, *Driftwood* and of course the ubiquitous *Why Does It Always Rain On Me?* propelled the Scottish band firmly into the mainstream and helped pave the way for acts such as Coldplay, Keane and Athlete. Formed around 1990, Travis – Fran Healy (vocals and guitar), Dougie Payne (bass), Andy Dunlop (lead guitar, keyboards) and Neil Primrose (drums) have been together for two decades now, most recently releasing their sixth album, *Ode To J. Smith* on their own label in 2008. Now, in between Travis albums, Healy has written his first ever solo record, *Wreckorder*, again released by his own Wreckord Label. A delicate, gentle and introspective affair, *Wreckorder* features appearances from Neko Case and Paul McCartney. It's a personal, textured album in which Healy – much as he does in conversation – bares his soul with surprising candour.

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We catch up with Travis frontman Fran Healy as he releases his first solo album, to talk about wells, water and records...

By Mischa Pearlman

Firstly, what prompted you to write and record a solo album?

I hadn't really thought about doing a solo album until I was in LA last year. Everyone's always asked me: 'When are you going to do a solo record?', but I've never really wanted to do it. But I'd written a song called *Holiday*, and it was then that I thought that maybe I should do a solo record.

The thought just came into my head backstage at the Wiltern Theater – I can remember exactly where it was. Five minutes before, if someone had asked me, I'd have said the same thing as I had for the last 14 years: 'why would I do a solo record? I'm in a great band'.

But I think at this stage it's the perfect time to do it. I'm not getting in the way of Travis, and the guys are all happy having some time off.

Does doing this take you back to before Travis, when you were starting out as a songwriter and hadn't got a professional career together?

Not really. It's weird. Right now, it reminds me of when we got a deal and when we first started touring and you're just trying to get your head around a new way of doing things. So that's what it feels like. I think with all of the experience I've had, though – and I've been doing this for 12 years, maybe longer, since I was very young – it's kind of easy now. It's my world, this is my habitat and I'm used to it.

> **"This album is just water straight out of the well, the closest you'll get to the source"**

Obviously you're the singer and main songwriter of Travis, so what's the main difference between writing a solo record and writing one with the band? Is it easier when you're by yourself or is it harder, because there's no other input?

Well, I never ask for anybody else's input, because I'm a bit of a benevolent dictator, as I was called by Dougie – in the nicest possible way!

At least you're benevolent!

Exactly! I think that the process – well, the beginning of the process – was easier and the motivation was easier because it was something new that I was writing for. The actual writing wasn't any easier, but the inclination to sit down in my room and work was.

You've turned vegetarian as a way of thanking Paul McCartney for playing bass on one of the songs. Was that one of the bargaining pleas for him doing it, or just a gesture of thanks?

It was a thank you, because I didn't know how to say thanks. And I wanted to do something that wasn't just another present to add to the collection. So I suggested to Nora [his wife] that we do that and she was cool with it. I've always fancied being a veggie, but I think it was harder to be one in the 80s, because there really wasn't much to eat other than potatoes and carrots. Now there's so much variety and so much choice.

You also moved to Berlin fairly recently. How has that changed your day to day life and your music? Has it had a big impact?

I don't know. Maybe. Probably. Definitely! I mean, there's something there. Not on the surface, but underneath there's probably something there. We moved to Berlin two-and-a-half years ago. We just wanted a change. We'd been in London for 12 years and just thought 'let's find somewhere new'. And I'm so glad we did.

Berlin is a great place for children to grow up. Kids don't need to go to school until they're six and there doesn't seem to be this rush – the pace of life in Berlin, for such a major city, is very laidback. It's such a big city but there's still not a lot of cash there, so people are moving from all over Europe and all over the world because it's affordable. It's a place where, if you have an idea, you can make it happen.

Are you going to try to get the others to move over there for the next Travis record, then?

Oh, no! I'll fly back to the UK.

Which presumably means that there will be another Travis album. This solo record doesn't mark the end of the band?

No. This is part of the whole thing. If you're the main writer in the band, I feel like you're the well and the water in the well is the songs. So you have the water in the well and Travis is like the Coca-Cola taste, that has another flavour to it. This album is just water straight out of the well, the closest you get to the source. For the next record, I'm going to take some songs and present them to the band and we'll cover them with the Travis hot sauce!

Clearing out

A detox program has given Fran a new lease of life for the release of his new album, *Wreckorder*...

At the time of the interview, Fran Healy was nearing the end of an extensive detox programme that involved changing his diet and abstaining from alcohol. "I'm on the second to last day of a 21-day detox," he says, "and I've never felt so positive. It feels like my brain has been cleared out of crap. It's like being 12 again. My doctor in New York kept going on at me for ages to do it, so I finally did. I haven't touched any alcohol for about a month. It's great. I've really never felt better."



Press wreckord Fran's album is out October 5

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Stunning new iPods

Your guide to Apple's amazing new range of iPods

By Mark Hattersley



From the incredibly versatile iPod touch to the intriguing new shuffle, Apple's new iPod range is a bunch of compelling Christmas purchases, but which one should you get?

On the face of it there are three new iPods (and of course there's still the classic, and you could include the almighty iPhone too, but we're not doing that here). The iPod touch is essentially an iPhone 4 without the phone (or, as Steve Jobs puts it: "it's an iPhone without the contract"). The newly-updated iPod touch gets the speedy A4 processor, three-axis gyro, and amazing Retina display. The iPod touch also gets front and rear-facing cameras, enabling you to shoot video and share FaceTime video calls.

Then there's the stunning new iPod nano, with its 4 x 4cm Multi-Touch display, compact square design and clip, taking it into shuffle territory in terms of size, and iPod touch territory in terms of controls. Speaking of the iPod shuffle, that's still around – only Apple has re-introduced the buttons, making it much easier to control. So which of the new iPods is asking you to part with your cash? Let's get it on...

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Getting to grips with the new nano

The new iPod nano offers Multi-Touch in a miniature space



Back clip
Like the shuffle, the nano has a clip on the back so you can attach it to your clothes and go running.

Volume controls
The volume controls feature metallic styling, like those that debuted on the iPhone 4.

Sleep/Wake up
This sleep/wake button turns the screen on and off. It also locks the touchscreen controls when not in use.

In touch
The new iPod nano has a tiny 4 x 4cm multi touch display like the iPhone and iPod touch.

Apps
There's a range of built-in apps, although you can't buy new ones from the App Store.

iPod nano tech specs

Price and Storage 8GB: £129, 16GB: £159
Display 3.91 x 3.92cm colour TFT, 240 x 240 pixels, 220ppi
Size 37.5 x 40.9 x 8.78mm
Weight 21.1g

The new old-skool iPod shuffle

Apple's made a really bold move. The third-generation iPod shuffle removed all the buttons and placed them on the earphones; the new one puts them back. "People clearly miss the buttons," said Steve Jobs, "but they love VoiceOver and playlists... so what are we gonna do? Let's make the best of both".

The new iPod shuffle looks visually similar to the second-generation model (although it's a lot smaller), but has all the functionality, including VoiceOver, of the third generation.



Shuffle with buttons
Removing the buttons from the shuffle was always controversial. Now that the new model has buttons, Apple's is bound to have a hit on its hands

Nine ways to use the new nano

Your guide to using the nano's latest features



1 Swipe control

Swipe left to right on the Home screen to reveal icons for browsing your music by Song, Album, Artist, Playlist, Genius Mix, Genre, Composer and more. You'll also find icons for Photos and Settings.



2 Auto-arrange

You can rearrange the icons on the screen just like on an iPhone or iPod touch. Click and hold to make the icons wobble, then drag them around. Click the sleep/wake button when you're finished.



3 Shake and shuffle

The iPod nano still has Shake to Shuffle, taking you to a different song in your music library. If you're in the habit of clipping it on to go jogging or exercising, you will probably want to turn this feature off...



4 Spin it around

The nano's screen auto-rotates (thanks to an accelerometer). If you're clipping the nano onto your sleeve or waist you can always rotate the screen with two fingers so it's the right way up for you to view.



5 Running well

The new nano has built-in Nike+ functionality and a pedometer, so you can take it jogging and measure how far you've gone. This brings it in line with the iPod touch and iPhone, which both feature built-in Nike+ apps.



6 Longer-lasting

Though we've yet to test this claim, Apple promises up to 24 hours of battery life from the iPod nano – much longer than you'd get from an iPhone or iPod touch. It's a very flexible way to take music on the go.



7 FM radio

The new nano has a built-in FM radio, and you can scan through stations using the touch screen. You can even pause and rewind a broadcast by up to 15 minutes.



8 Genius

The Genius playlist feature of old has made the transtion to this new small screen. You can tap Genius and let your iPod nano find other songs in your library that go together.



9 Playlist creation

You can create your own playlists directly on the nano too. Tap the Playlists icon, then hit the 'Add' button. This lets you search your music and tap songs to add them to your playlist.

Hands on with the iPod touch

The best of the iPhone 4 comes to the iPod

Twin cameras
There are two cameras on the device, one on the front and one on the rear. This enables you to record HD video and use FaceTime.

Retina display
The display packs in 326 pixels per inch, pretty much at the limit of what the human eye can resolve. This extra high-resolution display makes everything look crisp and clear.



Apple A4 chip
This powerful 1GHz processor combines rock-solid performance with low power consumption.

iPod touch tech specs

Price and Storage 8GB: £189, 16GB: £249, 32GB: £329
Display 3.5in 960 x 640 pixels, 326ppi
Size 111 x 58.9 x 7.2mm
Weight 101g

Six apps to show off the iPod touch



TruPhone

Thanks to the built-in microphone, you can now use the iPod touch for internet calls if you have a WiFi connection. Skype is also available, and if you already have a Skype account on your computer you can use the same account on your iPod touch.



N.O.V.A.

A few apps make use of the built-in gyro, but none better than N.O.V.A. You can still use on-screen controls, but you can also aim by moving the iPod touch around.

iBooks

Text looks utterly amazing on the new Retina display and its now possible to read books from Apple's iBookstore. Take a look at the free iBooks app to see just what a difference those extra-dense pixels make.



Six steps to using the new iPod touch

Your guide to getting started with the iPod touch



1 FaceTime

FaceTime is perhaps the most impressive new feature on the iPod touch. At the tap of a button you can video chat your friends (provided they also have an iPhone 4 or iPod touch), over a WiFi connection.



2 HD video recording

You can record high-definition video using the cameras on the device, storing it internally. This can be transferred to a computer or shared on YouTube or MobileMe. You can also hook up an iPod touch to a television to view it.



3 Game Center

Gaming is a big thing for the iPod touch, and the new device includes Game Center, Apple's new service to enable gamers to play online with each other on their iPod or iPhone. An interesting development.



4 iMovie editing

The new iPod touch is powerful enough to run Apple's iMovie app, so you can not only shoot video with the iPod touch but also edit it to create great home movies.



5 Gyroscope

Now there's a new way to control the iPod touch – by waving it around. Some games make amazing use of the new gyro-controls that aim wherever you're pointing.



6 Voice Control

The new iPod touch has a built-in microphone, so you can now speak to control the device. Hold down the Home button to open Voice Control, then speak commands.



Hipstamatic

Now that you've got a built-in camera you might want to check out this great camera app. Hipstamatic turns your iPod touch into an old-school camera and lets you change lenses, film stock and flash settings. It produces really cool pictures, too.



Shazam

With its built-in mic, the iPod touch can now run Shazam, one of the most amazing apps ever. It can identify just about any song from a snippit of the audio. It also lets you share what you find, thus allowing you to discover tons of new music.



Real Racing

A stalwart of iPhone gaming, Real Racing has always looked (and been) the business. Since being updated for the new Retina display, this game looks little short of incredible.

Logic3

www.logic3.com

Made for iPod iPhone



i-Station26

2.1 Speaker Dock with FM Radio and Alarm Clock

The new i-Station26 from renowned speaker manufacturer Logic3, blends design and technology seamlessly in one ultra stylish unit. This feature packed docking system is combined with FM Radio and Alarm Clock and can fill a room with crisp, deep lifelike sound. Simply dock your iPhone or iPod and enjoy stereo sound, from the combination of two mid range drivers and a sub-woofer. Furthermore the unit features Class D amplifier, Sleep Setting Option and alarm which gives you the choice to wake up to FM Radio, Buzzer or music from your docked iPhone or iPod.

- 2.1 Speaker System with FM Radio and Alarm Clock for iPhone / iPod
- Choose to wake up to FM Radio, Buzzer or iPhone/iPod
- Power efficient Class D amplifier for improved performance
- Built-in docking station provides charging for iPod/iPhone
- Remote Control with iPhone/iPod Menu navigation
- Sliding dock to conceal Universal Cradle when not in use
- 3.5mm Stereo Line-in connection for other audio devices
- Unit size : 280 x 127 x 125 mm (L x W x H)



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50 BEST GAMES

There are thousands of bargain games available on the App Store. We select the 50 best you can get for a quid or less

By Craig Grannell



As is often the case with Apple's App Store, the big challenge is finding decent games on there amongst all the dross. Too often there appears to be a very good reason why a game is free or cheap – it's because it's rubbish.

However, there are actually loads of very good games available on the App Store that cost next to nothing, if you know where to look. It doesn't cost that much to sign up to Apple's developer scheme, so games enthusiasts and developers are reeling off games almost as fast as gamers can play them, and the quality of some of them is impressive. Gone are the days when you had to splurge £50 on the latest console games – the App Store has seen to that.

So, with this in mind, we've picked out the 50 best games for 99p or less. Gaming on the go has never been better value, and with this list you'll be able to get your gaming kicks on the barest of budgets. Enjoy!

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Puzzle • Action-puzzle • Strategy

Flight Control

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/flightcontrol



Firemint's game pretty much kicked off the line-drawing genre, but if you've not yet succumbed to its charms, the game has you landing aircraft by dragging them to runways and helipads. It starts off easy, but when you've a dozen planes on-screen it becomes an ongoing battle to avoid mid-air collisions. Recent versions have added airfields and smart updated graphics for the iPhone 4.

Helsing's Fire

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/helsingsfire



It's great to see Helsing's Fire try something different; it's even better to discover that the game's splendid. You position Helsing's torch to illuminate monsters and destroy them in the correct order. The nature of the game makes it suitable for quick goes, but the large number of levels, slick production, beautifully rendered characters and graphics, and amusing Victorian dialogue, ensure it sticks around for the long term.

Highborn

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/highborn



Akin to a budget Civilization, Highborn offers plenty of depth and there's loads of fun to be had.

Aurora Feint 3

Price Free
Platform iPad
URL itunes.com/app/auroraFeint3



Weld a basic RPG to a match-three puzzler and you've got Aurora Feint 3. Good graphics and engaging battles.

Tetari

Price 59p
Platform Universal
URL itunes.com/app/tetari



Static-Tetris-from-above Tetari is more cerebral than Tetris, but similarly addictive, and there's also a 'twist' mode with hexagonal playfields.

Super 7

Price 59p
Platform Universal
URL http://itunes.com/app/super7



Super 7 has you dragging numbered discs together so that the resulting figure totals seven. Gets very hard very quickly.

Green Fingers

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/appgreenfingers



The aim: switch flowerpots to collect items and make flowers grow. The reality: a frantic, fast-paced game that becomes a big challenge at higher levels.

Flood-It! 2

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/floodit2



Flood-It! 2 merely has you tapping colours to flood the board with a single colour. Doing this in few moves is surprisingly tricky, though.

Flyloop

Price 59p
Platform Universal
URL itunes.com/app/flyloop



You might think Flyloop's what a hippy might produce if they wanted to rip off Flight Control. But take another look – sure, drawing loops to snag like-coloured butterflies seems easy, but it soon becomes tough to snare them within tight time limits. Great sound and a 'relax' mode (which omits the time limit) makes this an essential purchase for any iOS device owner.

Polyhedra

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/polyhedra



There are a few fill-based action-puzzlers on the App Store, but Polyhedra's head-and-shoulders above the rest. You press to expand shapes, aiming to fill two-thirds of the screen, while avoiding enemy particles (which destroy shapes still being created). Gravity can be used to trap foes under existing shapes. As the game goes on, new shapes are introduced, and there's an enemy-free 'toy box' mode, which you can use to create and play with 20 shapes.

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Racing • Sport • Board games

Parcel Panic

Price 59p
Platform Universal
URL itunes.com/app/parcelpanicpostcarracer3d

Parcel Panic resembles what Sega's Crazy Taxi would be like if you swapped the taxi for a rickety delivery truck and teleported it to a seemingly deserted desert island. The island's small, but there are plenty of short cuts to find – and you'll need them to ensure you get your deliveries to their destinations on time.



Super KO Boxing 2

BEST FIGHTING GAME

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/superkoboxing2

If you're a fan of any of the Punch-Out!! games for various Nintendo consoles, Super KO Boxing 2 is along the same lines. You battle your way to the top, overcoming 15 larger-than-life opponents. Once you've become world champion, you can check out the 'challenge' mode, which tests your skills further – one such challenge puts you in the ring but stops you from dodging your foe's punches!



Stick Golf

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/stickgolf

This side-on golf game looks simple, but it's huge fun to play. Features 12 courses, with traps galore.



You Cruise by Mazda MX-5

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/youcruisebymazdamx5

Most freebie licensed racing games are rubbish, but Mazda's controls are some of the best of any iOS racer.



Real Racing GTi

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/realracinggti

This cut-down Real Racing gives you six cars and three tracks. Lasts longer than many full-price games.



Flick Kick Rugby

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/flickkickrugby

Use your finger for endless rugby conversions, battling wind and increased distances after every kick.



10 Pin Shuffle™ (Bowling) Lite

Price Free
Platform Universal
URL itunes.com/app/10pinshufflebowlinglite

Merges bowling and poker – strikes or spares get you new cards, and you must hold the winning hand at the end.



Sol Free

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/solfreesolitaire

For solitaire fans, this one's a must. You get a half dozen variants on the game great graphics, and stats tracking.



Moto X Mayhem/Moto X Mayhem

Price 59p each
Platform iPhone/iPod touch or iPad (separate apps)
URL itunes.com/app/motoxmayhem

This motocross game isn't too concerned with realism, instead offering you distinctly arcade-oriented side-on time trials over treacherous terrain (four on iPhone, three on iPad, at the time of writing). While the ragdoll physics initially irks, learn to exploit this aspect of the game and it becomes a lot of fun. You also get the benefit of infinite falls, although every crash-and-restart adds one second to your time – clean runs are the way to high scores.



Shanghai Mahjong

Price 59p
Platform Universal
URL itunes.com/app/shanghaimahjong



For 59p, this is a ridiculous bargain for any iOS-device-owning mahjong fan. You get over 200 layouts, plenty of optional downloads for new tile-sets and backgrounds, and, on winning a game, a suitably silly proverb (of sorts) from a fortune cookie. The bigger screen of the iPad unsurprisingly makes Shanghai Mahjong easier to play, but with the game now boasting Retina display support, iPhone 4 owners can also enjoy crystal clear tiles and backgrounds.

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Platform • Survival

Pix'n Love Rush



Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/pixnloverush

This game is some of the best classic platform games you've ever played, stripped to their cores, and then shoved into a WarioWare-style production that keeps you constantly on your toes. One minute you're running horizontally, Mario-style, before the game abruptly shifts to Rainbow Islands-oriented vertical scrolling or single-screen shooting and platforming action. The beautiful retro graphics, surprisingly tight controls and well-designed bonus system make this the best platform game for iOS systems. At 59p, it's a steal.

Bit Pilot

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/bitpilot

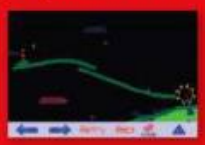


The Bit Pilot appears to have stumbled into a locked area of space, and his tiny ship lacks any weaponry. It's your job to keep him alive for as long as possible, dodging asteroids and lasers, with only occasional power-ups to aid survival. With its charming retro graphics and audio, along with perfectly balanced two-thumb controls (one thumb for subtle movements, two for quicker ones, battling inertia all the while), Bit Pilot is an iOS classic.

Trace

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/trace

This charming platform game provides dozens of single-screen levels and enables you to draw platforms to reach your goal. An exciting time-attack game.



Rat On A Scooter XL

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/ratonascooterxl

Rat On A Scooter XL is a one-thumb effort that has you helping your rat (on a scooter, natch) leap between platforms in the pursuit of more cheese.



Mr.AahH!!

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/mraahh

This has you tapping the screen to make Mr.AaahH let go of his swinging rope and land on the next platform. Wind and gravity up the challenge.



Doodle Jump

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/doodlejump

Doodle Jump's tilt-based gameplay is simple and addictive, and themes (especially the World Cup one) offer subtly different variations on the title's core gameplay.



Pudge

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/pudge

In gameplay terms, Pudge echoes iCopter: give your character thrust with a thumb, and avoid the walls and other obstacles. Great graphics set it apart.



:Shift:

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/shift

:Shift: is a single-screen platform game, but the 'shift' buttons flip the screen, adding a new dimension to each level.



Run!



Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL tunes.com/app/run

Forget Canabalt – Run! is where the action is when it comes to horizontally scrolling survival games. It might lack Canabalt's graphical polish, but Run! makes up for it with a huge range of foes and more control – you jump, slide, punch and kick you way to new high scores. Handily, your guy's also armed with a pocket bazooka (great for taking out helicopters!) and Run! is the only iOS game where you can karate kick a leaping shark in the face.

Squareball

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/squareball

Squareball mixes Breakout, Pong and a platform game; you swipe levels left and right, aiming to grab green blocks with your bouncing ball, avoiding red blocks of death and holes of doom. It's one of the most unforgiving games around – it sorts the tough gamers from the wusses, and then promptly turns said tough gamers into gibbering wrecks. The thing is, Squareball's also hugely addictive, and so you'll swear by it and swear at it in equal measure.



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Shooting • Artillery • Rhythm games

Angry Birds

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/angrybirds



Green pigs have stolen the birds' eggs and the birds are very, very angry. Now the pigs are holed up in various ramshackle structures, and so, naturally, the birds have decided to fling themselves at the pigs with the aid of a huge catapult. Ultimately, Angry Birds is a modern take on the ancient Artillery, but what a take! For 59p, you get 165 levels (many requiring plenty of time and precision to beat), fantastic graphics and humour, and several 'hidden' extras.

AirAttack/AirAttack HD

Price 59p each
Platform iPhone/iPod touch or iPad (separate apps)
URL itunes.com/app/airattack



This vertical shoot 'em up required a few trips back to its App Store page to check the price, but, yes, for 59p you really do get a fantastic eight-level bullet-hell shooter that puts many more expensive games to shame. The touch controls are precise, and the levels are well designed. The giant end-of-level bosses are imposing and brilliant – it's terrific when your plane suddenly finds itself confronted with a gigantic Nazi UFO.

Bankshot

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/bankshot



This simple game dressed in lush 'neon' graphics has you flinging a disc at a goal via one of the arena's walls. The 'blitz' mode is particularly fun, with hazards and power-ups adding to the tension and excitement.

Lucky Coins

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/luckycoins



Like more gratifying Peggle crossed with pinball, Lucky Coins requires you to grab the requisite number of objects using infrequently placed rotating magnets to carefully aim your coin.

Vector Tanks (Classic Version)

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app vectortanksclassicversion



Take to a surreal 3D battlefield and blow up as many tanks as you can before your own tank is obliterated. Vector Tanks riffs off of classic Atari game Battlezone, and boasts addictive, exciting gameplay.

World of Tunes

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/worldoftunes



This quirky platform game differentiates itself from the various Tap Taps on the App Store with lashings of personality, cute tunes and amusing boss battles.

Minigore

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/minigore



You're about to be eaten by hordes of 'furries' with pointy teeth. Take as many with you as you can in this dual-thumb shooter that boasts great character design.

Tap Tap Radiation

Price Free
Platform iPad
URL itunes.com/app/taptapradiation



Tap Tap gets a unique dynamic for the iPad. The basic rhythm-action gameplay remains familiar, but trippy backdrops make the game feel fresh.

Westbang

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/westbang

BEST COWBOY GAME

Westbang succeeds by going back beyond the birth of the FPS genre, to Sega's Bank Panic. There's no scrolling here – just three doors. As doors open, you have a split-second to shoot bad guys while avoiding innocents. New enemy types regularly appear as you progress, and there's an 'ugly' mode for tough guys.



Dropship

Price Free
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/dropship



Dropship was one of the App Store's early success stories, offering the first example of truly successful dual-thumb touchscreen controls. It could so easily have become a tech demo, but Dropship brings to mind the best aspects of arcade game Gravitar and 8-bit classic Thrust as you explore vector-graphic cave formations, rescue 'pods' and take out gun turrets with your weapons.

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Arcade • Pinball

Fruit Ninja

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/fruitninja

This cathartic game has you swiping your screen like crazy to hack apart myriad pieces of fruit.



Cabby

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/cabby

In Cabby, you control a flying taxi, carting punters around various tricky-to-navigate levels.



PapiJump Land

Price 59p
Platform: iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/papijumpland

This cute game has you helping Mr Papi around 30 different levels, in a mission to munch hamburgers.



The Deep Pinball

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/thedeeppinball

The Deep is among the best App Store pinball games, and the original iPhone version costs 59p. Looks great, with various camera angles.



iPolygon

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/ipolygon

iPolygon takes advantage of your device's accelerometer. Make your ball spiked, smash the walls of the shapes that confine you, and evade the void.



I Dig It

Price: 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/idigit

Help a farmer use his drilldozer to mine for items to sell, enabling him to save his farm. Although resembling the likes of Dig Dug, I Dig It offers much more depth.



Pocket God

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/pocketgod

For its first few updates, Pocket God was an interesting curiosity, enabling you to fiddle about with some cartoon pygmies, flicking them into volcanos. Now, though, the title has grown into an interesting collection of minigames alongside ever-evolving scenarios. So while there's still plenty to explore and experiment with in each location, there are also quickfire and fun clones of Doodle Jump, Harbour Master and Canabalt lurking, along with a slew of simpler timing-based high-score games to master.





Dark Nebula – Episode Two

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/1337gamedesign

We're not sure what Dark Nebula's story is, but you appear to guide a robot disc through 19 levels of hostile dystopian terrain, from jungles to brutal techno-enclaves. Your aim is simply to reach the end of each (mostly) vertically-scrolling level, but to do so you must battle deadly enemies and obstacles and master the game's subtle tilt-based controls. The cinematic score and graphics add to the riveting gameplay, making this a must-have title.

Fox Vs Duck

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/foxvsduck

This abstract game resembles a piece of high-end graphic design, and it boasts suitably elegant and refined gameplay to match its minimal aesthetic. You tilt your device to help your spherical duck escape the pond to freedom, avoiding the ravenous fox and deadly lurking koi carp. It doesn't take long for the game to take over in an almost hypnotic manner, and you'll feel surprisingly jolted when a fox grabs and kills one of your ducks.



Cluck It!

Price 59p
Platform iPhone/iPod touch
URL itunes.com/app/cluckit



In Curious Bear's one-thumb Frogger variant, the answer to 'Why did the chicken cross the road?' is 'To take all the little chicks to school'. It's obvious when you think about it. The graphics are sweet and the gameplay has surprising depth – a tap moves you one lane, and you run with the traffic, so must ensure you carefully time your taps. The game's 50 levels provide plenty of challenge, and Cluck It! puts Konami's similarly priced iPhone Frogger to shame.

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Tuff-Luv

SHOOTING HD!

Get HD-ready on your iPhone 4's camera

By Andy Penfold



The iPhone 4's camera is a massive step forward when compared to the dodgy snappers on the old iPhone models. Video shooting came to the iPhone on the iPhone 3G in 2008, but now it's taken a real step forward on the iPhone 4 – it can shoot in full 720p HD. The result is high detail home videos from your phone.

We've tried the video camera in a variety of settings, and can happily report that it performs well. It even filmed flowing water really smoothly – always a good test of a video camera's prowess. The video camera can also use the LED flash on the camera, although this is best for lightening up your drunken clips of your friends at parties rather than any real creative use.

Apple released the iPhone version of iMovie – its video-editing app – at the same time as the iPhone 4. iMovie is impressive, and plenty of third-parties have contributed apps that complement the iPhone 4's video capabilities too. Read on for your guide to video shooting on the iPhone 4, from apps to creative tips.

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Camcorder guided tour

Here's your guide to using the iPhone 4's video camera...



The iPhone packs its 5 million pixels onto a 1/4in backside-illuminated CMOS sensor. Sensors with backside illumination technology move the wiring from the front side of the sensor to the back, so that it's behind the light sensors. This allows more light to reach the sensors without being diffused by the circuitry, which means the camera can capture better low-light images.

Another factor contributing to the camera's good low-light performance is the size of its pixels. Bigger pixels capture more light, which makes for better images. Apple retained the same pixel size that it had on previous iPhones instead of shrinking them down to fit more megapixels into a smaller area, which is something many cameras do to inflate their megapixel count.

There's a 5x digital zoom slider, which essentially crops your image in-camera. There is a new LED flash which can be set to Auto, Off, or On. You can toggle between the main camera and the new 1.4-megapixel front-facing camera. Tap-to-focus works on the front camera, but digital zoom does not.

In Video mode, you'll be able to use the same controls. While a video is recording, you can turn the light on and off, and tap the screen to change your focus from one subject to another. Double tapping on the screen zooms in so that your video fills the entire screen, though it is still recording at the same 1280 by 720 size. The iPhone records 720p HD video at 30 frames per second (fps) and the front facing camera records 360p video. You cannot toggle between the two cameras while it is recording.

Five tips for great clips

How to take quality video from your iPhone 4's camera...



Get a tripod

For really smooth video clips, get a tripod. The Gorillamobile for 3G/3GS is a good example – and Joby promises an iPhone 4 version before the end of the year.



Light relief

While the iPhone 4 handles low light well, you're still best off shooting on a nice bright day. The flash won't add much to your shots unless you're filming subjects close up.



Diverse shots

When shooting a sequence for editing, make sure you get a good mix of close-ups, long shots, crowd shots and action shots. This variety will make your edit more interesting.



Eight-second rule

If you look at film and TV, the camera rarely lingers on one shot for more than eight seconds, usually much less. Bear this in mind when you're editing for a good snappy sequence.



Planning

If you're making a proper film on your iPhone, make sure you plan it with a script, and proper rehearsals. This will save you time and space on your iPhone's internal memory.

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The ins and outs of iPhone 4 HD

All you need to know about HD on the iPhone

Shooting video on your mobile phone has always been something of a novelty feature, but with the iPhone 4's full HD capabilities, video quality has taken a massive leap compared to the old models. Here are the ins and outs of the iPhone 4's video capabilities.

What does the 'HD' actually mean?

HD is a catch-all term for video of a resolution that's vastly higher than conventional television. The iPhone 4 shoots in 720p, which is shorthand for saying that the resolution is 1,280 pixels wide and 720 pixels tall. The 'p' at the end stands for 'progressive scan', which means that each of the 720 rows of pixels refresh every time the screen refreshes – in the iPhone 4's case the refresh rate is 30 frames per second.

Contrast this with another HD format, 1080i, which offers an interlaced refresh rate – this means that alternate rows of pixels refresh in quick succession. All things being equal, progressive scan makes for better detail.

Can the iPhone 4 play HD videos on its screen?

Yes. Apple's new Retina display has four times the resolution of all previous iPhone models which were 480 x 320 pixels. So its 960 x 640-pixel screen is approaching the resolution of, for example, 1,280 x 720 HD TV. But because all those pixels are packed into such a small screen compared to your TV in the lounge, its detail is incredibly high – so high the human retina can barely make out individual pixels, and hence the name Retina display.

In terms of the videos that it can play from your iTunes library, it supports three formats: MPEG-4, H.264 (in fact, a particular form of MPEG-4), and Motion JPEG (M-JPEG). If you can't get a video to work, check the 'Video formats' box below for more detailed specs.

How much space do HD videos take up on the iPhone's hard drive?

With this high level of video quality, your iPhone will fill up fast if you shoot a lot of video. 12 minutes of HD video will take up about 1GB of your iPhone's memory, so if it's already chocka with music you might need to free up some space.

What about the front-facing camera? What resolution does that shoot?

The front-facing camera is designed primarily for FaceTime video chats. As such it's pretty low-res so that the video can be sent in real-time over WiFi. While it'll take video and save it to your Camera Roll, it's a VGA camera and only 1.4, which is normal for a basic webcam.

Will the iPhone 4 output 720p HD video to a TV or monitor?

The iPhone 4 can play your videos on a larger screen. However, you can't currently output direct from a phone to a TV to watch in HD. You can use Apple's Composite AV Cable (£39) to watch your videos on a TV, but you'll be watching at Standard Definition – 576p or 480p.

You can send your HD videos to watch at 1,024 x 768 on a computer monitor though, if you use a Dock connector to VGA Adaptor (the Apple branded one costs £25). This will let you watch in full HD. There are a number of ways to share your HD videos to get them on a computer, where they can then be burnt to a DVD and watched on your HD TV. You can email them provided they're not too large, and you can also import them using iPhoto or Image Capture on a Mac, or via the My Computer window on a PC.

Video formats



Having trouble getting a video to play on your iPhone? Make sure it fits one of these formats...

H.264
Up to 720p, 30fps, Main Profile level 3.1
Audio: AAC-LC up to 160Kbps, 48kHz, stereo
File types: .m4v, .mp4, .mov

MPEG-4
Up to 2.5Mbps, 640 x 480 pixels, 30fps, Simple Profile
Audio: AAC-LC up to 160Kbps per channel, 48kHz, stereo
File types: .m4v, .mp4, and .mov

Motion JPEG (M-JPEG)
Up to 35Mbps, 1,280 x 720 pixels, 30fps
Audio: ulaw, PCM stereo
File type: .avi

Getting yout videos onto your computer

How to import your clips

Here's how to get the movies you've shot on your iPhone 4 onto your computer to edit or share.

Mac

The Mac OS X operating system has a few built-in programs that'll do this for you. When you plug in your iPhone, iPhoto should open automatically and display your iPhone pictures and videos. You can import from there.

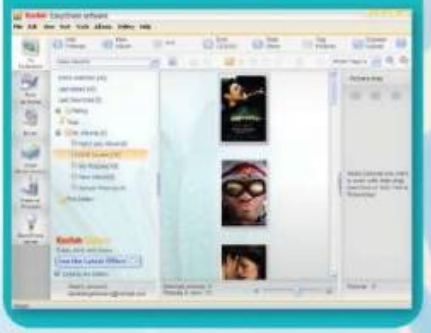


OS X also comes with Image Capture, an application that lets you quickly import photos to a location you define. You'll find it in your Applications folder on your Mac. If you prefer Image Capture, you can set it to open every time you connect your iPhone.



PC

On a PC, your iPhone should show up in your 'My Computer' folder when you connect it, in the same way that a digital camera does. If it doesn't, you can use your digital camera software to import your photos and videos. If you don't have any installed, download Kodak EasyShare from the 'Organize, Print & Share' section of the Kodak website (www.kodak.com).



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Movie-making apps

The best HD movie apps...

iMovie

URL www.apple.com/uk
Price £2.99



iMovie on the iPhone is an inspired port – Apple has stripped down its desktop consumer video-editing application to create a fun but powerful iPhone app.

The app gives you access to the video clips in your camera roll, and also lets you shoot a fresh clip inside the app. You can select a theme for your sequence, which gives you preset transitions and optional music, and trimming down clips on the touchscreen is intuitive and simple.

It could do with custom soundtracks and better export options, but other than that it's a simple step up to editing your HD videos.

CinemaFX for Video

URL www.nexvio.com
Price £1.19



CinemaFX for Video lets you get creative with your video clips by giving you a number of special effects to apply to your footage. The results can be creative or wacky, depending on the effects you use and your skill at setting them up.

The app comes with 26 different effects, including basic ones such as sepia and vignette. You also get a raft of 20 'Cinematic' effects that features retro effects as well as wacky ones such as heat and night vision.

There are two effects packs ('Toycam' and 'Vintage') that you have to purchase in-app to get the really cool period effects (such as 70s vintage and customisable film grain), but the effects look great and it's easy to use.

Vintage Video Maker

URL http://macphun.com
Price £1.19



Vintage Video Maker is another special effects app, but it focuses on retro effects. We love that you can add loads of grain and flickering, a piano soundtrack, and speed the video up to make it look and sound exactly like a 1920s silent movie.

You can also add your own soundtracks from your computer via a WiFi FTP connection, which is a welcome feature, if a bit fiddly.

The app has five different effects, as well as options for tweaking the resolution size and the video speed. Once you're ready, processing takes quite a long time, but the results are placed automatically into your camera roll.

YouTube your vids

Here's how to publish your videos to YouTube once you've shot them...

1 With your video selected in the Photos app, tap to bring up the options, tap the share arrow and hit 'Send to YouTube'.



2 Sign into your YouTube account. If you haven't got an account, you can create one on your computer, or using the YouTube app on your iPhone. If you're a gmail user, your account information should be the same.



3 You then have to enter a few details for the video, such as a title, tags, and category. When you're happy with your upload, press 'Publish' in the top-right.



ReelDirector

URL www.nexvio.com
Price £2.39





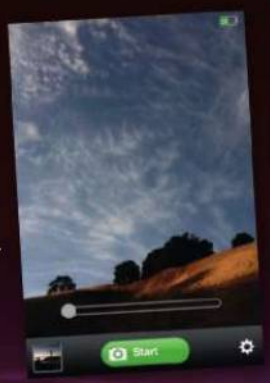
Before iMovie for the iPhone came along, ReelDirector was the main contender when it came to handheld video editing. However, there are several differences to Apple's own app. At the time of writing, iMovie only works on the iPhone, while ReelDirector also works with iOS 4 on the iPod touch, provided you have synced some video clips into your Photos app. ReelDirector also lets you import your own soundtrack. It has considerably more transitions when compared to iMovie, too – you can cross dissolve, fade black or white, and even do *Star Wars*-style wipes.

ReelMoments

URL www.nexvio.com
Price £1.19







Another video app from the Nexvio video stable, ReelMoments is an app that allows you to create time lapse footage with your iPhone's camera. Before you start shooting, go into the settings where the app gives you options for the video qualtity, shutter interval, and playback framerate.

You can also set a maximum time to record, and preserve your battery by setting it to stop shooting if your battery falls below a certain level or charge.

If you can set up your iPhone in a fixed position, then the results look just like the time-lapse footage you see on nature programmes.

Results can be emailed or plonked in your camera roll where you can do what you like with them.

Video Panorama

URL www.outmantech.com
Price £1.19







Video Panorama isn't strictly a HD video app, but it does put the HD video camera to clever use. The app creates panoramic images. Most apps approach this by stitching together still images, but Video Panorama gets you to shoot a short, slow video of the panorama. It then cuts up the video and stitches frames together to create a panoramic photo.

Like all panoramic creation software, it works best if you use a tripod to make sure your footage is smooth, and it also works best when there isn't much in the foreground of the shot. For £1.19, it's worth a try.

Computer cutting room

The lowdown on desktop video-editing software...

iMovie '09

URL www.apple.com/ilife/imovie
Price Preinstalled on all Macs. £71 to upgrade from an older version

iMovie brings powerful video tools to consumers in very clever ways. At its heart is a viewer that lets you see all your video clips, and a control method called 'skimming' – simply roll your mouse over the thumnails to select the start frame of a clip. You then drag and drop clips into the Project Window. These clips can be dragged around to re-order them. It's really intuitive.



Windows Movie Maker 2

URL www.microsoft.com
Price Preinstalled on Windows XP, Vista, and 7

Microsoft's answer to iMovie is Movie Maker, which comes installed on a new PC. The interface consists of a list of your clips on the left, a viewer on the right, and a storyboard at the bottom. You can view



clips in the viewer and then drag clips into the timeline at the bottom to place them in your movie. They can be dragged and dropped into a different order.

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iPod touch

The new iPod touch is a breathtaking piece of kit



iPod touch
Company Apple **URL** www.apple.com/uk/ipodtouch
Price 8GB £189, 32GB £249, 64GB £329

You know the story by now. For many, the iPod touch is the iPhone without the phone and GPS features. It's also the iPhone without the contract.

Now comes the fourth-generation model, a little lighter than its predecessor and with a slew of new features, including the high-resolution Retina display, a built-in microphone and a speaker, and two cameras (for high-definition video on the back, and FaceTime video on the front). It also boasts Apple's A4 processor for faster performance.

The built-in mic and speaker mean that you don't need any extra hardware to turn the iPod touch into a phone, using a VoIP app like Skype or Truphone. Though the mic is on the back of the iPod, it's more than sensitive enough to pick up your voice. And the speaker is audible enough to carry on a conversation.

Look, no hands

Thanks to the built-in mic, you can also control the iPod touch hands-free: simply press the Home button until the Voice Control screen appears. However, this works only for playing music.

> **"A portable gaming machine that is leagues ahead of anything else on the market"**

Like the iPhone 4, the fourth-generation iPod touch has a 960 x 640 pixel Retina display. It's so good that it's impossible to make out individual pixels – images are very, very clean and you can make the display very bright. Unlike the iPhone 4, however, the new iPod touch display probably doesn't have IPS (in-plane switching) technology which lends a wider viewing angle (Apple was probably trying to keep costs down here).

Thanks to the A4 processor, also used in the iPhone 4 and iPad, the new iPod touch is noticeably more responsive than older models – and even better for gaming.

The iPod touch is wildly popular, with good reason. It's an extremely versatile device, and this latest update turns it into a camcorder and video phone too. And with its speedy A4 processor, gyro controls and Retina display, it's a more compelling proposition for gaming than ever.

Christopher Breen & Mark Hattersley

THE SKINNY...

Likes FaceTime video chat, stunning Retina display, gyro controls, built-in mic and HD video recording

Dislikes No GPS, display isn't quite as good as the iPhone 4's, can get hot

Rating: ★★★★★



Gaming power-up

The iPod touch is a better gaming machine than ever

The iPod touch has always been great for gaming, and the new faster processor, plus gyro controls and the superb Retina display, make for an even better gaming experience. Combine all this with the Game Center app included in iOS 4.1, and the result is a portable gaming console that's leagues ahead of anything else on the market.

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FaceTime and the iPod touch

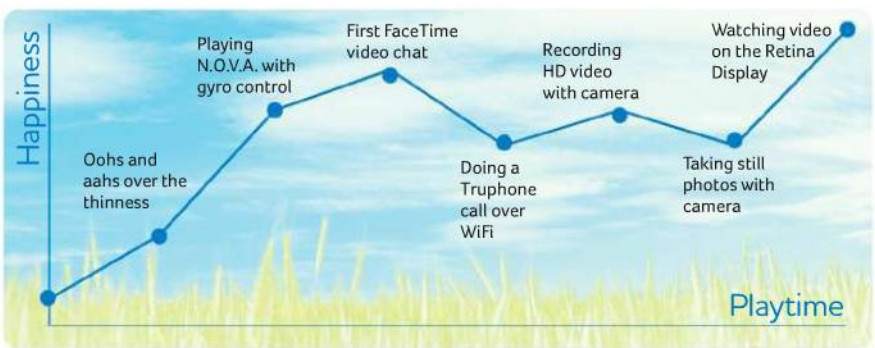
Chat to your mates using the built-in video camera

With the cameras comes FaceTime, and it works very much as it does on the iPhone 4. That means you have the option to switch between the front- and rear-facing camera, though it's the front camera that Apple has designed for use with FaceTime. Your voice is picked up by the built-in mic which, though on the back of the iPod – and thus facing away from you if you are using the front camera – is sensitive enough to deliver good results. And the internal speaker is loud enough that you can easily hear the person you're talking to.



iPad & iPhone User says...

The iPod touch has always been the all-singing all-dancing Pod, and this fourth-generation model takes it to a whole new level, incorporating many of the best features from the iPhone 4. Gamers in particular will love the new gyro gaming experience



Thumbs up

Dual cameras

One on the front; and another on the rear – the twin cameras mean you can capture HD video and make FaceTime video calls to your mates via Wi-Fi.

Gyroscope

Gyro controls mean the iPod touch can sense roll, yaw and direction. In practical terms this means the display moves with what you're pointing at. This makes first-person games react as you move around, for the ultimate in realism.

Voice Control

Now that it has built-in mic, you can use Voice Control to activate music playback on the iPod touch. Say 'play Kings of Leon' and the relevant tracks will fire up. We find it's a bit cranky with a British accent, but fun to play with.

Retina display

Packing an amazing 326 pixels per inch, the iPod touch's display is stunning. Games and videos look amazing, and the text is completely crisp, so you can read entire books on your device.

Remote control

Thanks to iOS 4.1, the fourth-generation iPod touch provides better support for AVRCP (Audio/Video Remote Control Profile) – a Bluetooth profile that lets you control playback with A2DP devices such as headphones and speakers. This means you can control and stream audio to speakers and headphones wirelessly.

Thumbs down

No GPS

As with previous iPod touches this one has no GPS hardware. It uses WiFi location data to determine its coordinates.

Camera's not as hot

The iPod touch's cameras are not identical to those in the iPhone 4. Still, while the results aren't as good as those delivered by the iPhone 4 or one of the better HD pocket camcorders, the iPod touch does shoot reasonable-looking video.

Display angles

The display isn't quite as good as the iPhone 4's, and it isn't as visible at extreme angles. It's rumoured that the iPod touch display doesn't have the IPS technology used in the iPhone 4. This would make sense given the much lower price of the iPod touch.

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REVIEWS

iPod nano

Available in the same 8GB and 16GB capacities but in seven new colours



iPod nano
Company Apple **URL** www.apple.com/uk/ipodnano
Price 8GB £129, 16GB £159

No iPod model has received as many makeovers – both minor and dramatic – as the iPod nano. But one thing all nano models have had in common is the traditional iPod design: a screen at the top with Apple's click wheel below.

No longer. With the release of the sixth-generation iPod nano, the line has received its most dramatic redesign yet, and the click wheel is nowhere to be found. In its place you'll find a Multi-Touch screen similar to (though much smaller than) the one on Apple's iPhone and iPod touch.

Hip to be square

The new nano, available in the same 8GB and 16GB capacities as before but in seven new colours, still wears an aluminium shell, but it now takes a considerably smaller shape.

On the top of the nano are a Sleep/Wake button and shuffle-like Volume Down and Volume Up buttons. In fact, with its volume buttons, shape and clip, the new nano looks very much like an oversized version of the new iPod shuffle.

If you've ever used an iPhone or an iPod touch, the touch-based interface will be familiar. You press the Sleep/Wake button to turn on the screen, and in place of the traditional iPod interface of hierarchical menus listing functions and media, you now see 'app' icons floating over a user-configurable background. You swipe up and down to scroll lists of, say, tracks or artists.

For many tasks, the Multi-Touch display and iOS-like interface are dramatic improvements over the older, click wheel-navigated menus. For example, scrolling through a long list of tracks or artists with a few flicks of the finger is as easy on the new nano as it is on an iPhone or iPod touch. You even get the same alphabetic index on the right edge of the screen that lets you quickly jump to, say, tracks starting with the letter R. If track information is too long to fit on the screen, a swipe to the left tells the nano to scroll that information.

Side swipe

And during music playback, you can swipe left and right to switch the screen view between playback controls, playback options (repeat, shuffle, scrubbing and Genius) and lyrics, all of which float over the current track's album art.

Likewise, some features that were present on previous nanos are now much more useful. Perhaps the best example of this is photo viewing: you can flip between pictures by simply flicking your finger across the screen, and you double-tap

THE SKINNY...

Likes Multi-Touch screen and iOS-like interface, FM radio easier to use

Dislikes No physical playback controls, no video recording, no apps

Rating: ★★★★★

Spin me around

Two fingers to the rotating screen

A standout feature made possible by Multi-Touch is that you can rotate the nano's entire interface, 90 degrees at a time, by placing two fingers on the screen and twisting clockwise or counter-clockwise. This is a great option that lets you view the nano's screen right-side-up regardless of how the iPod is clipped or oriented.



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to zoom in and out, just as you would on an iPhone. And tuning the built-in FM radio is much easier too – you just swipe left or right to move the 'dial' in large increments, or make smaller gestures to pinpoint a particular station. Setting presets is as simple as tapping the star at the bottom of the screen.

Also improved is scrubbing through a track, which now works just as it does on iOS devices: drag your finger left or right on the timeline to scrub, and adjust the scrub speed by dragging your finger up or down on the screen. Editing playlists is also dramatically easier, and when rating a track, you just tap the desired rating star, rather than having to "spin" the click wheel to highlight it. (Oddly enough, though, the rating option is hidden behind a tiny 'i' for info button.)

Missing in action

At the same time, the sixth-generation iPod nano is missing quite a few features compared to previous models. Perhaps the most-talked-about relate to video: the built-in video camera that debuted with the fifth-generation nano has died with that model. And unlike with the previous three nano generations, you can no longer sync videos to the nano and watch them on its screen or on your TV. As we noted in our roundup of iPod questions and answers, the new line of iPods clearly divides Apple's portable line into music-only and video-focused devices, and the new iPod nano is on the music side of that fence. Similarly, the new nano loses the capability to play games. Granted, games made for click wheel iPods simply wouldn't work on the new nano, but what's to say a touchscreen nano couldn't play different games?

> "the new iPod touch is a bit of an enigma with its small size and touch screen"

We're fine with those particular changes. We know I don't speak for all iPod nano owners, but both as a user and from talking with other iPod users, the fifth-generation nano's video capabilities – both recording and watching – went unused (or were underused) by many.

The problem was that the screen was too small for watching video, the camera's quality was mediocre.



Tiny touchscreen The nano's touchscreen can be a bit fiddly due to its tiny size

iPad & iPhone User says...

The new iPod nano is a bit of an enigma, with its compactness and touch screen. At first it will generate oohs and aahs, and in many cases provide genuine, even substantial, benefits. On the other hand, the interface suffers from being confined to a tiny screen. Perhaps it's better to think of the new iPod nano as version 1.0 of a completely new device. And being an early adopter is always fun.

Dan Frakes

iPod shuffle

A little clip-on model with easy-to-navigate controls



Shuffle shades The aluminium body comes in five colours

iPod shuffle
Company Apple
URL www.apple.com/uk/ipodshuffle
Price 2GB £39

One of our favourite iPods of all time was the second-generation iPod shuffle. On the other hand, the third-generation iPod shuffle was an example of Apple's design language taken to an extreme. Gone were the onboard controls, leaving most users scratching their heads as to how to work it.

That was a step too far, so the new shuffle is a little guy with a clip-on body and a circle of easy-to-navigate control buttons. While the previous shuffle was rectangular, this new shuffle is almost perfectly square, shaving off a third of the old model's size.

While it's admirable that Apple continues its quest to create the smallest products possible – a statement we might now amend to 'the smallest products possible without abandoning all on-device controls' – the fourth-generation shuffle poses a small usability problem. There's no room for you to grip the device while you operate the buttons (or try to prise open the clip).

As a result, it is much more awkward to squeeze open the clip and attach it to your clothing. However, that small problem aside, this is still a great device to just clip on and go for a run around the park.

> "still a great device to just clip on and go for a run around the park"

THE SKINNY...

Likes On-device controls, VoiceOver navigation, long battery life

Dislikes Awkward to clip on, no way to lock out controls from accidental bumps

Rating: ★★★★★

iPad & iPhone User says...

This is a classic design that works well now the buttons are back. At £39 for 2GB of storage, it's not only the perfect entry-level iPod but also a solid second device for iPhone users who want to keep it simple while exercising. Throw in the VoiceOver features and the improved battery life, and it's easy to say that this looks to be the best iPod shuffle Apple has ever made.

Jason Snell

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Fidelio DS9000

Curvy iPod hi-fi system from Philips



Product name
Company Philips **URL** www.philips.co.uk
Price £399.95

Philips whipped up high expectations in the iPad & iPhone User office with its dark wood, intriguingly shaped Fidelio DS9000. Not to mention the fact that its living room design aesthetic and £400 price tag puts it in direct competition with the big boys of iPod docking speakers such as the Bowers & Wilkins Zeppelin.

The unit delivers in part on it's promise. The design is indeed lush – it's reassuringly heavy, and the curious hole through the middle creates an impressive pedestal for your iPod or iPhone. The dock connector itself is tilted backwards on a spring, with a back rest on the surface of the speaker. This means that any iPhone or iPod placed on the dock will be held relatively sturdily. The DS9000 certainly looks £400 worth of iPod hi-fi kit.

The curved back isn't just for the sake of it – Philips claims that it's used layered wood and employed a special process to bend it into shape for an improved sound. It's designed to reduce unwanted vibrations, and the rubber foot on the bottom has a similar purpose.

> "The Fidelio DS9000 is designed to take **pride of place in your living room**"

The sound is pumped through Philips' PureDigital sound processing technology, before it gets to the speakers – two low-distortion tweeters handle the top end while two inverted dome woofers take care of bassiness.

We actually found the bass playback to be the main problem with the fidelio DS9000. It certainly pumps out a healthy rumble, but it's not terribly tuneful. Otherwise, the sound of the unit is pretty good, if a little clinical. If you don't fixate on the hulking bass, the sound is clear, and sounds good when you crank it up a bit.

That hefty price tag may play on your mind a bit, but it's beside the point. The Fidelio DS9000 is designed product to take pride of place in your living room, and that's what you're paying for.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Lovely design with luxurious look and feel, decent sound

Dislikes We're not sure it sounds good enough for £400, the app doesn't add much

Rating: ★★★★★

iPad & iPhone User says...

The sound doesn't deliver on Philips' audiophile protestations, but real audiophiles are likely to spend even more than £400 for their sounds. The Fidelio DS9000 is a fine example of a premium iPhone speaker. It's by no means the best premium iPhone speaker sound-wise, but if you set your heart on that curvy look it'll serve you fine.

Andy Penfold

The Fidelio app

Using Philips' iPhone app with the DS9000...

Plug your iPhone or iPod touch into your Fidelio DS9000 and you'll be prompted asked if you'd like to download the Fidelio app. It's a novel idea – you can use it to control your Fidelio's graphic equaliser settings and also set it up as an alarm clock that'll play your tunes or a preset sound at the set time.

The graphic EQ sliders are something of a blunt instrument for adjusting tone, as the five sliders represent a wide range of frequencies. The interface is also a little hooky – you have to wait around for the iPod controls to disappear before you can press the 'i' to access the EQ and bass-boosting settings.



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V-Moda Crossfade LP

Cyberman styling and booming sound from V-Moda

From the biker-style silver frets adorning the exterior to the cushioned leather interior, the V-Moda Crossfade LP headphones are anything but ordinary. Even then the headstrap has a subtle snakeskin effect. Part fashion item (V-Moda also has a successful clothing range), part DJ wear, the Crossfade LP headphones have serious attitude.

Their design has been tested to destruction and shown to withstand more than a million assaults on the headstrap, cable attachments and the arms holding the earpieces themselves in place. in short, they won't break.

The heavy-duty credentials extend, of course, to the sound. Bass fans will rejoice. They can also do subtle reasonably well. Faced with a mixture of thumping beats and lighter tones, however, we found them lacking a little depth, which is a slight worry considering the price tag.

Usefully, V-Moda packs in an inline microphone and track play/pause button so you can take calls from your iPhone. The Kevlar cord also comes with adapters for a hi-fi, iPhone or laptop headphone connector.

> "The Crossfade LP headphones have serious attitude"

The whole caboodle comes in a highly unusual snakeskin-clad moulded plastic casing with a dust cloth with which to clean nasty fingerprints off those distinctive silver shields.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Huge sound, massive bass, comfortable, virtually indestructable

Dislikes Bass-heavy, expensive

Rating: ★★★★★



iPad & iPhone User says...

The V-Moda Crossfade LP headphones are bass-heavy and exceptionally comfortable. They're real lookers (and come in a range of colours) and are just the thing for dance and rock tracks with lots of bass. You may end up with a headache after prolonged use, but you probably won't want to stop using them.

Rosemary Hattersley

Robot ears The Crossfades come in a range of colours

Headphones
Company V-Moda
URL www.v-moda.com
Price £229

HF3

STAR BUY

Etymotic help you protect your hearing with its latest sound isolating earphones



There are a few differences between Etymotic's HF3 earphones and the HF2 model that they replaced. The one that makes the biggest difference is that the 3.5mm jack is angled. We were happy using the superb HF2 headphones only for the straight jack to develop a lose connection. This new design rectified the fault, so we are confident that the problem will not be encountered on the HF3.

The most obvious difference between the new and old headphones is the introduction of a three-button headset, letting you pause, adjust volume and navigate through music tracks. Previously there was one button to pause, move to the next track, or repeat a track, now two extra buttons bring the addition of volume controls.

When a call comes in answering it is a button click away. The integrated high sensitivity mic works well and we had few complaints from the caller on the other end of the line, other than that we were a bit quiet. This at least beats the usual complaint we've had with other headsets: that the ambient noise, from traffic or crowds, was deafening.

> "The HF3 offer breadth and clarity"

As you would expect for a set of headphones that cost £130, the HF3 offer breadth and clarity, with rich detailed musical reproduction. With a good fit in the ear canal (a variety of ear pieces large and small are provided) you can expect excellent noise isolation and superb treble and midrange clarity. The bass is just right, rather than overpowering or non-existent.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Excellent noise cancellation and superb sound reproduction, high-end technology for a mid-range price

Dislikes Price is higher than the (£99) HF2s they replace

Rating: ★★★★★

iPad & iPhone User says...

We found that the Shure headphones we compared the HF3s too were a little too bassy for our liking. We also found the HF3 mic was ideally placed for making calls, while the Shure mic hung down our front and needed to be held up to our mouth if we were to be heard. Sound wise though, you can't go far wrong with the HF3s.

Karen Haslam

Headphones
Company Etymotic
URL www.etymotic.com
Price £130

Scan: worldmags®

Parrot AR.Drone

It's safe to say this is the first flying iPhone accessory...



THE SKINNY...

Likes Stupendous fun, flies really high, software is simple and it works

Dislikes Hull is vulnerable, more apps would increase scope for play

Rating: ★★★★★

Product name
Company Parrot **URL** http://ardrone.parrot.com
Price £299

It's easy to see why the Parrot AR.Drone has received much attention since it was unveiled in January at the annual Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas. It is, after all, a toy helicopter that you control via WiFi with your iPad, iPhone or iPod touch. It's fun.

The AR.Free Flight software puts basic controls for the AR.Drone on the screen of your device. While it works on an iPad, it's designed for the screen size of an iPhone or iPod touch. If your device has motion sensors, you can apply a tilt to make the AR.Drone fly in the same direction.

As you might expect, flying indoors requires a lot of space and minimal obstructions. This is when Parrot suggests using the 'indoor hull', with circular bumpers that ring the propellers and protect them. The indoor hull did indeed do its job, but within two days ours had fractured in several places. We repaired the first few fractures with superglue and let the repairs sit overnight, but the next day the hull would break in a new place.

> **"Flying outdoors is fun: the AR.Drone can climb high and show its agility"**

Parrot offers 'mending tape' for about a tenner and even has an online video about how to fix the hull. If yours is beyond repair – ours eventually broke into pieces – you can buy a replacement for about £40. At least the main body of the AR.Drone, including its propellers, is forgiving. We accidentally crashed several times outdoors, and the propellers and body stayed intact.

In low wind, outdoor flying proved much easier than indoor flight and allowed the AR.Drone to climb quite high. It was also much more fun as the drone is agile and can fly quickly in any direction.

Charging the battery takes 90 minutes and delivers around 15 minutes of flight. The software displays a battery gauge and once it hits 12 percent, the drone will gently land.

iPad & iPhone User says...

Once you're comfortable with the controls, the AR.Drone is a lot of fun to fly. The protective indoor hull suffered frequent fractures, but the rest of the toy was quite durable. If you'll be flying a lot, a spare battery would come in handy. Ultimately, the success of the AR.Drone will hinge on what third-party apps and games are created for it.

Nick Barber

Apps for a chopper?

Flying isn't the only possibility

The basic AR.Free Flight software lets you to control the AR.Drone and monitor the video feed from its two cameras. It also allows you to adjust the tilt sensitivity as well as the vertical speed and yaw speed. But why confine yourself to flying? Parrot has a game in the works that will allow AR.Drones to indulge in virtual dogfights with no damage to the craft themselves, and is encouraging developers to create other apps for the toy chopper.



Helicopter vision
The AR.Drone's cameras point ahead and down

Scan: worldmags®

Case Round-Up: Four signal-preserving skins for the iPhone 4

Company Incipio **URL** www.myincipio.com
Price £14.79 (www.amazon.co.uk)

STAR BUY

Incipio Feather



The Incipio Feather is the smartest, least conspicuous iPhone case we've seen so far, and as such it is a huge success. It's a very thin hard shell that covers the back and sides of the unit and incorporates a screen protector.

The Feather has a soft finish and feels good in the hand. It has cutaways for all the buttons and the camera lenses. We found the fit slightly less snug after several cycles of putting it on the phone and taking it off, so we'd recommend leaving it on once it's on.

The black model makes for a barely noticeable cover, but if you want to make your case more of a statement, you'll be pleased to hear the Feather comes in 11 other colours and shades. It's certainly the most stylish way to fix up that antenna we've tried so far.

Andy Penfold

THE SKINNY...

Likes Stylish, very thin and understated

Dislikes Not suited to being taken off repeatedly

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Griffin **URL** www.griffintechnology.com
Price £14.90

FREE with iPhone 4 Case Program

Motif



Griffin Technology's Motif is the closest thing to a soft-silicone case available via the iPhone 4 Case Program, but its material, thermoplastic urethane (TPU) is smoother and shinier than most silicone skins.

The Motif's material is thin enough that the case doesn't add much bulk to the phone, yet this offers more protection against drops and bumps than some other cases featured in the iPhone 4 Case Program. However, as with all the cases in the Program, the Motif leaves the iPhone's screen exposed.

Perhaps the most notable thing about the Motif is that the interior of the back is sculpted into a diamond-lens pattern. Together with the glossy exterior, this gives the back a striking and highly distinctive look.

Dan Frakes

THE SKINNY...

Likes Unusual looks, protects against bumps

Dislikes Detracts somewhat from iPhone design

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Proporta **URL** www.proporta.com
Price £19.95

Mizu Shell



A silicone case, Proporta's Mizu Shell has a shiny plastic feel and isn't sticky like a lot of skins made of the same material. It doesn't cover the iPhone's screen, but the lip over the front helps prevent scratches if you lay the phone face down on a table.

We didn't find the case too stretchy, so it should fit well even after being taken off a few times. You shouldn't have to remove the case often anyway – it worked with most of our docking systems.

The case does lend a certain visual quirkiness to the iPhone, adding a translucent border as viewed from the front, though the see-through greyish back is less attractive. The Proporta logo scratches off easily, too, but you may not mind that.

Andy Penfold

THE SKINNY...

Likes Protect from scratches, hard-wearing

Dislikes Looks a bit 'kiddie' compared to bare iPhone

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Scosche **URL** www.scosche.com
Price £19.99

metalliKASE G4

THE SKINNY...

Likes Subtle and unobtrusive

Dislikes Mirrored screen protector detracts from display

Rating: ★★★★★

The Scosche metalliKASE is a wrap-around affair that clips on to and protects the sides and back of the iPhone 4.

It's thin and quite subtle in some ways, but on the other hand it's made out of chrome-effect polycarbonate and looks like a mirror. Not that it's a bad look, since it's reminiscent of the original iPhone.



The metalliKASE is supplied with a mirrored screen protector that you apply to the display. When it's fitted, it has the effect of turning the whole of the iPhone into a mirror if the screen is powered down. However the protector can detract from the colour and clarity of the display in normal use. It also reduces the viewing angle of the screen, which in some ways is a good thing if you're tapping in passwords on the bus, for example.

The metalliKASE G4 leaves all the ports and sockets accessible, has an area cut out of the rear for the camera and flash, and it looks cool too.

Mark Hattersley

Scan: worldmags®

Headphones
Company Jaybird
URL www.jaybirdgear.com
Price £99

Jaybird SB2

Wireless headphones that look better than they sound

Bluetooth headphones have mattered for iPhone users ever since iOS 3.0, which introduced A2DP stereo Bluetooth functionality. We found Bluetooth pairing quite easy with Jaybird's SB2 headset, though there's a slight quirk when turning the headset on – you have to hold the power button for just the right length of time so that the little light flashes red and blue. If you get it wrong, the light will just flash blue, and pairing it to your iPhone doesn't go anywhere. Once pairing is set up, though, the headphones work pretty well.

The JB2 is pretty comfortable and has a retro quality – we like the way it looks. Some of the available colours look really great, particularly those that are plain white on the outside and coloured on the inside. The packaging is very sport-oriented, and while these headphones are quite tight-fitting, they should be largely suitable for gym work, providing you don't have the Paula Radcliffe head nodding running style.

Cordless phones Sleek but a little muddy on the ear



> "They look great, particularly if they are white outside and coloured inside"

THE SKINNY...

Likes Cool range of colours and good looks, easy to set up

Dislikes Sound a bit flat, controls on the earpieces aren't ideal

Rating: ★★★★★

The only downside is the sound – it's quite flat and muddy.

iPad & iPhone User says...

Despite its great looks, the SB2 is merely adequate for casual listening or when you're out and about. It is an improvement on the iPhone's earbuds, but for the price you can get stonking-sounding wired headphones.

Wayne Jarvis

T12 v2 soundbar

Big sound from a soundbar and subwoofer for iPod and TV

The relaunched T12 v2 from British audio specialists Orbitsound combines a stereo soundbar and subwoofer with an iPod dock, making it suitable for pumping out music or the audio output from a TV or home cinema system. The company claims the T12 v2 takes advantage of its unique 'spatial stereo' technology, offering a full-bodied and detailed sound from a fairly modest setup.

While Orbitsound insists the T12 v2 doesn't require any lengthy positioning experiments to find that 'sweet spot' the soundbar is hardly plug-and-play. You might need help just getting everything out of the box as it all weighs a fair amount (8kg), and there's a selection of cables and a remote to sort as well. The subwoofer especially feels too big and bulky for its own good. That said, we had everything up and running in less than 10 minutes.

The remote supplied does a fair job of controlling anything docked, including scrolling through iPod and iPhone menus and playlists, as well as switching between dock and TV. The treble and bass controls offer some fine-tuning, although it can confuse matters when setting up. In any case the sound proved rich in detail and clarity, whatever style of music we tried it out on.

> "The sound proved rich in detail and clarity whatever the style of music"

THE SKINNY...

Likes Good sound, excellent range of inputs, solid build, fully featured remote

Dislikes Subwoofer feels like overkill, can be time-consuming to set up

Rating: ★★★★★



Raising the bar The T12 v2 soundbar sounds good, but its price tag is hardly modest

iPad & iPhone User says...

In a pleasingly neutral black, the T12 v2 stacks up well against more pricey and substantial home cinema setups. That said, it doesn't come cheap itself and needs time to set up to get the best out of it.

Nick Spence

Stereo soundbar
Company Orbitsound
URL www.orbitsound.com
Price £299

Scan: worldmags®

Power Spring 4

A welcome booster for the power-hungry



Expert in producing battery/case hybrids, MiLi has updated its Power Spring offering to fit the iPhone 4. The Power Spring 4 packs a higher-capacity battery than its predecessor – up to 1,600mAh from 1,200mAh. The battery in the iPhone 4 performs better than that in the 3GS anyway, so with the Power Spring 4 you should get good usage out of the gadget before you have to charge it conventionally.

We ran our iPhone 4's battery down completely, then turned on the Power Spring 4. It gave us an extra six hours of video playback, a hefty boost indeed. If you're not into power-hungry applications, you should get a lot of extra use out of your iPhone with the Power Spring 4.

It doesn't activate automatically – instead, you decide when to press the power button to make it start driving your iPhone 4. The Power Spring 4 almost doubles the thickness of the phone, but it doesn't add too much weight. It's well designed too, blending in by allowing the phone to sits perfectly flush in the case. There's a massive cut-out in the back for the camera and flash, too.

> "It gave us an extra six hours of video playback – that's a hefty boost indeed"

THE SKINNY...

Likes Good snug design, provides a big boost to battery life

Dislikes Bulky

Rating: ★★★★★

Juice from a case Chunkiness is a small price to pay for plenty of extra power

iPad & iPhone User says...

Though it does detract from the iPhone 4's looks to a degree, the Power Spring 4 is an attractive compromise design-wise, and it will be welcomed by users who regularly struggle with the iPhone's battery.

Wayne Jarvis

Case with built-in battery
Company MiLi
URL www.iphonemili.com
Price £55

v-JAYS

A decent set of headphones at a decent price

Headphones
Company Jays
URL www.jays.se
Price £59.99



Ear foam Check out the v-JAYS old-school Walkman-era styling

V-JAYS are a small, lightweight pair of headphones with foam earpads. To us, in many ways they seem reminiscent of Sony Walkman earphones circa 1980. We're not sure this is a good thing – they feel a bit plasticky, to be honest. Indeed, they sort of remind us of the pre-iPod era when portable music could be pretty terrible to listen to.

Which is why it came as a pleasant surprise that the v-JAYS' sound turned out to be quite good. These headphones are never going to win any awards from hi-fi purists, but they do deliver decent volume and bass for such an inexpensive product.

What's more, being so lightweight (they weigh only 59g) has its advantages, both in terms of comfort and portability. They feel good in use, and unlike some over-ear headphones in ths price bracket, don't hurt your ears after a few hours use.

The v-JAYS are perfect for taking on holiday with you, particularly if you find in-ear models uncomfortable.

> "They are good value, build quality is decent and they can even fold away"

THE SKINNY...

Likes Small and light, beefy audio, fold up into small package

Dislikes Styling is a bit dated, foam feels a bit cheap

Rating: ★★★★★

iPad & iPhone User says...

They're not the beefiest-looking headphones, but they do deliver surprisingly good sound. At £59 they're good value, the build quality is reasonable, and they even fold away into a small package you can easily carry around in your pocket. All this makes them a tempting choice, particularly if you're looking for traditional over-ear headphones.

Mark Hattersley

Scan: worldmags®

Apps Round-Up: Three iPad games reviewed

Company Electronic Arts **URL** www.ea.com/ipad **Price** £5.99

Mirror's Edge for iPad



Welcome to dystopia. In Mirror's Edge, society is 'perfect', and government surveillance aims to keep it that way while, naturally, ignoring or suppressing the underclass. Cue 'runners'. The heroes of the age, these fearless athletes use free-running and parkour skills to leap over rooftops, plunge down ventilation shafts and clamber up buildings, passing on messages and avoiding getting shot by guys with really dangerous guns (and, often, hugely dangerous helicopters).

On the iPad, the 3D action of the PC game has been simplified somewhat, with protagonist Faith instead shown in a side-on view. Touchscreen gestures are used along with the accelerometer to control and fine-tune her actions.

> "The outside levels are mostly glorious to play but can be quite linear too"

The game is mostly pleasingly responsive and great to look at. On extended play, however, the environments become samey as they largely centre on building sites and skyscrapers or murky, industrial interiors. Despite the lack of visual variety, the outside levels are mostly glorious to play, although pathways are more linear than you might assume. Gameplay inside buildings tends to become more finicky and fragmented, but at least you have as many shots as you need to complete each level.

Besides the standard storyline mode, Mirror's Edge provides 'speed runs' for completed levels, and you can also challenge friends in a split-screen two-player mode that offers time-attack speed trials and a 'city hunt' for secret packages.

iPad and iPhone User says...

Mirror's Edge is actually pretty similar to the 59p iPhone game Run!, but with Hollywood-style production values. However, the story and wonderful outside sections give it an edge, and the 'infinite continues' model ensures even the toughest levels aren't too frustrating.

Craig Grannell

THE SKINNY...

Likes Simple gameplay with polish and great production

Dislikes Short, pricey, inside levels can be more frustrating than fun

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Gameloft **URL** www.gameloft.com **Price** £5.99

Splinter Cell Conviction HD



Not only has Sam Fisher, protagonist of the Splinter Cell games, seen his daughter killed, he's also been morally compromised by his top-secret spy jobs. As a result he jacks them all in and becomes a double-hard maverick instead.

The game offers 11 levels of 3D stealth action in eight different locations. The on-screen D-pad which lets you run around is responsive enough, but it's not always convenient to find an area of the screen to drag in order to look around. Forget trying to run and look and aim and shoot at the same time – it's impossible.

Graphically it's fantastic, creating an engaging and entertaining, if not desperately challenging experience. The onscreen controls can be a bit awkward, though.

Andy Penfold

THE SKINNY...

Likes Great graphics, fun violent 3D action

Dislikes Controls awkward, not that hard

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Hemisphere Games **URL** hemispheregames.com/osmos/ **Price** £2.99

Osmos for iPad



Most games for iOS are designed for quick thrills. Not Osmos. At its heart, Osmos is a physics-based arcade game, but it's a world away from the frenetic Angry Birds. Here you control a 'mote' – an organic blob – with the aim of absorbing smaller motes. The various levels feature orbital motion and gravitational fields, sentient foes, and hugely chaotic environments where you must move as subtly as possible or risk oblivion.

Osmos is perfectly suited to the iPad. The touch controls are faultless, the graphics beautiful and the soundtrack engaging. There are a few difficulty spikes, but the mix of ambient audio, stunning visuals and a procedural 'arcade' mode with random content keeps you playing until you succeed.

Osmos is destined to be an iPad classic.

Craig Grannell

THE SKINNY...

Likes Intuitive, different, beautiful and engaging. Varying level design. Arcade mode

Dislikes A few difficulty spikes

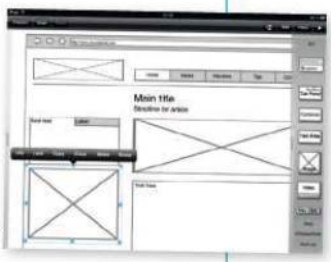
Rating: ★★★★★

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Apps Round-Up: Six of the best iPad apps reviewed

Company Endloop Systems Inc **URL** imockups.com **Price** £5.99

iMockups



Here's an app for rapidly creating mock-ups of websites and apps. It provides you with a number of components that you can drag and drop, and these can be resized, nudged, grouped and locked. The interface is intuitive, if occasionally quirky, and most components intelligently resize.

Likes Quite intuitive. Regularly updated

Dislikes A little clunky

Rating: ★★★★★

Company The Omni Group
URL omnigroup.com/products/omnifocus-ipad **Price** £23.99

OmniFocus for iPad



This task manager in many ways betters its Mac equivalent. You can dump ideas into the inbox and process them later into projects and actions. The app is location-aware, and the forecast view shows imminent, overdue and upcoming tasks. It will be overkill for most, but it's good value if you need robust task management.

Likes Excellent workflow, intuitive

Dislikes Nothing

Rating: ★★★★★

STAR BUY

Company Nevercenter **URL** nevercenter.com/camerabag
Price: £1.79

CameraBag for iPad



CameraBag offers a selection of retro filters to bring a tactile quality to digital snaps. Each comes with variations, frames and crop styles, and components can be mixed and matched. The interface is straightforward, if non-standard, and the results are pleasing. A little more control over filters would be nice, although the app's simplicity makes it usable.

Likes Easily achieves great results

Dislikes A little too simple

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Omer Shoor **URL** mobile-pond.com **Price** £2.39

Photogene for iPad



Some may hanker for an iPad Photoshop, but most people just want to do basic image editing. Enter Photogene, which can crop, sharpen, rotate and resize images, adjust levels and add filters, with multiple undo. It also sends the results to social networking sites. The interface is usable but visually rough – some assets look like upscaled ones from the iPhone app.

Likes Good toolset, easy to use

Dislikes Feels a little rough

Rating: ★★★★★

Company MeteoGroup Deutschland GmbH **URL** weatherpro.eu
Price £2.99

Weather Pro

STAR BUY



The majority of advanced weather iPad apps are bereft of features if you are outside the US, but Weather Pro works worldwide, providing detailed forecasts for the week ahead. Location search results can be saved and accessed via the sidebar, and the rainfall and cloud radars provide more detail than TV forecasts tend to give.

Some users have reported niggles in the interface, and while there's some 'mystery meat' navigation (tap day headers to access three-hour forecasts, for example), we liked the extra graphical components – thermometers, wind-speed dials – shown in portrait view.

Craig Grannell

THE SKINNY...

Likes Information-rich yet usable. Great rainfall radar. Accurate forecasts

Dislikes The user interface has the odd hidden bit

Rating: ★★★★★

Company Silvio Rizzi **URL** reederapp.com **Price** £2.99

Reeder for iPad

STAR BUY



RSS readers for iPad have had plenty of press, due to Pulse getting into a spat with the New York Times and Flipboard inviting all-comers and then not having the capacity to cope. Throughout, the brilliant Reeder has soldiered on and remains best-in-class.

Reeder might not be as pretty as some of its rivals, but it's far more usable and, crucially, it provides a first-rate reading experience. The navigation gives you thumb-based access to unread, next and previous articles (drag gestures can be used too), and the main view uses readable fonts and colours. The built-in web browser is also fit-for-purpose, saving you from having to keep switching to Safari.

Craig Grannell

THE SKINNY...

Likes Superbly designed interface. Decent services integration. Well-chosen fonts

Dislikes Nothing

Rating: ★★★★★

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Guitar effects apps: get stompbox pedals on your iPad

Company IK Multimedia **URL** www.ikmultimedia.com
Price £11.99 (free version also available)

AmpliTube for iPad



With a suitable cable, you can now plug your guitar into your iPad and customise your sounds to your heart's content using AmpliTube for iPad. The full version offers a range of effects pedals, amplifiers and speakers (the free version provides a small selection).

A chromatic tuner and metronome are included too.

At the top of the screen are slots for up to four pedals, each with 'on' and 'off' buttons as well as controls for level, tone and so on. Tapping on the name of the effect, just above the pedal, summons a menu with all 11 available effects, including fuzz, delay and overdrive. The sound is good – through headphones or small speakers. Feed it to a PA, though, and it'll sound terrible.

You can store up to 36 custom presets, but you can't name them and the app doesn't store them as you go – if you swap amps it returns to the defaults. Oddly, you can import and play along with songs in your computer's iTunes library but not those on your iPad.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Great sound, authentic guitar graphics, loads of effects

Dislikes Playing along to music is a pain, sounds poor played loud

Rating: ★★★★★

iPad & iPhone User says...

AmpliTube for iPad is gorgeous to look at, and a clear winner at recreating a boatload of amps and effects. It will truly rock once it is able to record your playing and allows you to play along with the songs in your iPad's music library.

James Galbraith

Company Frontier Design **URL** www.frontierdesign.com **Price** Free

iShred LIVE



Considering the price of AmpliTube, iShred's free effects can't really be knocked. It gives you some fun guitar effects to play with – and it lets you play along to stuff in your iPad's music library, which AmpliTube just can't handle.

iShred comes with a flanger, a delay pedal and a hum noise killer, and more are available to buy. For £1.19 we added the Hot Fuzz overdrive pedal to our virtual effects rack, and there's also a tremolo, chorus and several others available.

Admittedly the effects aren't as good or as customisable as on AmpliTube. The fuzz pedal for example only has one dial on it, so you can't tweak the sound that much.

But it's as a practise tool that iShred really shines. Playing along to a track is as simple as selecting it in the 'Music' section of the app and pressing 'Play'. And for a free app, iShred is pretty full-featured. It can save 48 effects presets and also gives you an excellent tuner.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Great tuner, good bare-bones effects, for free

Dislikes Doesn't sound as good as AmpliTube, and adding useful effects will cost you

Rating: ★★★★★

iPad & iPhone User says...

iShred is a fun app for messing with guitar effects. The chromatic tuner is useful, and the ability to play along to your music is fantastic. Guitar sounds are second best to AmpliTube, though.

Andy Penfold

Wired for sound

How to connect your guitar to your iPad? Here are your options...

To be able to use these apps, you need a way to plug your guitar into your iOS device and to hear the results. The company behind Amplitube also makes iRig, a simple device with a short cable that plugs into your iPad's headphone jack. You plug your guitar into the iRig using a standard instrument cable. Griffin's GuitarConnect includes a 3.5mm headphone plug on one end of the six-foot long cable, while the other end splits into a Y, with a headphone socket and a 1/4-inch plug that goes into your guitar.

iRig

Company IK Multimedia
URL www.ikmultimedia.com
Price £24

Likes Handles clean sounds well, compact design, a more even sound

Dislikes Less good on heavy sounds, requires a separate standard guitar cable

Rating: ★★★★★



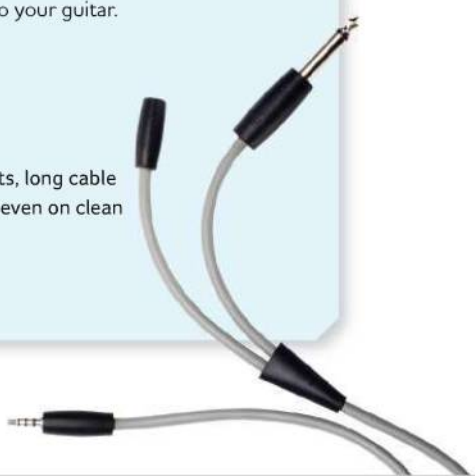
GuitarConnect

Company Griffin
URL www.griffintechnology.com
Price £19.99

Likes Good sound on heavy effects, long cable

Dislikes Tends towards overdrive even on clean sounds

Rating: ★★★★★



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Apps Round-Up: A superb recording studio takes pride of place

Company Halfbrick Studios **URL** www. monsterdashgame.com **Price** 59p

Monster Dash



This takes the basic Canabalt formula (tap to make running guy jump between elevated platforms; avoid falling to an untimely death) and adds monsters and high-powered weapons. The four scenarios are gorgeously rendered, but ultimately the game is nothing new. Second-best to the masterful Run!

Likes Engaging, funny and playable
Dislikes Nothing really new
Rating: ★★★★★

Company Gameloft **URL** www.gameloft.com **Price** 59p

NFL 2011



NFL 2010 was a weak response to EA's Madden, king of American football games. This update boasts smart new graphics, enhanced passing and kicking, and the ability to draw hot routes. However, it stumbles with a number of issues, including a lack of pass blocking. The lack of free-flowing play is another disappointment.

Likes Looks good. Tops NFL 2010
Dislikes Control/AI issues. Complex
Rating: ★★★★★

Company Penpower Technology Ltd
URL worldcard.penpowerinc.com **Price** £3.49

WorldCard Mobile



WorldCard Mobile is another OCR app aiming to save you time entering contact details. The app attempts to extract information from snaps of business cards, and you can be edit its results before exporting them to the Contacts app. It works satisfactorily (the anti-shake option when taking a photo is particularly welcome), especially with white cards, but it's no better than Business Card Reader.

Likes Simple to use. Fairly accurate
Dislikes No better than its rivals
Rating: ★★★★★

Company JayBird Gear LLC **URL** jaybirdgear.com **Price** £2.99

JayBird BluTrax



BluTrax works with Bluetooth headphones to give you some control over your music listening. Clicking through tracks uses the same double- and triple-clicking setup as on the iPhone's wired headphones. You can set how long you get to double-click, and a bar on the app shows you how long you have left to complete the instruction. It all works well, especially if you're using your headphones for running, but can feel superfluous otherwise.

Likes Great for controlling your music while running
Dislikes Expensive for what it does
Rating: ★★★★★

Company Blip Interactive **URL** blipinteractive.co.uk **Price** £8.99

NanoStudio

STAR BUY



When Apple unveiled iMovie for the iPhone 4, the rumour mill started chattering about the possibility of other iLife applications making the jump to iOS.

In particular, rumours were rife about some kind of GarageBand for Apple's portable devices. Apple needn't bother, though, because NanoStudio is here, and it's absolutely stunning.

If you're only interested in five minutes of bashing a virtual piano or smacking a touchscreen drum machine, look elsewhere. However, if you truly want a recording studio in your pocket, then NanoStudio is as near to essential an app as you could hope to find.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Fantastic built-in sounds. Intuitive, well-judged workflow. Top-notch effects and filters

Dislikes NanoSync tool is workmanlike at best

Rating: ★★★★★

NanoStudio does feel a little daunting the first time you run it, but soon the careful consideration that went into the interface becomes apparent. We got a few tracks up and running in no time, easily adding overdubs and new elements, and using live effects. The built-in sounds are great, and there's even a facility that lets you import your own 30-second samples.

> "If you want a recording studio **in your pocket, then NanoStudio is essential**"

Although we had most fun with NanoStudio's live recording, there's also a sequencer which enables you to draw or edit patterns, and copy and paste them to form an entire song. Once you're done, you can use the mixer to amend the mix and use effects to add delay and reverb.

Tracks can be mixed down to WAV format and exported via WiFi using NanoSync, a free download for Mac or Windows from Blip Interactive.

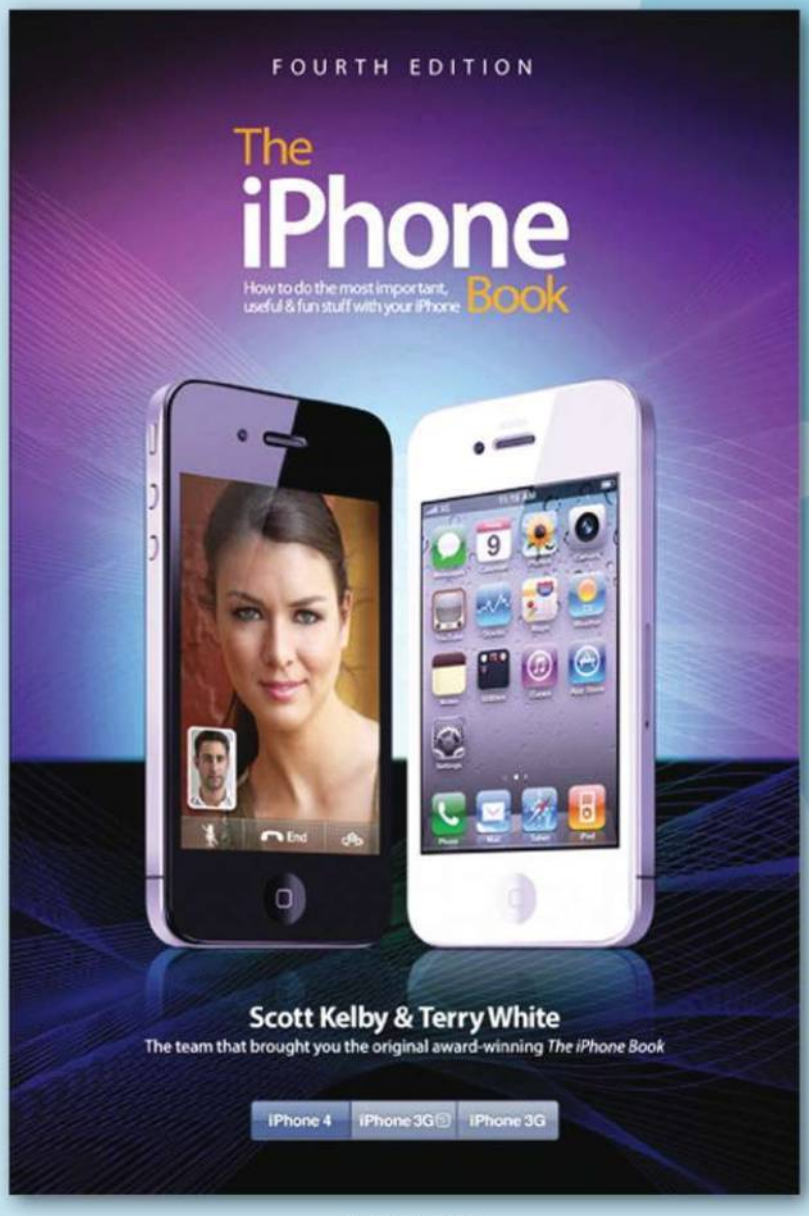
iPad and iPhone User says...

There's a shopping list's worth of stuff we'd love to see in NanoStudio, not least MIDI export. But even if NanoStudio was never updated again, it's already the best app of its kind we've seen. The fact the developer has confirmed numerous improvements are imminent makes NanoStudio not just a great buy but also a brilliant investment.

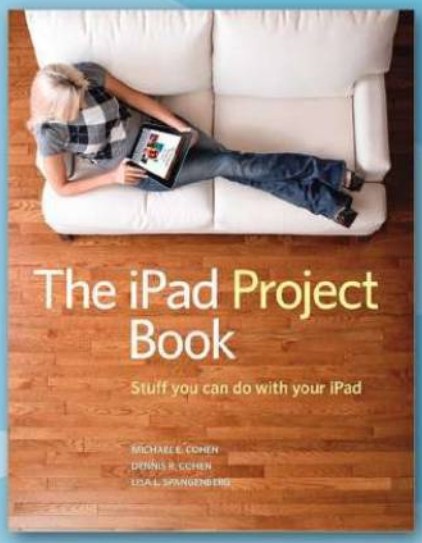
Craig Grannell

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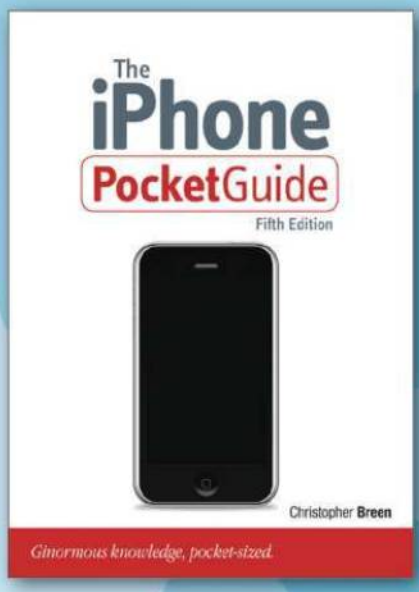
New iPhone and iPad books



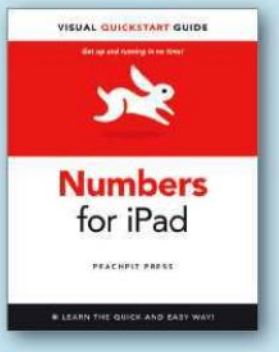
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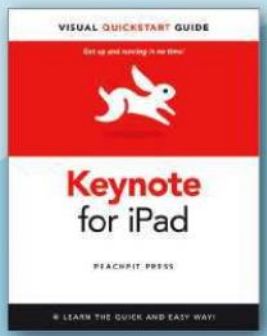
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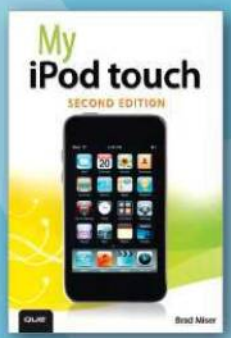
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ALARM CLOCK DOCKS TESTED

Rise and shine

Whether you're bright and breezy in the morning or a total zombie, these alarm clock docks will help you start the day with a song...

By Cliff Joseph



Let's face it – for most of us, waking up in the morning isn't a barrel of laughs. So why not at least try to ease your way into the day by waking up to your favourite tunes on your iPod or iPhone? There's a whole category of alarm clock docks that are specifically designed to live in your bedroom and replace your old clock radio. As you'd expect, these alarm clock docks have certain basic features in common, such as the ability to set alarms, and to wake you up with either your iPod music, a buzzer or a radio alarm. However, there are major differences between them – a basic model with FM radio can cost as little as £50, but if you spend a bit more you can get DAB and even internet radio features from a gadget such as Orbitsound's Radiopod. There's also the portable App Station for travellers, and Sony's multimedia Dream Machine with its fancy video screen. So here's our guide to the top alarm clock docks to cheer you up when you're facing those back-to-work blues on a Monday morning.

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Table top The AlarmDock Reveal is small enough to sit on any bedside table

AlarmDock Reveal

Company Gear4 **URL** www.gear4.com **Price** £49.99

The AlarmDock Reveal is designed to be neat and compact so that you can sit it on a bedside table without taking up too much space.

We thought this compactness might result in a rather weak sound, but the audio quality turns out to be very good. The sound is clean and detailed, with a respectable amount of bass for such a small unit.

It's louder than we expected, too – a 50 per cent volume setting is adequate to wake you up, and you'll probably never need to turn it all the way up in the bedroom.

The unit works pretty well as an alarm clock. You can set two separate alarms, either of which can wake you up to the sound of your iPod music, the radio (there's an FM tuner and the facility to store five favourite stations), or a buzzer.

One handy detail is that you can set the volume level for each alarm, ensuring that you don't wake yourself with the alarm at full blast by mistake.

The entire front edge of the unit acts as an oversized snooze button, so if the alarm sounds and you're not ready to get up, you can just reach across and thump it without even having to open your eyes.

The Reveal works with most iPod and iPhone models, and includes adaptors for a variety of iPods. Gear4 did tell us that the Reveal hasn't been officially certified by Apple for use with the iPhone 4 as it was released just a couple of weeks before the phone. However Gear4 says the iPhone 4 should charge and play perfectly well, and we didn't experience any problems when testing it with our iPhone 4.

Our only minor complaint is that there's no remote control, but that's not a major problem given the Reveal's modest price.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Compact design, good sound quality, big snooze button

Dislikes No remote control, small LCD clock display

Rating: ★★★★★



App Station

Company iLuv **URL** www.i-luv.com **Price** £70

This is a bit of an odd one. Strictly speaking, the App Station isn't an alarm clock – it's a portable speaker unit that lets you use your iPod or iPhone to set and play alarms.

Used with an iPod classic or iPod nano, it lets you set alarms using the iPod's built-in clock and alarm functions. If you've got an iPod touch or iPhone, you can download the free iLuv app for enhanced alarm features. The app uses the full iPhone/iPod screen to display the time so you can read it clearly when it's beside your bed. It also shows a two-day weather forecast for your location, and when you're ready to sleep you can adjust the brightness of the screen with a quick flick of your finger.

The App Station doesn't have a radio built in, though, which means that alarms must play either music stored on your iPod/iPhone or an assortment of comedy sound effects included in the iLuv app. It's therefore more limited than most of its rival docks, but the App Station has the advantage of being quite light, compact and able to run off either the mains or six AA batteries. This makes the App Station suitable as a combination travel alarm clock and portable speaker system, and we can see it appealing to jet-lagged business travellers.

It's not as loud as some of its rivals, but it sounded better than we expected. Some space inside the unit is given over to an acoustic chamber that adds a nice, echoing fullness.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Good sound quality, portability, runs off batteries, alarm app displays weather forecast

Dislikes Lack of a built-in radio

Rating: ★★★★★

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TRYOUT: Alarm clock docks



Dream on No mere dock, Sony's Dream Machine plays photos and videos too

THE SKINNY...

Likes 7in screen that displays photos and videos, facility to record your own alarms, lots of radio presets

Dislikes Very expensive, initially complicated to set up

Rating: ★★★★★

STAR BUY

Dream Machine ICF-CL75iP

Company Sony **URL** www.sony.co.uk **Price** £149

It's expensive, but then Sony's Dream Machine packs in a ridiculous range of features. It's built around a 7in LCD display that can be used as a picture frame or to play videos – either stored on your iPod/iPhone, or on a memory card or USB stick that you can plug into the slots on the back (it can also do boring things like displaying the time or iPod track listings).

The screen also has a 'night' mode that automatically fades. And if you want to take your iPod/iPhone with you when you leave home in the morning, you can slide the dock tray back into the body of the unit so that it just looks like an ordinary photo frame.

The built-in radio allows you to set no fewer than 20 FM presets and 10 for AM. We were expecting a dozen alarms but there are in fact only two, though Sony does throw in a little extra option called Fun Wake Up that allows you to record your own wake-up message using the unit's microphone.

Of course, Sony knows a thing or two about sound quality, so this didn't disappoint. Though sound is very clear and bright, a little more bass wouldn't go amiss – but then this is an alarm clock not a boombox. You should find the audio perfectly fine for listening to a bit of music first thing in the morning.

Our only complaint is that the sheer range of features and control buttons can be a bit confusing at times, but if you're looking for more than a basic alarm clock, the Dream Machine really is in a league of its own.

iP88

STAR BUY

Company iHome **URL** ihomeintl.com **Price** £119.95

The dual-dock iP88 is ideal for couples with an iPhone each, or for anyone who lives with others or has more than one Apple gadget. But there's more to it than that eye-catching feature of having two docks.

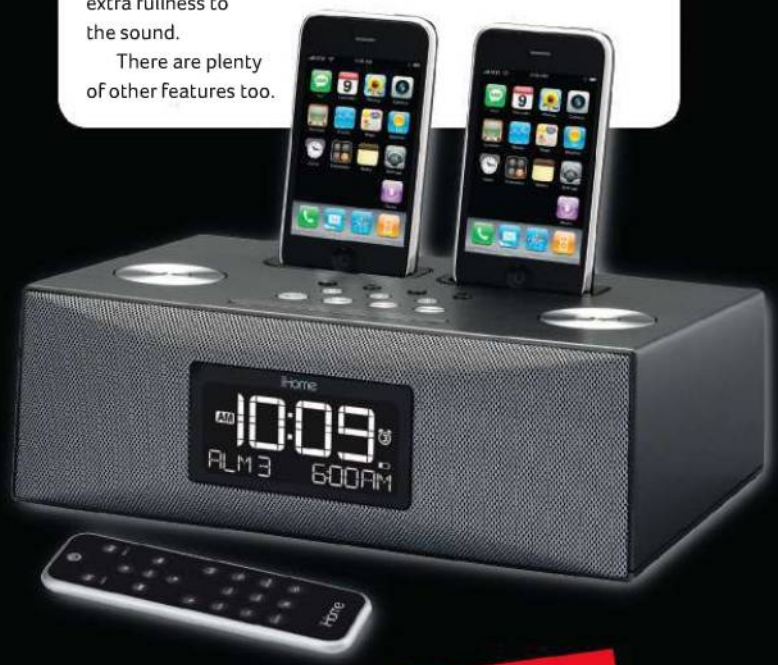
Though the unit takes up a fair amount of space on your bedside cabinet, it does produce a bright, robust sound that will have you bouncing out of bed in the morning. The higher frequencies get a little shrill as you raise the volume, but we found that 70 per cent of maximum was more than loud enough to listen to music while we were working.

You can fine-tune the sound using the separate bass and treble controls, and there's a balance control as well, along with an ambient 3D effect that adds a little extra fullness to the sound.

There are plenty of other features too. The radio lets you store eight preset stations (which have to be on FM unless you have a US model, which offers AM radio too), and you can set three separate alarms that activate either of the two docks, the radio or a buzzer.

The Snooze option can be varied from 1 to 29 minutes, and there's also a Sleep feature that can be set to fade your music down over a set period of time – handy for drifting off at the end of the evening. The finishing touch is a solidly built remote control that provides access to all these features, as well as controlling music playback from either dock unit.

The iP88 is a little pricey, admittedly, but the beefy sound and impressive range of features ensure that it will earn its keep.



THE SKINNY...

Likes Dual docks, powerful sound, good remote control, versatile radio and alarm features

Dislikes Expensive, higher frequencies distort towards maximum volume

Rating: ★★★★★

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On Time Micro

Company JBL **URL** www.jbl.com **Price** £149



Ultra sonic The On Time Micro makes a big sound

JBL makes a number of alarm-clock docks, including the eye-catching arch-shaped On Time 5. As the name suggests, the new On Time Micro is a more compact version, although its broad circular base will still hog a reasonable amount of room on your bedside cabinet.

The Micro is quite pricey, too, and while it doesn't have the range of features offered by the similarly expensive Sony Dream Machine ICF-CL75iP, it does provide perhaps the best overall audio quality at this end of the market. The speakers produce very clear and detailed high frequencies, not to mention solid bass.

The unit delivers plenty of volume too – 10 per cent of maximum is easily enough to wake you up in the morning, and we could only turn it up to about 60 per cent before we started to worry about waking the neighbours too. The absence of distortion as you crank up the volume attests to some high-quality engineering.

JBL has included an AM/FM radio with 10 station presets. The snooze button on the front could be a bit bigger perhaps, but at least the remote control has its own snooze button.

The alarm-clock features are fairly straightforward. A nice touch is that the Micro allows you to set no fewer than seven alarms, so you could have a different one for every day of the week if you were so minded.

Of course, most of us aren't going to need such a powerfully loud – and expensive – unit just to wake us up, but the On Time Micro could well justify the outlay if you put it to general use it as a radio and speaker system.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Impressive audio quality with plenty of raw volume, seven alarms, remote control

Dislikes Very expensive, and at this price DAB would be nice too

Rating: ★★★★★

T4 Radiopod

Company Orbitsound **URL** www.orbitsound.com **Price** £149.99

It comes in at the same price as the Sony Dream Machine ICF-CL75iP and JBL's On Time Micro, but visually Orbitsound's T4 Radiopod is a completely different kettle of fish.

In contrast to the Dream Machine's eye-catching screen display, the Radiopod has a rather old-fashioned text-only LCD display on the front, set within a sedate lump of black plastic.

However, radio enthusiasts will find this the ideal alarm clock, as it's the only model in this group to include both FM and DAB radio. It also has built-in WiFi to let you access internet radio stations. That's a great idea, but we found connecting it to our WiFi network a little fiddly, as there's no remote control and you have to use the rather cramped little buttons on the top panel to cycle through a long menu on the LCD screen. Thankfully, you only have to do this once. Having done it, you can set up 10 favourite preset stations for each of the FM, DAB and internet modes.

The unit produces bright, clear sound, particularly on higher frequencies. The lightweight casing doesn't handle songs with a lot of bass very well, but that shouldn't be a problem unless you enjoy waking to heavy-duty drum-and-bass.

You can fine-tune the sound using a series of equaliser presets, but it's a shame there's no remote control, as we found the cramped control panel just isn't ideal for navigating through music menus.

When we slipped our iPhone 4 into the Radiopod's dock, we got a message warning us that the Radiopod 'is not optimized for the iPhone'. To be fair, we encountered no problems using an iPhone 4 during our tests of the Radiopod, but it would be nice if Orbitsound updated it for the latest iPhones, especially given the Radiopod's high price.

THE SKINNY...

Likes Includes FM, DAB and Wifi for Internet radio, lots of presets for favourite stations

Dislikes Very expensive, no remote control, bass could be better

Rating: ★★★★★



DAB hand The Radiopod can play DAB and FM stations, as well as internet radio via WiFi

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TRYOUT: Alarm clock docks





iPad & iPhone User says...

If you're just looking for a basic alarm-clock dock to replace your old clock radio then Gear4's AlarmDock Reveal should fit the bill nicely. It's small enough to fit on most bedside tables, produces good sound and lets you set two alarms. There's no remote control and you can only save five station presets, but it'll charge your iPod or iPhone and wake you up – not bad for about £50.

The App Station from iLuv is also quite basic, although its compact design means you can easily bring it with you when you're travelling.

If you're looking for something with quite a few extra features, it's hard to beat Sony's Dream Machine ICF-CL75iP, with its 7in video screen, 30 station presets and built-in microphone for you to record your own wake-up messages. However, many people will consider some of these features – not to mention the £150 price tag – to be a bit over the top for a box that wakes them up in the morning.

The same could be said of the equally expensive JBL On Time Micro and the Orbitsound T4 Radiopad. The On Time Micro is a fairly conventional alarm-clock dock, distinguished by its impressive sound quality and raw volume, while the Radiopod's DAB radio and WiFi connectivity for listening to internet stations will appeal to hardcore radio enthusiasts.

> "The On Time Micro is a fairly conventional alarm-clock dock, distinguished by its impressive sound quality and raw volume"

That leaves the iHome iP88. It sits right in the middle of the price spectrum at about £120, and includes a remote control, eight station presets, equalizer controls, and a handy dual dock for charging two devices. While some of its rivals have features that will attract a niche audience, the iP88 is an all-round device with the right combination of price, quality and features to make it our Editor's Choice alarm-clock dock.

How they shape up

Product	AlarmDock Reveal	App Station	Dream Machine (STAR BUY)	iP88 (STAR BUY)	On Time Micro	T4 Radiopod
Price	£49.99	£70	£149	£119.95	£149	£149
Manufacturer	Gear4	iLuv	Sony	iHome Audio	JBL	Orbitsound
URL	www.gear4.com	www.i-luv.com	www.sony.co.uk	ihomeintl.com	www.jbl.com	www.orbitsound.com
Dimensions (H x W x D)	100 x 130 x 130mm	170 x 170 x 100mm	148 x 205 x 119mm	89 x 269 x 178mm	116 x 203 x 203mm	143 x 109 x 109mm
Radio	FM	None	AM/FM	FM	AM/FM	FM/DAB/internet
Alarms	2	Set on iPod/iPhone	2	3	7	2
Station Presets	5	N/A	10 AM, 20 FM	8	10	10 FM, 10 DAB, 10 internet
Remote Control	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N
Snooze Button	Y	N/A	Y	Y	Y	Y
Star rating:	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★

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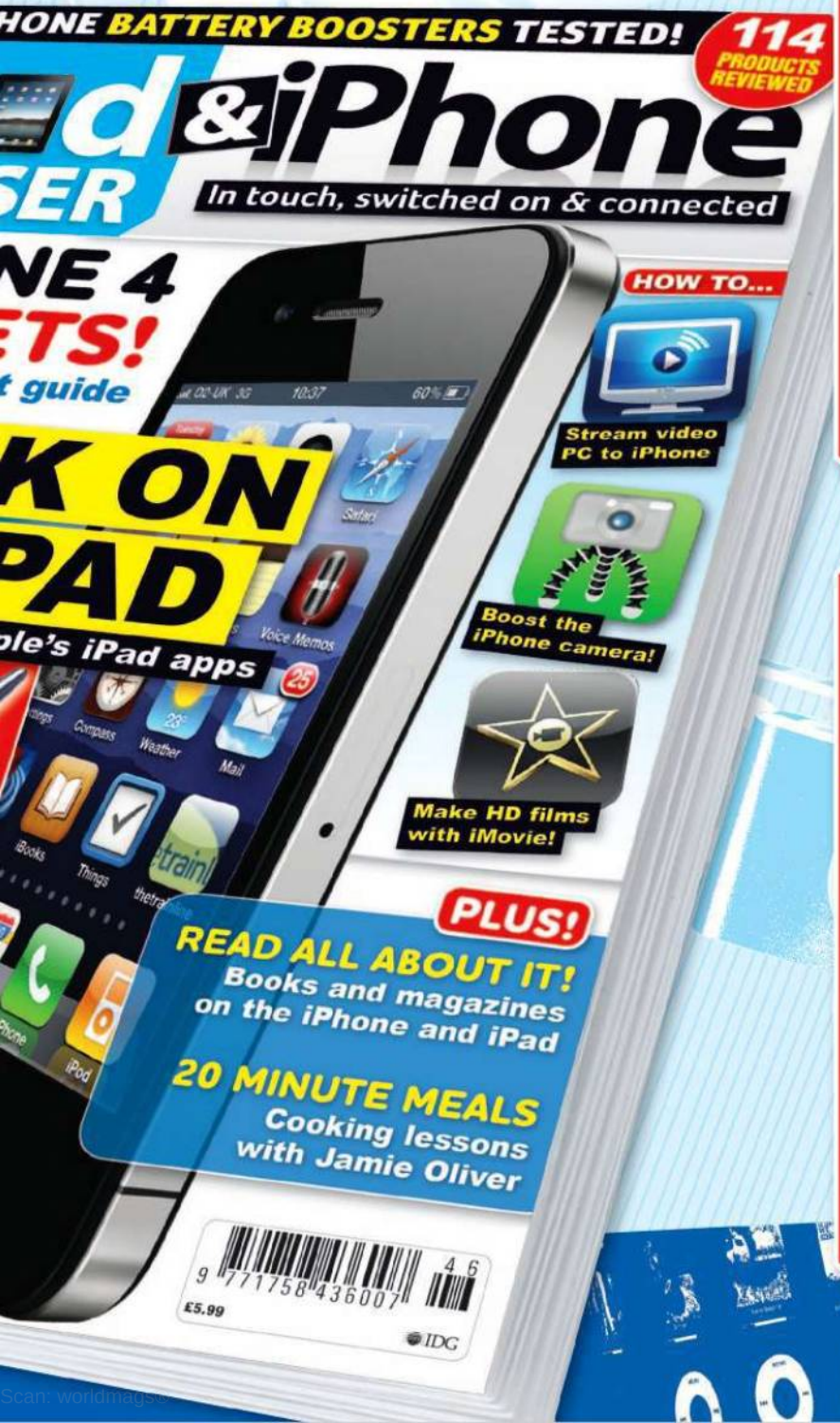
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FREE GIFT ONE...

The Rough Guide to the iPad

By Peter Buckley



The Rough Guide to the iPad shows you everything you need to know about the iPad, from choosing the right model and customising your settings, to discovering the exciting world of apps. It has jargon-free explanations on what you need to get started and how to get the most from the iPad's amazing range of features.

WORTH £7.99

FREE GIFT TWO...

USB 2.0 Charge & Sync Cable

From Scosche



Charge and sync your iPod or iPhone on the move with Scosche's USB 2.0 cable. Attach it to your key ring for portability and simply plug into a convenient USB drive.
With this handy device you will always be powered up and connected, and you'll never have to scrabble around looking for that elusive iPod syncing cable!

WORTH £19.99

Scan: worldmags

Keep track of your data with Bento for iPad

How to use iPad Bento – the database tool for the rest of us

By Jonny Evans

Bento is a database tool from FileMaker – the company is behind the business database tool called (unimaginatively) FileMaker. Bento is the easier-to-use, easier-on-the-eye database program for consumers to keep track of anything from credit cards to sports teams. It offers 25 ready-to-use and editable templates, including handy tools for event planning, to do lists, recipes and small business and client management.

Bento syncs wirelessly with Bento 3 for Mac. While this expands what Bento can do, the standalone iPad app remains powerful enough to help you keep things together without using your desktop computer at all. Bento 3 costs £29.95 for a single licence. Bento for iPad is a steal at £2.99 – if you just want it for your iPad you'll save a packet.

VITAL INFO

- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Time required:** 10 minutes

What you need

- Bento app, £2.99 from iTunes App Store
- Bento app on your Mac optional; £29.95

Step-by-step guide

Create a database in Bento



1 Create record

To begin creating a new database on the iPad, touch the 'Libraries', then tap the '+' sign. The next screen will show you template options.



2 What you want

Flick through the available templates to select the most appropriate to your needs – in this case we're going to use 'Home Inventory'.



3 Create library

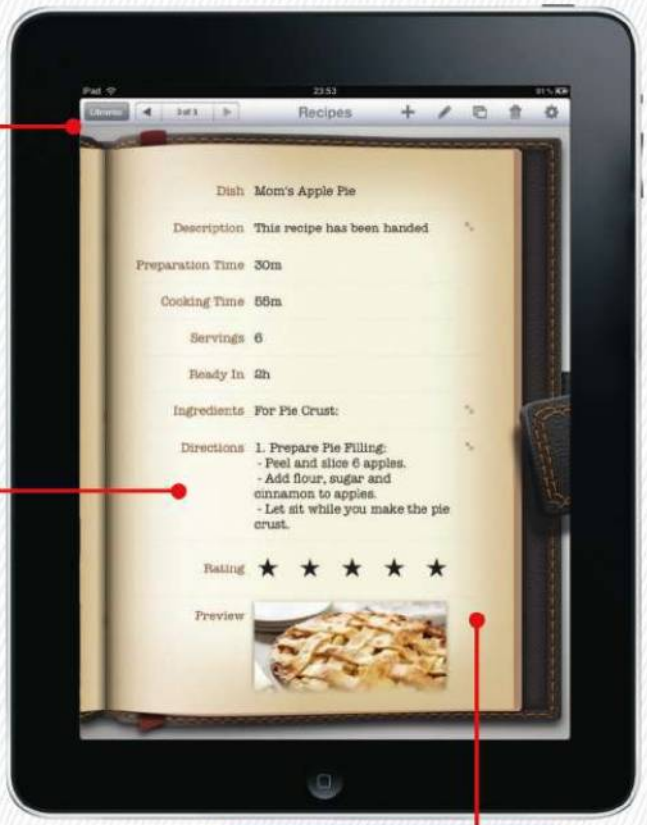
With 'Home Inventory' at the centre of your Cover Flow-style display, simply touch the 'Create Library' button to get started.

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Bento: your guided tour

Data central
Tapping the 'Libraries' button brings up a list of your various databases. We've selected a Recipes database here.

Field trip
All Bento's fields are customisable, and you can put whatever you like in each field. The onscreen keyboard appears when you want to edit text.

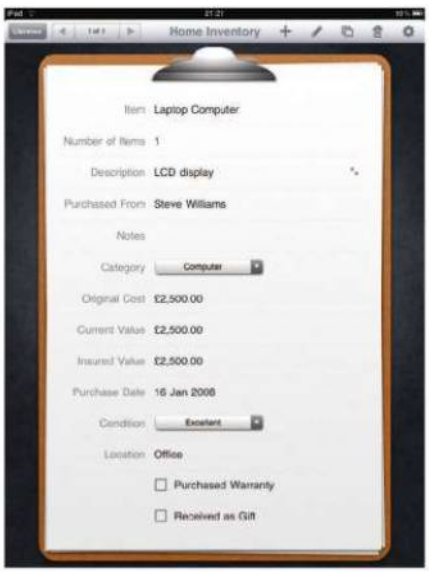


Filofax style
The app comes with three different visual 'skins' for your databases. As well as the leather-bound book look, you can also pick a clipboard or businesslike black look.

Desktop syncing

EXPERT TIP

Desktop Bento 3 users can launch Bento on the Mac, touch the 'Sync' icon on the iPhone, then 'Sync Now' to sync the library. This ensures that your databases are always up to date whether you're on your Mac or your iPad. Hit the cog icon (top-left) of any Bento screen to set up a sync. Your computer will need to be on the same WiFi network as your iPad.



4 Bento guides

You'll see the database is pre-populated with one example. Touch the record to explore the available fields and view a typical Bento entry.



5 Personal info

To change an entry in any record's field just touch the relevant item. The on-screen keyboard will pop up and you can enter text.



6 Adding fields

To add another field just tap 'Fields', then '+' to access the 'New Field' chooser, choose a field and tap 'Create'.

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KNOW-HOW

Control your Mac or PC from anywhere

LogMeIn Ignition puts your entire computer in the palm of your hand

By Andy Penfold

LogMeIn Ignition gives you remote access to your computer on your iPad via the internet. To start, go to secure.logmein.com and download the LogMeIn Free software onto the computer you want to control.

As the name implies, this software is free, and you can download it onto one or more Macs and PCs that you want to control remotely.

Once you've registered your computer on the company's web page, it'll show you the details of your LogMeIn account and the computers that you've set up for remote access over the internet. You can use this web page to manage your account, adjust settings, and add other computers that you also want to control. Then it's a question of downloading and installing LogMeIn Ignition on your iPad the same way as any other app.

VITAL INFO

- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Intermediate
- **Time required:** 20 minutes

What you need

- Internet connection
- Mac or PC with LogMeIn Free installed (must be powered on and awake)
- LogMeIn Ignition iPad app, £17.99 from iTunes App Store

Step-by-step guide

Using LogMeIn Ignition



1 Logging in

First install LogMeIn on your computer and set up an account. Then launch LogMeIn on your iPad and enter your details.



2 Helping hand

Ignition displays the PCs and Macs you've added to your LogMeIn account. Tap the computer name and enter the login details.



3 The Word

And here's the desktop of our MacBook on the screen of our iPad. We've opened iTunes and can browse our music via the iPad screen.

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Your computer screen on your iPad...



Mini me

This message appears on your computer's desktop and on your iPad so you know that the connection has been made. And if you're using your iPad to show someone how to do something on a remote computer, they'll know their computer isn't haunted.

Remote controls

Your main LogMeIn Ignition functions are covered here, from summoning the keyboard to logging in. As usual, the cog icon brings up settings, while the 'x' disconnects from the computer you're remote controlling.

Mouse modes

EXPERT TIP

There are two ways of using the cursor in LogMeIn Ignition. 'Mouse moves' mode treats the iPad screen like the trackpad on a laptop. In 'Screen moves' mode, the mouse cursor remains permanently fixed in the centre of the screen and the screen moves behind it. To select which one you want to use, tap the cog icon, then tap 'Scroll Mode'.





4 Zoom in

Now we're editing a document in Pages (the desktop version). Activate the on-screen keyboard to start typing.



5 Keyboard commands

Press the icon at the top of the screen in the middle to bring up your function keys, so on a Mac you can press F12 for Exposé.



6 Change settings

Click the cog icon in the Ignition dock to go to Settings. This window includes the option to change the resolution of your Mac's screen.

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KNOW-HOW

Save web content for offline reading

Instapaper offers a simple way to bookmark internet content

By Andy Penfold

How do you access online content on your iPad when you can't get online? Even if you have the 3G version of the iPad, there are still quite a few places, from London Underground stations to rural dales, where you won't be able to get a signal.

Enter Instapaper, which lets you save articles when you're online for reading later when you're offline.

The app puts a button in Safari's bookmarks bar that you click whenever you want to save a page for later. This creates a downloadable text-only version of the article under your account name on the developer's website. Later, when offline, you fire up the Instapaper app to read it. You have to do some jiggery pokery setting up this clever bookmark, but this tutorial walks you through the process.

VITAL INFO

- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Time required:** 10 minutes

What you need

- Internet connection for web browsing
- Instapaper for iPad (£2.99 from iTunes App Store)

Step-by-step guide

Set up and use Instapaper



1 Open up

Fire up Instapaper on your iPad and hit the 'Log in to Instapaper' button. You'll then be prompted to log in or sign up.



2 Sign in

Registration is easy, and can be done on the Safari browser on your iPad or computer. You just have to think of a username and enter it.



3 On the desktop

You need to install the 'Read Later' bookmark in your iPad's browser. Go to Instapaper's settings and select 'Install Read Later in Safari'.

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Instapaper ins and outs



Installed
Here's the Instapaper Read Later bookmark installed in the desktop Safari browser.



The reader
Using Instapaper to read articles is a dream. By default, the article is saved as text only, but if you want pictures, too, tap the cog icon and then 'Download graphics version'.

Desktop saving
If you want to save articles while you're surfing the web on your computer, go to Instapaper.com. Here you'll be able to save the Instapaper bookmark into your bookmarks, and then sync the bookmarks to your iPad. Any new Instapaper saves will be copied to the iPad app.



4 Create a bookmark

This will launch Safari, and you'll be walked through how to create the special bookmark. First, create a bookmark for the page you're on.



5 Secret code

Next, you to edit your new bookmark's setup by going into the bookmark's URL and copying and pasting some code into it.



6 Save for later

Now, when you browse in Safari, you can save an article for later by going to your bookmarks and selecting the 'Read Later' bookmark.

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KNOW-HOW

Get finger painting on your iPad with Brushes

The iPad has many creative uses – Brushes lets you finger paint

By Andy Penfold

Brushes is a great application if you want to use your iPad to paint. It's so good that Jorge Colombo drew a cover for *The New Yorker* magazine with it on his iPhone while queuing outside Madame Tussaud's. Of course, the graphic designers among you might not be able to get by purely with work created on mobile devices, but you get the point – this is one clever app, and the iPad version takes advantage of that great big screen.

Brushes lets you get on with the simple skill everyone has with finger painting, gives you a blank canvas, and lets you get going. Here we show you the basics of Brushes – including how to import a photo, which offers infinite creative opportunities as our expert drawings attest. We'll also explore the colour and layer tools in the app.

VITAL INFO

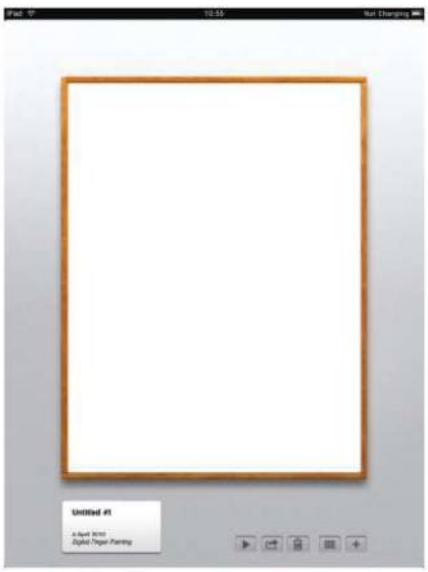
- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Time required:** 20 minutes

What you need

- Some pictures synced to your iPad
- Brushes app, £2.99 from iTunes App Store

Step-by-step guide

Learn to paint with Brushes



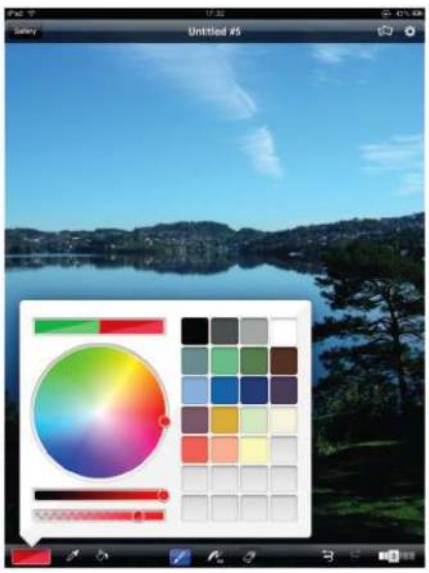
1 Starting your artwork

You can start from a blank canvas. For a colour canvas, tap the colour selector (bottom-right), pick a colour, then tap the paint bucket tool.



2 Import a picture

Alternatively, you can start with a picture and edit it. Tap the pictures icon in the top right, and select a shot from your photo albums.

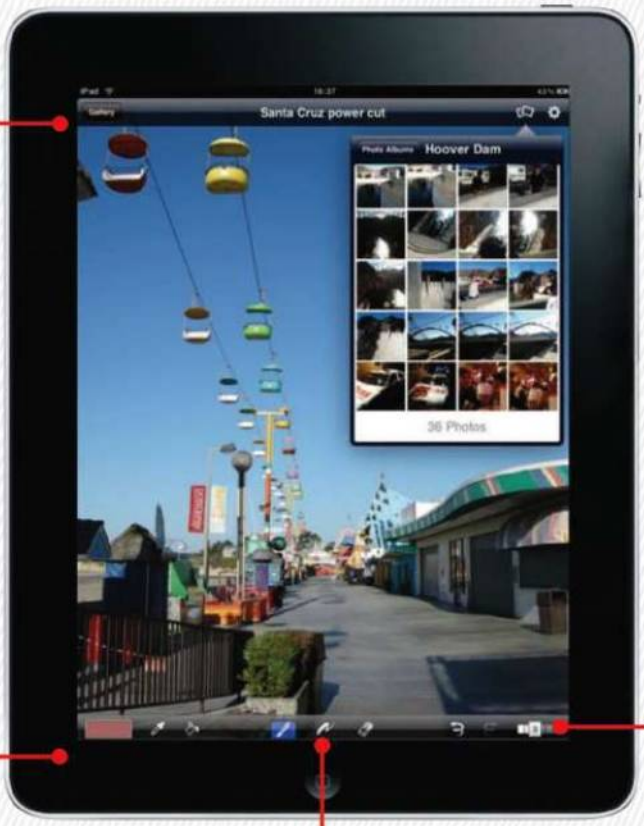


3 Paint job

Choose your brush colour here. To copy a colour from your image, select the eye-dropper tool and drag the ring to the colour you want.

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Brushing up on Brushes



Viewing the gallery
Tap the 'Gallery' button to see all your creations in a cool swipeable gallery interface.

Colour options
Choose your brush colour here. The pippette icon next to it lets you copy a colour from your main photo, while the bucket icon lets you fill a large area with colour.

Edit brush
Tap this button to edit the properties of your paint brush.

Layer control
These buttons let you manage your layers. Tap here to bring up layers, edit their order and opacity.

Using opacity

EXPERT TIP

In the colour picker, it's possible to pick a colour and give it opacity. This means that your brush strokes will be see-through, to a degree that you set using the opacity slider – the bottom slider on the left of the colour picker.





4 Select a brush

The Brushes tool lets you vary the size of the brush with a slider. You can change the brush type using the three dots.



5 Layer it on

We've painted this scary lake-monster, and now want to add another picture. Tap the layers button (bottom-right), and tap '+'.



6 It's an art rage

Our work is done. Tap 'Gallery' (top-left), then the arrow button to see the options you have for saving and sending your art.

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KNOW-HOW

Keep on top of the tasks in your life with Things

This simple to-do list manager for the iPad is deceptively powerful

By Wayne Jarvis

There is a multitude of task management apps on the App Store, but none are as simple and effective as Things. The idea is that you jot down tasks as and when you think of them or when they come up, and then sort them out in a way that helps you meet your office targets as well as remember your wedding anniversary. You can sort tasks into categories, create Projects, and even sync the app with a desktop version so you can keep on top of your tasks.

The iPad version is the perfect companion to the £45 desktop app, but it'll also serve you well if you use it by itself. It offers all the task-creation and task-management options of the desktop app in an intuitive touchscreen interface, and the two apps will sync tasks with each other too, so you'll be sure of what you have to get done whether you're on the go or in the office.

VITAL INFO

- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Time required:** 20 minutes

What you need

- Things app, £11.99 from App Store
- Things app on your Mac optional; £44.95

Step-by-step guide

How Things works



1 Open up

When you fire up the app you'll see this empty home screen. This is where you can manage all your to-dos. Hit the '+' to add your first to do.



2 Stuff to do

Fill in the details of your task and tap the corresponding fields to add due dates and notes. By default, all to-dos go in your 'Inbox'.



3 Tag it and bag it

Hit 'Tags' to assign tasks to a category – you can also add categories. To create a custom tag, hit 'New tag' at the bottom of the list.

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Things to do...

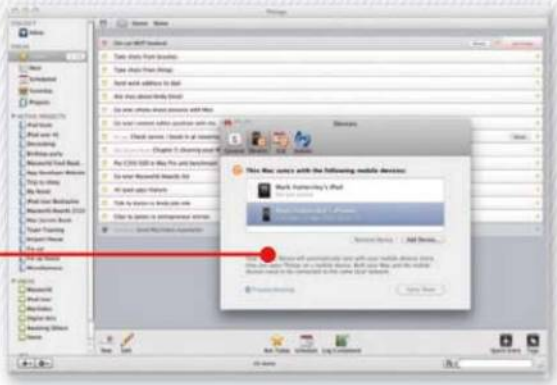


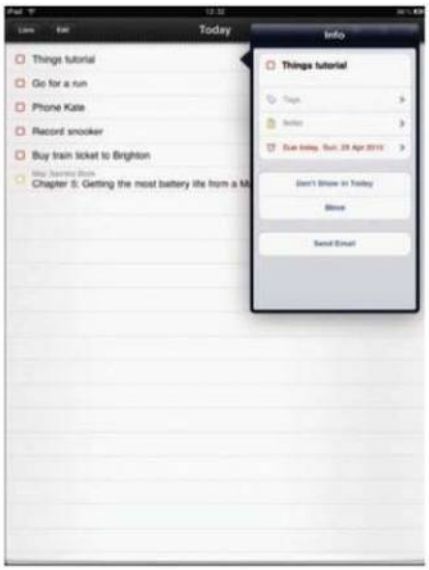
Today's tasks
Tasks in 'Today' are tasks with a due date of today, or tasks you've specified need starting today. The 'Next' list displays the next things you need to get to after today, while the 'Scheduled' button lets you view all the tasks that you've recorded so far. Use the 'Someday' folder for ideas you might want to come back to when things are less hectic.

Plus points
A '+' button is on pretty much every Things screen, so you can quickly jot down a to do before you forget it.

Log and load
When you tick a task off, it goes in the logbook as a record of your achievements.

Desktop download
Things also syncs with a £45 desktop app. This gives you a bit more functionality, such as delegating tasks to contacts, and adding 'teammates' for tasks.





4 The day today

Sort your tasks into the folders in the 'Lists' heading. All tasks with a due date of 'Today' automatically go into the 'Today' folder.



5 Priority calling

The arrow icon at the top of a list's screen lets you move tasks between various folders. This is useful for prioritising items in your inbox.



6 Planning projects

You can also create 'Projects', which lets you sort your tasks into areas. You can then move tasks from the inbox to a Project.

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KNOW-HOW

Manage your tweets with TweetDeck

Harness the power of Twitter with TweetDeck on your iPad

By Andy Penfold

Twitter addicts swear by TweetDeck on their computers, and now this Twitter aggregator has an iPad counterpart. The application gives you an interface that brings all your accounts together. The idea is that you set up various 'columns' to display your Twitter activity – for example you'll have a column for your friends' tweets, tweets that mention you by name, and your direct messages. It'll also bring Facebook into proceedings, letting you replicate your tweets on your Facebook status.

The app works entirely independently on the iPad, but if you use TweetDeck on the desktop as well it might be worth registering with TweetDeck and getting an account (on top of your Twitter accounts). Doing that will let you sync your columns across your mobile and desktop TweetDeck apps.

VITAL INFO

- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Time required:** 10 minutes

What you need

- Internet connection
- TweetDeck app, free from iTunes App Store
- TweetDeck on your desktop free from www.tweetdeck.com

Step-by-step guide

How to use the TweetDeck



1 Blank canvas

When you first launch TweetDeck you'll see a welcome message. Hit 'Twitter' in the middle of the screen to add an account.



2 Get logged in

Enter your details and tap 'Add' in the top-right. Once you're set up, you can add more accounts later.



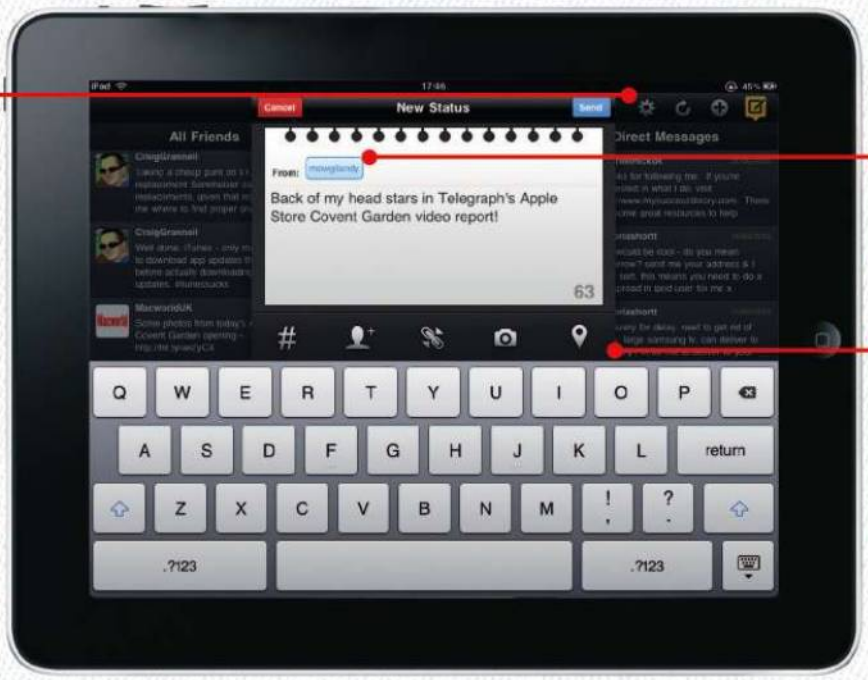
3 Play columns

Then hit the '+' at the top-right. Use the arrows to select accounts and column types, then hit 'Add Column'.

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Tweeting on your iPad

Toolbar options
This toolbar gives you all your important functions. The figure silhouette lets you search Twitter, the cog takes you to settings, the circular arrow refreshes, and the '+' sign adds a column. Finally, the yellow button lets you post a tweet, as we're doing here.



Speak out
At any time in TweetDeck, you can hit the yellow icon in the top-right to post a tweet. If you have multiple Twitter accounts you can touch the name here to toggle between them.

Twitter tools
These buttons give you various Twitter options. You can bring up and choose from hashtags and '@' replies, and add pictures and locations.

Posting links

EXPERT TIP

Twitter is a great way to share links with your friends, but URLs can take up too many of your 140 tweet characters. Bit.ly is a URL shortening site, and if you have an account you can get TweetDeck to shorten URLs automatically. Sign up at http://bit.ly, then sign into your account in TweetDeck by tapping the cog icon and hitting 'Connect to Bit.ly'.





4 Tweet central

You'll see the list of tweets as per your selections. Add more columns using the '+' button.



5 Flick it

Now you've got a few columns set up, you can flick between them. Tap one to zoom in on it. Tap the 'Columns' icon to choose another.



6 View updates

The circular arrow icon in the top-right of the screen updates your columns. Tap a column heading to set how often the column updates.

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KNOW-HOW

Read dynamic digital comics on your iPad

Comics as you've never seen them before – this app is a revelation

By Mark Hattersley

With its generously sized colour screen, the iPad is perfect for the comics universe. There are plenty of apps to help you find your way around that realm, and among the coolest is the appropriately named Comics. It's a nifty comics reader, and one that doesn't treat a comic as page after page of snazzy but inert art.

If you double-tap on a page you go to Comics' 'Guided View' mode. Now the app shows you one panel at a time, letting each one occupy the whole screen while also zooming in to focus on speech balloons.

Best of all, Comics even has its own iTunes-like store, allowing you to browse and buy from a vast library of online material, with stacks of worthwhile freebies available from cover to cover, too.

VITAL INFO

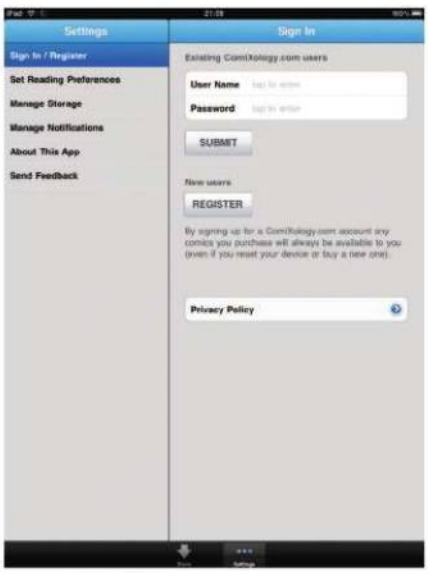
- **Device:** iPad
- **Difficulty:** Beginner
- **Time required:** 10 minutes

What you need

- Internet connection for buying comics
- Comics app, free from iTunes App Store

Step-by-step guide

Reading on Comics



1 Log in

The first thing you need to do is create an account with ComiXology.com and log in. This will enable you to download new comics.



2 Search for a comic

You can search by 'Featured', 'Free', 'Top 25' or 'Browse' (which leads to options to search by Title, Creator, Publisher, and so on).



3 Pick a comic

We're going to go for this *Clash Of The Titans* prequel. We found it in the 'Free' section. Click the button that says 'Free' to download it.

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Lets get comical

Done
When you've finished reading a comic click the 'Close' button to return to the main menu.

To the left
Clicking on the left side of the screen moves back to the previous panel.

Central point
Clicking the central pane opens the options overlay.



To the right
Clicking on the right hand side of the screen animates to the next panel.

Adjust settings

EXPERT TIP

Comics sports so many settings – from letterboxing and animated transitions – that it'll make you feel more like you're watching a partially animated movie than reading a comic. These are pretty cool but you can switch them off for a more regular experience. Click Settings Set Reading Preferences to see what can be changed.





4 Read away

Once downloaded the 'Free' button turns to 'Read'. Press it and the comic starts. Click the right-hand side to move through the panels.



5 Double tap

The iPad is perfect for looking at the lush artwork of a decent comic – double tap a frame to have it take up the whole screen.



6 When you're done

When you flick right from the last frame or page, you'll see a series of options – including the facility to look up local comic shops.

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HIT LIST

We at iPad & iPhone User make it our business to bring you the finest gadgets the world has to offer. Here in our buyers' guide you'll find our picks of the best stuff, starting with Apple's devices themselves...



iPad

Apple says it's 'magical' – we say the iPad is desireable as heck



www.apple.com/uk/ipad

Likes Amazing screen, zippy interface, 3G model doesn't require a contract, great for games, email and calendar apps are highlights, iBooks app great for reading

Dislikes 3G network can be spotty, you'll still need a laptop for work and for syncing data and music to the device

Price WiFi: 16GB £429, 32GB £499, 64GB £599
WiFi + 3G: 16GB £529, 32GB £599, 64GB £699

Rating: ★★★★★

Putting out the iPad in 2010 was a brave move by Apple. It's a product in a category all of its own, introduced into a dismal economic climate. But Apple's gamble paid off – the iPad was the company's most successful launch in its history, and the iPad itself has been lauded as the technology product of the year.

You only have to have a go on an iPad to see why it's been so popular. It takes the usability gold that is the iPhone's multi-touch display and makes it more luxurious. While the iPhone is designed for information and communication on the go, the iPad feels like something you could comfortably use in the home as well as out and about.

Quite aside from ergonomic 'look and feel' factors, though, the iPad is an incredibly powerful device. The A4 chip that Apple has designed especially for the purpose is incredibly snappy – in most tests the iPad is the fastest of all Apple's mobile devices. The software update that's due in Autumn should bring multitasking to the iPad, which will make it a much better device for working on documents.

It's not perfect of course – the onscreen keyboard is a compromise however you look at it, and it should never be mistaken as a substitute for a proper computer. But as a games, web, communications, and media device, the iPad is exactly what the gadget consumer ordered.

iPhone 4

Will the iPhone 4 shake off the curse of the Death Grip?



www.apple.com/uk/iphone

Pros High-resolution Retina display, 5mp camera with LED flash, HD video recording, vastly improved battery life over 3G and 3GS, optimised for iOS 4 software

Dislikes Antenna attenuation issues are a design flaw, still pricey to get hold of one, Bumpers are in short supply

Price from £0-£599, depending on your chosen price plan

Rating: 4GB ★★★★★

The iPhone 4 comes so close to being the iPhone you can't knock. Sure, no gadget is ever perfect, but the iPhone 4 saw most of the major gripes about older versions addressed – the iPhone 4 can multitask (kind of) and has a camera that's really rather good instead of woefully bad. It'll never convert everyone, but by version 4 you'd expect it to be pretty accomplished, and it is.

But there's a caveat. Gradually the fawning over the best iPhone ever became gnashing of teeth over the so-called 'Death Grip'.

The iPhone 4's design is such that all the antennas are on the outside or the unit. If you cover up the gap between the antennas on the left-hand side with your hand, you seriously affect your signal.

Apple has admitted the issue, and after assuring us that it's a problem for all smartphones, and being hounded by the media for weeks, the company relented and offered a free 'Bumper' case to all iPhone 4 owners. A case fixes the issue, but rather spoils the very cool look of the device.

All this controversy is a shame, because Apple did so much right on the iPhone 4. The Retina display, which packs in four times as many pixels as older models, is astonishingly good-looking, while the A4 chip means that it is incredibly fast. Battery life, too, is a vast improvement on older iPhones, and the HD video camera rivals the Flip. We're still inclined to plump for the iPhone 4 over any other phone, despite the hoo-ha about the antennas.

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iPhone 3GS

The older iPhone offers a cheaper alternative



www.apple.com/uk/iphone

Likes Fantastic multi-touch interface, superb screen, App Store and application support, browse the web at 3G speeds, GPS chip

Dislikes Still more expensive than other smartphones

Price from £0-£419, depending on your chosen price plan

3GS Rating: ★★★★★

Apple has a two-pronged attack with the iPhone – the iPhone 3GS is still available with 8GB of memory, giving customers the option of a cheaper entry into the iPhone world, and also the conundrum of whether the iPhone 4's antenna problem really is a deal-breaker.

The iPhone 3GS' body is identical to the previous 3G's – and a world away from the iPhone 4's design. It's a tad thicker, and has a plastic curved back. If the iPhone 4 is luxurious in the hand, the iPhone 3GS feels a lot more mass-market, and we suspect that was the idea.

The 'S' in the 3GS stands for 'speed' according to Apple, and in terms of snappiness it's a really good buy. The iPhone 4 is faster, but not to the extent that this older version will drive you crazy.

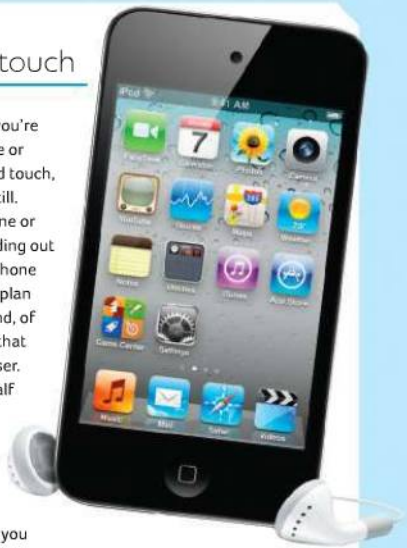
In terms of functionality, you won't lose out too much if you plump for this older version. The 3GS has a compass, so augmented reality apps will work. However the iPhone 4 can sense acceleration, so is as sensitive for gaming as a Wii remote.

The camera on the 3GS was a weakness in the market even when that unit came out in summer 2009. The 3.2mp sensor is below even some average consumer phones, and the lack of flash means pictures are weak in low-light. The camera is one area where you may wish you bought the iPhone 4 after all.

The other area that might disappoint compared to the iPhone 4 is the battery. The 3GS' battery runs flat in a day, regardless of how much you use it. The iPhone 4 has a larger battery that lasts much longer.

iPod touch

Camera and video calling make for a fine iPod touch



www.apple.com/uk/ipodtouch

Likes Super speedy like the iPhone 4, excellent games machine, FaceTime video calling, fantastic high-res Retina display, solid music and video player

Dislikes Lacks the compass and GPS functionality of the iPhone, speaker is pretty weak, camera features are fine for FaceTime but otherwise poor

Price £189 (8GB), £249 (32GB), £329 (64GB)

Rating: ★★★★★

The iPod touch is wildly popular for good reason. It's an extremely versatile device – media player; pocket gaming machine; productivity tool; internet communication device; and, with this latest update, pocket camcorder, still camera, handheld recorder, and FaceTime video phone.

While its cameras fail to produce results as good as the iPhone 4, they do make FaceTime possible, which allows us to more easily forgive their less-than-pristine images and movies. Using the iPod touch for FaceTime, combined with its existing ability to use Skype, brings it closer to the iPhone without the expensive contract.

Despite the cameras' weaknesses, this is a very good iPod touch. If you have a third-generation iPod touch and lack an iPhone 4, this iPod's FaceTime capabilities may tempt you to upgrade. If you're unhappy with the performance or capacity of an even earlier iPod touch, this iPod is more compelling still.

And if you're without iPhone or iPod touch and have been holding out for a device this close to the iPhone – without the incumbent data plan and two-year commitment (and, of course, the phone features) – that realization has never been closer. Plus the iPod touch is about half as thick as the iPhone 4, so if you share Apple's obsession with thin, the iPod touch is impressive indeed.

It's hard to imagine what more Apple could do to tempt you with this version, and it's as good a time as any to snap one up.

iPod nano

www.apple.com/uk/ipodnano

Rating: 4GB ★★★★★



Yet another drastic makeover for the iPod nano sees it embrace the inevitable – a touchscreen. The iPod nano for Christmas 2010 foregoes most of the fun features from the last iteration – the movie camera, most notably – and instead gives you a very small touchscreen to play with, and a shuffle-style clip design.

In practise, it could do with a slightly larger screen. It all works fine, but it can be a bit fiddly. Annoyingly, the new nano doesn't come with Apple's remote-control enabled headphones either.

It's still a stellar music player though, and the tiny size and impressive disk space means its perfect for the gym or holidays.

Likes Cool new touchscreen, incredibly small and handy

Dislikes Loses several features from the old model

iPod classic

www.apple.com/uk/ipodclassic

Rating: ★★★★★



Lacking the wide-screen wonder and connectivity of the iPod touch and the iPod nano's array of new tricks, the iPod classic doesn't feel new or innovative. Rather, it's a tested and reliable way to carry around your media.

It's brilliant if you want to take a large collection of your media with you. Compared to the iPod touch and 5G iPod nano, though, it's not very sexy.

The latest version is 160GB, which represents excellent value for money. It also offers superb battery life – it'll play your tunes for almost two days before the battery dies. And despite the new iPod's touchscreen wizardry, the click-wheel is still a genuine design classic.

Likes Loads of storage, great battery, Genius support

Dislikes Not as versatile as the touch or nano

iPod shuffle

www.apple.com/uk/shuffle

Rating: ★★★★★



We were never big fans of the third-generation, button-free iPod shuffle. Its control system gave us nightmares and its form factor was perfect fodder for an anti-Apple advertising campaign or parody.

It seems Apple has also fallen out of love with the buttonless iPod shuffle too, as the new shuffle is a new and improved version of the previous iteration – a clip-on gadget with an easy-to-use onboard control system. It's almost perfectly square, knocking off about a third of the last shuffle that looked like this (released two years ago).

It's only £39 for 2GB too, so it reinstates the shuffle as the budget-friendly iPod. It also boasts a much improved battery life, and it's clear that the new shuffle erases the bad memories of the last iteration.

Likes Smart looks, much improved controls

Dislikes No way to lock controls

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THREE OF THE BEST: Wireless headphones

BackBeat 903

IT'S A WRAP

Company Altec Lansing
URL www.alteclansing.com
Price £69.99

★★★★★

Altec Lansing's BackBeat 903 Bluetooth headset offers good audio quality at a decent price. They'll work with your iPhone, iPod touch, and any other Bluetooth device. A button on the right earpiece lets you turn on a Bass Boost for a bassy kick.



HALO

Company Jabra
URL www.jabra.co.uk
Price £99

ANGELIC EARS

★★★★★

The HALO from Jabra is a smartly designed headset that you can fold flat when you're not using it. Its slim, black plastic headband wraps comfortably around your head, and there's a touch-sensitive volume control on the right earpiece. The audio quality is rich and warm – but the loose design leaks a lot of sound.



PX 210 BT

Company Sennheiser
URL www.sennheiser.co.uk
Price £149.99

★★★★★

WIRELESS WONDER

Sennheiser resisted Bluetooth technology for years, but now the company has embraced it, with these great wireless headphones. They sound great – the best we've heard from a Bluetooth set.



Headphones

Image S4i

Company Klipsch URL www.klipsch.co.uk Price £89.99

★★★★★

iPod STAR BUY



The Klipsch S4i are an in-ear set of headphones that offer exceptional sound quality, if at a premium price point. You also get full iPod or iPhone control thanks to an in-line remote control, which doubles up as a button for answering and hanging up calls on the iPhone. A cracking set of earphones.

Likes Built-in controls, great sound quality
Dislikes Not quite as good sound as other earphones at this price

Shure SE115m+

Company Shure URL www.shure.co.uk Price £129.99

★★★★★



The SE115m+ has plenty of features – packing in a mic for phone calls and a remote control button for controlling music playback. The set won't let you down in terms of those cool features, but sound quality is decent rather than exceptional, so if that's your priority you may be better off with a set with fewer features and better sound.

Likes Good solid build, decent sound
Dislikes Sound quality is a bit weak considering the price

Bowers & Wilkins P5

Company Bowers & Wilkins URL bowers-wilkins.co.uk Price £249

★★★★★

iPod STAR BUY



Possibly the finest earphones we've ever heard. The P5's are made from the very best materials. New Zealand sheep's leather earpieces are ludicrously comfortable, while the audio is stunning. Bowers & Wilkins has created an audio system it calls TrueSound, and it produces an incredibly rich, natural sound.

Likes Astonishing sound quality, unrivalled comfort, superb design
Dislikes The price is the only downside

SE420

Company Shure URL www.shure.co.uk Price £249

★★★★★



Offering two drivers rather than the SE530's three, the SE420s are cheaper, and still give you amazing sound quality. They're not as powerful – if you're spending £249 might you just as well spend another £80 and get the best you can get? We'll leave that with you, but you'd be a real perfectionist if you were disappointed with these.

Likes Astonishingly good sound quality
Dislikes Not at the top of Shure's range, but they're still very pricey

IDR600

Company Scosche URL www.scosche.com Price £69.99

★★★★★



Scosche's headphones are neat little numbers, named for their increased dynamic range. Coming with a range of fittings so you can find the ones that perfectly block out the world, they're pretty comfortable, and light enough to use at the gym. The 11mm IDR drivers deliver sharp sound, although bass could be fuller.

Likes Various ear fittings, magnetic cable management, strong sound
Dislikes Could be bassier

Sennheiser CX 550 Style II

Company Sennheiser URL www.sennheiser.co.uk Price £80

★★★★★

iPod STAR BUY



Sennheiser's new noise-isolating headphones are a stylish and sturdy set. They're designed with a small arm tilted forward that helps the cable stay in place and the headphones comfortably in the ear. Sound-wise, the CX 550 Style IIs are a sound choice – balanced and detailed. Pricey, but worth it for the quality and comfort.

Likes Rich in detail, comfortable, stylish, good build
Dislikes Expensive

Apple In-Ear Headphones

Company Apple URL www.apple.com/uk Price £61

★★★★★



Apple's headphones have been a bit iffy to date, but these are an improvement. Each earpiece contains two drivers – a woofer and a tweeter. Apple's buds also have a remote control built into the cord – this only works with the newest iPods. This is a good set, but there are several models that match Apple's buds for price and sound.

Likes Detailed audio, remote control and built-in microphone
Dislikes Weak bass, remote and mic only work with the latest iPods

Remix Remote

Company V-Moda URL www.v-moda.com Price £89.95

★★★★★



V-Moda tends to veer towards the glamorous side of iPhone accessories, and its new range of headphones are no exception. The Remix Remote in-ears are shiny in the extreme, but they are a little more understated than some bling-tech. Sound, though, is massive, and the build is strong enough to last longer than most headphones.

Likes Great sound, comes with four sizes of earpieces, in-line remote
Dislikes Glam look is a bit much for some tastes

JBL Reference 430

Company JBL URL www.jblroxy.com Price £59.95

★★★★★



Designed by ladies' sportswear brand Roxy, this JBL set of headphones sure makes a bold statement. If you love the bright colours then this is actually a decent set of earphones – sound is rich and punchy with strong bass. However, if it's an over-ear set you're looking for there are cheaper, less garish options out there.

Likes Comfortable, colourful design, decent audio quality
Dislikes Sound leakage, don't fold up, don't block out external sound

Audéo PFE 122

Company Phonak URL www.audeoworld.com Price £129

★★★★★



Phonak is best known for making stylish hearing aids, but the award-winning company has now brought its expertise to the headphone market. At £130, they're a serious investment too, but they deliver in terms of audio quality. They also come with sets of audio filters that you can fit to the headphones to create a certain type of sound.

Likes Excellent sound quality, can be tuned to your tastes
Dislikes Ear guides can be fiddly, only a single size of earpiece included

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Docks

Dexim P-Flip

Company Dexim **URL** www.dexim.net **Price** £59.99

★★★★★



At once a handy dock and a travel battery, the Dexim P-Flip is a successful all-in-one iPhone gadget. It folds flat for easy storage, and then flips open when you need it. You can also use the P-Flip to sync your iPhone with your computer – making it an ideal accessory to throw in your laptop bag. The battery charges via USB.

Likes Smart design, good power supply, works with touch too
Dislikes iPhone in a case won't fit

Universal Dock

Company Apple **URL** www.apple.com/uk **Price** £36

★★★★★



Apple used to ship a dock with the iPod, but now it's an optional extra. This is still quite a basic model – if you want all the leads, a remote control and a power connector, it'll set you back a few more quid. It's a premium price for an ordinary experience, but it's well built – as you'd expect from the Apple stable.

Likes Excellent build quality and styling
Dislikes Expensive if you add the cables, basic functionality without

ProControl AV

Company Gear4 **URL** www.gear4.com **Price** £49.99

★★★★★



The ProControl claims to offer everything you need to integrate your iPod into your home entertainment setup. In the box you'll find all the leads you'll need to attach it to your telly, hi-fi and computer. You'll still have to move it around to use it with all three devices though. The dock itself is well designed and unobtrusive.

Likes A complete connection kit, cool styling
Dislikes Flimsy power plugs, needs to sit near your various appliances

Logic3 Pro-Dock

Company Logic3 **URL** www.logic3.com **Price** £49.99

★★★★★



The Pro-Dock boasts an eye-catching design with its cylindrical shape and glowing logo on the front. It has component and composite video connectors on the back, as well as stereo audio. There's also a USB interface for when you want to use it to sync your iPod with your computer. However, only audio cables are supplied, no video wires.

Likes Smart design, includes composite and component video output
Dislikes No video cables or dock adaptors

DS-A3

Company Onkyo **URL** www.onkyo.co.uk **Price** £100

★★★★★



Onkyo's DS-A3 is primarily designed for use with the company's own range of specialist amps and music systems. However, you don't have to be an Onkyo addict to appreciate its high-quality design and useful features. It's easily connected to your TV and hi-fi, and crucially it includes all the cables you'd need, too.

Likes Attractive design, displays iPod music/video menus on your TV
Dislikes Expensive, on-screen display is basic, no USB connector

iPhone cases

Incipio Feather

Company Incipio **URL** www.incipiotech.com **Price** £15.95

★★★★★



The Incipio Feather is one of those cases that doesn't appear to have a lot to it. It's essentially a plastic shell that covers the back and sides of your iPhone. However, the Feather succeeds where others fail thanks to its simple design and lightness. It's less than 1mm thick, and adds next to nothing to the weight of your iPhone.

Likes Snug fit, very light and thin, range of colours
Dislikes Not much to it

iFrogz Luxe

Company iFrogz **URL** www.ifrogz.com **Price** £19.99

★★★★★



The iFrogz Luxe is a good bet – it gives your iPhone a smart finish without adding too much bulk. The bottom half is black, while the top comes in a range of seven colours, each with a swish metallic finish. The two halves slot together and fix with a button on the bottom that slides under a catch on the top.

Likes Looks cool, plenty of colours to choose from
Dislikes A bit clumsy to put together

Scosche KickBACK

Company Scosche **URL** www.scosche.com **Price** £26.99

★★★★★



Scosche's KickBACK iPhone case offers good protection for your iPhone, with a handy extra – a clip-out stand on the back that lets you prop up your phone for movie watching. When not in use, the stand sits flush against the case. Your iPhone is held in place by rubber casing, while the back is made of shatterproof polycarbonate.

Likes Novel idea, neat stand hidden well when not in use
Dislikes Nothing major

XGear Stylus

Company XGear **URL** www.bagcrazy.co.uk **Price** £24.99

★★★★★



XGear's Stylus is something of a refreshing change, offering a simple plastic cover that doesn't get in the way of the gadget itself. It's very slim, and is ridged to give it extra strength. There are cutaways for the camera and controls. It's minimal, and at £25 you may well wonder where your money went. A lower price would be fairer.

Likes Keeps the iPhone safe without adding bulk to the device
Dislikes Has a half-finished look, costs way too much

Tech21 Slip

Company Tech21 **URL** www.tech21.uk.com **Price** £24.99

★★★★★



Tech21 has launched a range of cases for phones and laptops that have a secret weapon known as d3o. In its raw form, d3o is a gloopy material that firms up on impact, so it's perfect for protective products. The Slip is an understated leather pouch for the iPhone that has d3o panels on the front and back, offering great protection.

Likes Good protective qualities, understated and stylish looks
Dislikes Open top, controls inaccessible

EDITOR'S PICKS:

iPod cases

Wallaby Wallet

Company Proporta
URL www.proporta.com
Price £24.95

★★★★★

MONEY SPINNER

Proporta has incorporated a case for the iPod nano into a regular wallet, so you can keep your music and your moolah in the same place. Its iPod credentials are decent enough, but it's as a wallet that the Wallaby falls down. There's no fastenable bit for your change, and with the iPod in place it's too rigid.



Bolt Armband

Company Contour Design
URL www.contourcase.com
Price £24.95

★★★★★

SLEEVE NOTES

Gym-lovers have a variety of options for taking their nano on the road, and the Bolt Armband is a washable, durable option. Made from a combination of two of our favourite underpants materials – Lycra and Spandex – the bolt has a clear plastic screen for easy access to the nano's controls.



tapSTICK

Company Scosche
URL www.scosche.com
Price £24.99

★★★★★

ON THE BUTTON

The iPod shuffle's minimalism can be problematic when it comes to controlling the iPod and using your own headphones. Scosche has solved this problem by incorporating playback control buttons into a svelte shuffle case. It costs nearly half the price of a basic shuffle, but it does make the iPod easier to use.



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THREE OF THE BEST: Travel speakers

iHome iP49

Company iHome
URL www.ihomeaudio.com
Price £149.95

★★★★★

FOLD AWAY!

Featuring the same Bongiovi sound enhancement system as the massive iHome iP1, the iP49 folds up to the size of a paperback book, and is therefore perfect for your holidays. However, the compact design belies the expansive sound, and it goes loud for a little fella too.



Orbitsound T3

Company Orbitsound
URL www.orbitsound.co.uk
Price £79

★★★★★

'SOUND AURA'

The Orbitsound T3 offers stonking sound considering its tiny dimensions – it's about the same size as an iPod classic. It features two speakers on the side, which combine to create a 'sound aura' around your head when you wear the speakers round your neck. Works well as a normal portable travel speaker, too.



Griffin AirCurve

Company Griffin
URL www.griffintechnology.com
Price £17.99

★★★★★

SMART IDEA

The AirCurve is an acoustic speaker for the iPhone. A small, transparent plastic block with a sealed cradle for the iPhone, the AirCurve contains a funnel design that amplifies the sound from the iPhone's built-in speaker without batteries or wires. A fantastic innovation, and perfect for low-cost, no-hassle travelling. It's also a total bargain at just £18.



Speakers

On Time 200P

Company JBL **URL** www.jbl.com **Price** £199.99

★★★★★



The On Time 200P is a decent, if not standout, iPod alarm clock. Offering 10 radio presets, snooze functions and multiple alarms is handy rather than groundbreaking. It's got two 45mm speakers with a 2x 6W amp, though, and sound is pretty good for a small bedside unit. Build quality is a bit bendy, but it's sturdy enough.

Likes Good sound quality, smart design, plenty of features
Dislikes It's pretty basic in operation

Valve80

Company Logic3 **URL** www.logic3.com **Price** £293

★★★★★



This strikingly designed iPod amp is a hybrid valve and transistor system. It uses the warm fuzzy sound of valve amplification as a pre-amp, before the sound signal goes through the main amp. It creates a lovely sound. It also has the valves externally mounted, so there are three glowing glass tubes on the outside.

Likes Lovely sound quality, great looks, sturdy build
Dislikes No visual representation of settings such as volume and tone

QDOS SoundFrame

Company QDOS **URL** www.qdossound.com **Price** £79.99

★★★★★



The rotating speaker system is by no means a new idea, but the QDOS SoundFrame succeeds thanks to its excellent sound. The clunky rotating stand is the main weakness, but the SoundFrame's travel credentials are immaculate – it has a large internal rechargable battery and comes with loads of accessories.

Likes Good sound considering size, travel accessories included
Dislikes Clunky rotating stand

Zeppelin

Company Bowers & Wilkins **URL** www.bowers-wilkins.com **Price** £399

★★★★★



The Zeppelin is quite simply the coolest iPod speaker available. Its curvy, space-age design is a real draw, but it's backed up by incredible build quality and stonking sound. The Zeppelin offers plenty of connectivity options, too, so you can make it the centrepiece of your home, and spend your evenings gawping at its beauty.

Likes Awesome sound, cracking design, strong build quality
Dislikes Bass isn't as big as with larger speakers, costs a fortune

MM-1

Company Bowers & Wilkins **URL** www.bowers-wilkins.com **Price** £379

★★★★★



B&W's MM-1 desktop speakers may look unassuming, but these modestly sized blocks – just 17cm tall – are packed with advanced drivers and electronics that put most speakers to shame. The set is beautifully designed, with no visible joins between components, and while the price is high, the MM-1 speakers are exceptional.

Likes Amazing sound, great design, smart build and connectivity
Dislikes You get what you pay for but they are pricey

SSB-1

Company Crystal Audio **URL** www.crystalaudiovideo.com **Price** £200

★★★★★



An ordinary-looking soundbar system, the SSB-1 actually boasts a virtual surroundsound feature. 'Virtual SurroundSound' oversells it somewhat – the effect boosts the volume and gives it a wider sound, but doesn't sound like surround. Aside from that though, the SSB-1 sounds great and goes very loud – it's a very good system with plenty of inputs.

Likes Good sound quality, loud, multiple inputs
Dislikes Fiddly remote control, virtual surroundsound doesn't deliver

GLA-55

Company Harman Kardon **URL** www.harmankardon.com **Price** £749

★★★★★



Some speakers are designed to blend into their surroundings – but not the GLA-55. The cut diamond looks of the speakers are crying for attention, and the design is such that all the electronics are hidden in the base plates. At £750, you'd expect amazing sound, and that's exactly what you get.

Likes Very striking looks, fantastic sound quality
Dislikes Expensive, can sound a bit clinical, looks won't suit everyone

PURE Sensia

Company PURE **URL** www.pure.com **Price** £249.99

★★★★★



This DAB radio and wireless internet radio streaming hub is a class act. It looks great, and the clear audio and large touchscreen display give it an edge over every other audio streaming device we've tested. The touchscreen interface also offers a number of mini-apps for posting to Twitter and Facebook and for checking the weather forecast.

Likes Touchscreen interface, cool applications, great sound quality
Dislikes Can be a pain for scrolling through long lists on screen

iHome iP1

Company iHome **URL** www.ihomeintl.com **Price** £299

★★★★★



The iHome iP1 has an imposing look, with its smokey glass front panel and exposed speakers. Perfect for a bachelor pad, this beast is heavy and pumps out some pretty cracking sounds. The built-in audio processing makes the most of your digital music – it's basically a dynamic equaliser that constantly tweaks the audio for the best output.

Likes Lush sound, built like a tank, looks good in a swanky flat
Dislikes Unusual looks may be an acquired taste

Logitech S315i

Company Logitech **URL** www.logitech.com **Price** £99.99

★★★★★



Logitech's S315i is a streamlined and attractive portable speaker system. The smoothly curved unit is about the size of a paperback book, and about 1.5in thick. It's light and compact enough to slip in a bag when you're travelling. Sound is good, but there's no remote control – a bit of an oversight considering the whopping price.

Likes Compact, good sound quality, rechargeable battery
Dislikes Expensive, no remote control

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Car adaptors

iTrip Auto FM

Company Griffin **URL** www.griffintechnology.com **Price** £49.95

★★★★★



Your regular no-nonsense iPod car player, the iTrip Auto FM is a good option, incorporating a charger, FM transmitter, and dock connector. It's finished in a smart black and silver plastic. It's a bit hissy, but the SmartScan feature means you can easily find an FM channel to use.

Likes Well made, responsive buttons, LCD screen makes tuning easy
Dislikes Prone to background hiss

LiquidAUX

Company Kensington **URL** http://uk.kensington.com **Price** £53.79

★★★★★

iPod STAR BUY



The Kensington LiquidAUX offers up a refreshing variation on the in-car iPod device, which at first appears to be pretty standard FM transmitter fare. On closer inspection, though, you'll find a wireless remote control that attaches to your steering wheel, which is most handy. Works with all the iPods and iPhones too.

Likes Bluetooth wireless control pad, works as iPhone hands-free kit
Dislikes Not much use if you don't have a 3.5mm socket in your car

Gear4 CarDock FM Follow Me

Company Gear4 **URL** www.gear4.com **Price** £49.99

★★★★★



The CarDock FM Follow Me boasts a new 'ClearSearch' feature, which enlists the use of a compatible RDS car radio to work. ClearSearch allows you to find a new, clear FM signal at the touch of a button, which is great for adjusting your signal when your music starts to crackle. It also charges your iPod via a car cigarette lighter.

Likes Compact design, ClearSearch works well, good value
Dislikes No cables so the iPod has to sit near your ciggie lighter

iO PLAY

Company iO PLAY **URL** www.my-io.com **Price** £199

★★★★★

iPod STAR BUY



The iO PLAY is the finest in-car iPod setup we've seen so far. It lets you stream music to your car stereo via Bluetooth. You get a Bluetooth dongle for your iPod, while the rest of the system is installed behind the dashboard. You get a voucher to cover the cost of getting it wired in. It also acts as a hands-free kit for iPhone users.

Likes Fantastic audio quality, built-in hands-free for mobile phones
Dislikes Volume control has a delay before it actually takes effect

TuneCast Auto IV

Company Belkin **URL** www.belkin.com/uk **Price** £49.95

★★★★★



Belkin's TuneCast is a stalwart of the iPod car scene, and version four sees some good design tweaks. It has two programmable preset buttons, and there's also a one-push station locator called 'ClearScan'. It might not find you in congested areas though – if FM airwaves are busy, you'll be hard pushed to find a clear channel.

Likes Good styling, programmable buttons, backlit LCD display
Dislikes Interference in busy areas, retuning can be difficult

Batteries and chargers

powermonkey-explorer

Company powertraveller **URL** www.powermonkey-explorer.com **Price** £65

★★★★★



The powermonkey-explorer stores up power for topping up your gadgets on the road – but the set's main draw is its clamshell solar panel that lets you charge up your iPod and phone using the power of the sun. If running out of juice when all you wanted to do was zone out with your iPod drives you to despair, get yourself one of these.

Likes Great for travellers, environmentally friendly
Dislikes Lots of bits to carry around and fiddle with

Mophie Juice Pack

Company Mophie UK **URL** www.juicepack.co.uk **Price** £68.49

★★★★★



The battery is the iPhone's main weakness. The Mophie Juice Pack is an external battery that can double the life of the iPhone 3G. And while most battery add-ons dangle precariously from the iPhone dock connector, the Juice Pack surrounds the iPhone like a case, keeping it safe as well as boosting the battery life.

Likes Fits snugly around the iPhone 3G, doubles battery life
Dislikes Adds bulk to the iPhone's shape

MiLi Power Skin

Company Power Skin **URL** www.powerskin.co.uk **Price** £49.99

★★★★★



The Power Skin is an iPhone case that incorporates an external battery. It's a great option for anyone who is frustrated with having to charge up their iPhone all the time. You first run out the iPhone's battery, then flick a switch when it's depleted to use the Power Skin's battery. It should give you a good 24-hour stint without charging.

Likes Double battery life in standard iPhone use
Dislikes Bulky and heavy, doesn't switch automatically

HyperMac Mini

Company HyperMac **URL** www.hypermac.com **Price** $79.95

★★★★★

iPod STAR BUY



HyperMac's Mini may look like a brightly coloured hip flask, but it's actually an external battery pack. Battery packs are a necessary if slightly dull part of gadget life, but the HyperMac Mini makes the concept fun with its vibrant looks. Its USB socket means you can charge hundreds of different devices with it.

Likes Fantastic design, USB makes it versatile, good power output
Dislikes Single indicator light makes it hard to decipher at first

PowerAngel

Company D Vision **URL** www.iphonemili.com **Price** £34.99

★★★★★



The PowerAngel is essentially a battery kickstand for your iPhone. It has an battery built in which you can charge via USB and then take out with you to provide your iPhone with extra juice. The kickstand on the back works in landscape mode, so you can watch movies without holding it, and without worrying that it'll kill your battery.

Likes Unusual battery/stand combo, power indicator
Dislikes No mains power supply, feels flimsy

THREE OF THE BEST: Innovations

Spotify

Company Spotify
URL www.spotify.com
Price Free

★★★★★

MUSIC MASTER

Spotify is a whole new way to listen to music. It's an online service with a massive catalogue of tunes to listen to legally. The free version is funded by radio-style audio ads and visual pop-up ads, but there's a £9.99 per month 'Premium' version that lets you use the catalogue ad-free. Life-changing software.



Nike + iPod Sports Kit

Company Apple
URL www.apple.com/uk
Price £19

★★★★★

iPOD FITNESS

Let's face it, there's an awful lot of tat released for the iPod. Every new product promises to revolutionise the way you use your music player, but few deliver. The Nike + iPod Sports Kit is one of the few that actually breaks new ground. If you're a runner, this can revolutionise the way you train.



Moshi Moshi 02

Company Native Union
URL www.nativeunion.com
Price £50

★★★★★

I'M ON THE PHONE

When we first heard about the Moshi Moshi product line we thought it was a bit batty. Now we've tried the Moshi Moshi 02, though, we're converted. It has all the wiring of a hands-free set – a microphone and earpiece – but is presented as a traditional telephone. The result is a more relaxed, chatty way of using your mobile.



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THREE OF THE BEST:

Racing games

Crash Bandicoot: Nitro Kart 3D

Company Vivendi
URL www.vivendi.com
Price £3.49

★★★★★

OLD CLASSIC

Crash Bandicoot is the game that proved the iPhone is a genuine gaming platform – the graphics are fantastic, offering a colourful 3D racing environment and cute characters, and the gameplay is fast and furious and fun. Still an App Store highlight.



DrawRace

Company RedLynx Ltd
URL www.drawrace.com
Price £1.79

★★★★★

RACE TRACK

In DrawRace, up to three players battle it out by drawing routes for cars before the race begins. You then watch events unfold, determined by the speed and direction of your tracings. The solo game is hard, but playing this unconventional racer with friends is fun.



Racer

Company Tatem Games
URL www.tatemgames.com
Price 59p

★★★★★

TRAFFIC JAMS

Racer is a beautifully designed, addictive game that will rattle your nerves worse than rush-hour traffic. It's set on one straight road, and you simply have to swipe left and right to change lanes and avoid the cars ahead of you. You can also speed up and slow down by swiping back and forward, and you get more points the faster you go.



Games

Rolando

Company ngmoco **URL** www.ngmoco.com **Price** £3.49

★★★★★



A classic side-scrolling platform game that takes advantage of the iPhone's accelerometer to give controls a twist. Your job is to rescue little characters called Rolandos that roll and jump to your commands. If ever there was an action game that played to the iPhone and iPod touch's strengths as games machines, this is it.

Likes Good graphics and sound effects, great use of iPhone's controls
Dislikes Royal Spikey Commandos are tricky to control

Sway

Company Illusion Labs **URL** www.illusionlabs.com **Price** £2.99

★★★★★



Sway is a maddeningly hard but cute platform game. Take control of Lizzie the lizard – using an unusual control method – as she swings through the levels of the game. The left and right sides of the screen control Lizzie's left and right hands – tapping either side causes Lizzie to grab the wall. Thus, you are able to swing her across the screen.

Likes Excellent replay value, challenging, novel controls
Dislikes Difficulty may deter some casual gamers

Boggle

Company Electronic Arts **URL** www.eamobile.com **Price** £1.79

★★★★★



EA has relied a bit too much on the Boggle brand name in this release. It plays fine, but in the real world Boggle is a communal game, best played and bragged about with mates. Sad then that the iPhone version offers no multiplayer mode, aside from the tame option to email the board you've just played to a friend.

Likes Good solo gameplay, good graphics and controls
Dislikes No multiplayer game is a poor show

Zen Bound

Company Chillingo **URL** www.chillingo.com **Price** £2.99

★★★★★



Zen Bound is an exciting title in that it simply wouldn't work on any other platform. It's a puzzle game in which you have to wrap rope round a wooden shape. You use the iPhone's accelerometer and touch screen to cover the shape in rope. Once you've covered 70 per cent of the shape, you're on to the next level. Engrossing.

Likes Innovative controls, challenging, great visuals and audio
Dislikes Slow pace may not appeal to gaming junkies

Madden NFL 10

Company Electronic Arts **URL** www.eamobile.com **Price** £5.99

★★★★★



Madden NFL 10 gets the feel and spirit of the Madden franchise spot on – fans will enjoy the simple control scheme, addictive gameplay, and true-to-life teams. The promised multiplayer abilities will only make this game better over time. Aside from some spotty AI strategies, EA has done Madden proud.

Likes Easily playable, fun and addictive, all the NFL logos and teams
Dislikes Opposition offense is predictable, annoying commentary

Frogger

Company Konami **URL** www.konami.co.uk **Price** £1.19

★★★★★



Frogger is an old favourite in the gaming world, so we were pleased to see it get an iPhone port. Thankfully, it's turned out well. There are three methods of control, but only one is really worth bothering with – we recommend you use the 'sliding' method and leave the others well alone. A good mix of classic gaming and iPhone controls.

Likes True to the original game's roots, cool cartoon graphics
Dislikes The tilting controls are awful

Modern Combat: Sandstorm

Company Gameloft **URL** www.gameloft.co.uk **Price** £5.99

★★★★★



With Modern Combat: Sandstorm, the first-person shooter genre on the iPhone takes a massive step forward, then trips over its shoelaces. Graphics, controls, and combat gameplay are all top-notch, but it sadly also suffers from sync issues, bugs, terrible dialogue and a rushed plot. It's still the best of its kind on the platform, though.

Likes Fantastic control scheme, great visuals
Dislikes Dreadful voice acting, infrequent check-points

Blades of Fury

Company Gameloft **URL** www.gameloft.com **Price** £3.99

★★★★★



Dedicated followers of fighting games will recognise the debt Blades of Fury owes to some console classics, but it's still a top fighting title. The multiplayer function is perhaps the game's biggest selling point – WiFi and Bluetooth connectivity allow you to battle foes wirelessly. Intuitive controls and great graphics, too.

Likes The first decent multiplayer fighting game, great graphics
Dislikes Controls can be clunky, voice acting and plot is woeful

Space Invaders Infinity Gene

Company TAITO **URL** www.tap.taito.com/en **Price** £2.99

★★★★★



Within seconds of firing up this unique version of Space Invaders and blowing away a few lines of encroaching aliens, it starts evolving – eventually resembling the bullet hell of Ikaruga. Infinity Gene is easily the iPhone/touch's best shooter – it has classic Space Invaders gameplay coupled with a uniquely changing gaming backdrop.

Likes Varied gameplay, great visuals
Dislikes Can feel a bit stop-start

Grand Theft Auto: Chinatown Wars

Company Rockstar Games **URL** www.rockstargames.com **Price** £5.99

★★★★★



Bringing the GTA world of violence, cops, drugs and guns to your Apple handheld, Chinatown Wars is a lot deeper than most App Store games. Experienced GTA hands will notice that it pretty much matches the PSP and DS versions, which makes the iPhone version's £5.99 price tag an absolute steal.

Likes Plenty of missions, good story, difficulty means longevity
Dislikes Controls can be fiddly and awkward, camera issues

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Apps

FourTrack

Company Sonoma Wire Works **URL** www.sonomawireworks.com **Price** £5.99

★★★★★



Back in the days before GarageBand, a four-track recorder was the holy grail of the unsigned band. Now you can get one on your iPhone for £6. The app allows you to construct a song one track at a time. You can set the stereo pan for each track, and FourTrack also lets you 'bounce' tracks – that is, copy multiple tracks to two free tracks.

Likes Great app for capturing a quick song idea, includes metronome
Dislikes Transferring songs to a PC is a little drawn out

CoPilot Live

Company ALK Technologies **URL** www.alk.eu.com **Price** £26.99

★★★★★



Among the cheapest sat-nav apps on the App Store, CoPilot Live is also one of the finest. For your £26.99 UK map pack (£49.99 for the whole of Europe) you get full seven-digit postcode search, as well as weather reports for your destination, and a choice of 2D and 3D map views. It also does speed camera warnings and alerts.

Likes Great price, full postcode search, handy features
Dislikes No show-stopping problems

Spotify

Company Spotify **URL** www.spotify.com **Price** Free

★★★★★



Spotify on the iPhone has a slight sting in its tail for users of the free desktop app – you have to be a Spotify Premium subscriber to use it. This costs £10 per month and gets you high-quality music streaming without ads. The app itself is good, if a little clunky, and allows you to cache playlists for listening when you're not online.

Likes Access to 3.8 million tracks, offline mode, no need to sync tunes
Dislikes Requires you to sign up to Spotify Premium

LogMeIn Ignition

Company LogMeIn **URL** https://secure.logmein.com **Price** £17.99

★★★★★



Clocking in at £17.99, LogMeIn Ignition is clearly more than your usual iPhone app. It lets you access your computer screen on your iPhone screen remotely, and it's a pretty amazing experience. Sure, you have to do an awful lot of scrolling on that little screen (imagine it on an iPad though), but it has the potential to be very handy indeed.

Likes Ability to access your home or office computer anywhere
Dislikes Requires remote computer to be turned on, no file transfers

Facebook

Company Facebook **URL** www.facebook.com **Price** Free

★★★★★



Still the social-networking standard, Facebook is a phenomenon, and now it's available for the iPhone you'll be checking your messages and updating your status every five minutes. The app lets you send and receive messages, search, request and approve friends, and even chat live over any of the iPhone's networks.

Likes Loads of functionality, clean interface, live chat works well
Dislikes Doesn't have full functionality of the desktop site

Sketchbook Mobile

Company Autodesk **URL** www.autodesk.co.uk **Price** £3.99

★★★★★



Sketchbook Mobile is a drawing app that excels in skilled hands. The various tools are easy to access, and it's a really fun app to use. It gives you 10 layers of undo, and can zoom to 2,500 per cent for fine detail work. You can also paint on layers – six layers are supported on the iPhone 3GS, or three on the 3G.

Likes Layers and undo support, export to Photoshop, easy to use
Dislikes Fiddly to change brush sizes

Things

Company Cultured Code **URL** www.culturedcode.com **Price** £5.99

★★★★★



Things is a handy task manager program that aims to help you get stuff done at work and at home. It has a desktop counterpart for the Mac, and the iPhone (and iPad) versions sync with the Mac version to keep you up to date. It has a simple way of noting down to-dos, and lets you sort them into order later. Very handy.

Likes Simple to use, desktop add-on, powerful
Dislikes Quite expensive, especially if you also get the Mac version

Twitterific

Company The Iconfactory **URL** www.twitterific.com **Price** Free

★★★★★



Twitter has taken social networking to a whole new level, and at the moment there are hundreds of apps that let you tweet on your iPhone or iPod touch. Twitterific is one of the App Store's best Twitter facilitators, as it provides integration with twitpic.com, so you can take a photo and upload automatically.

Likes Twitpic integration, simple yet powerful interface
Dislikes Single tweet view is a waste of time, no tweet filtering

TomTom

Company TomTom **URL** www.tomtom.com **Price** £59.99 (UK & Ireland)

★★★★★



TomTom is the best known name in sat-nav technology, so the iPhone version was hotly anticipated. It largely delivers, too – TomTom's IQ Route technology, which calculates the best route based on the time of day as well as all the usual factors, is included. A very solid sat-nav performer that's been updated to support multi-tasking.

Likes Updated for iOS 4, excellent maps and clear instructions
Dislikes One of the pricier sat-nav options

Photoshop.com Mobile

Company Adobe **URL** mobile.photoshop.com/iphone **Price** Free

★★★★★



Adobe's Photoshop.com Mobile app is a free, intuitive, and fun way to edit pictures. You can crop and rotate your pictures, and also edit the exposure, saturation and tint, or convert a colour shot to black and white or add filter effects. Most edits are achieved with a swipe of your finger. Some features are missing, but it's a good start.

Likes Simple interface, lots of special effects in one app
Dislikes Basic feature set, no sharpening or zoom tools yet

THREE OF THE BEST: iWork for iPad

Pages

Company Apple
URL www.apple.com/uk
Price £5.99

★★★★★

LOST FOR WORDS

Apple's word-processing app makes the easiest transition to the iPad, and after its 1.1 update it works a lot better in landscape mode. Pages works best with the keyboard dock, as the onscreen keyboard is functional but a chore to use. It'll be a lot more realistic to write on the iPad when multitasking is enabled on the iPad.



Numbers

Company Apple
URL www.apple.com/uk
Price £5.99

★★★★★

CLEAN SHEEETS

Spreadsheets are made a lot easier by Apple's Numbers application on the Mac. Where Microsoft Exel is a chore to learn, Numbers is a breeze. However, on the iPad, Numbers has a steep learning curve, thanks to a raft of contextual functions. No match for the desktop, but potentially useful nonetheless.



Keynote

Company Apple
URL www.apple.com/uk
Price £5.99

★★★★★

SLIDE AWAY

Keynote, Apple's answer to PowerPoint, is an intuitive presentation application on the Mac, but the iPad version suffers as a result of being stripped down a little too much. From a slide-design perspective, the iPad's touchscreen is perfect, and the app flashes up guides and rulers for maximum polish on your designs. However, there are problems with importing full-featured presentations from the Mac.



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MY POD

Snooping about on an interesting person's iPod...



Phill Jupitus

TV funnyman and music obsessive...

Stand-up comedian, record industry executive, musical star and team captain on *Never Mind The Buzzcocks*, Phill Jupitus spills the beans on his radio days at BBC station 6Music as well as his new book, *Good Morning Nantwich*...

By Jo Kendall

What iPod do you have?

I've got an old iPod, second gen. It was a gift about seven years ago. I went 'ooh' when I saw it – my fag packet sized one, just 10GB, was running out of space so I gave it to my daughter who broke it immediately. I started filling my 30GB up instantly. It was a joy.

What's your favourite thing about your iPod?

The interesting thing for me was when someone showed me how to make playlists on-the-go. I didn't do anything else for the next two weeks. You think, 'I'm going to the shops, I need a playlist...'

> **"I'm going to the shops, I need a playlist..."**

You're obviously a massive music fan...

I've got about 5,000 CDs. I love physically having stuff. In fact as I'm talking to you I'm thinking about how I can probably squeeze in a trip to HMV between now and my next interview. I'm a Spotify user but I don't like the idea that on the playlist I'll make I don't own half of those records. That leaves me feeling kind of empty.

Your new book, *Good Morning Nantwich, Adventures In Breakfast Radio* is about your next phase. When did radio beckon?

I became a jobbing comedian around London and my friend Mark Lamarr was doing a show on GLR. I'd go in regularly as a guest. One time he went on holiday they asked if I'd step in while he was away. This was about 1995 – and I kept on from there.

How does the book start?

It begins with me being told that 6Music is gonna be shut down. It was a real bombshell that hit many people and before we knew it, there was a campaign.
The rest is the story of a man who stopped doing a perfectly lucrative career as a stand-up in order to become a breakfast DJ and how it didn't really work out.

Why do you say that?

I realised I wasn't really a DJ, I was a man with a record collection and there's a big difference. I was far too obsessed with the music, and with bringing music to the people and having a laugh with my mate (producer Phil Wilding).

What was the best thing about BBC 6Music?

Meeting so many people I was a huge fan of. Brian Wilson, John Cale from The Velvet Underground, Elvis Costello, Weller... I loved asking questions on how they lived their lives. Also, helping to launch a new music station – 6Music was the BBC's first launch since Radio 1 in 1967 – was a quite big deal too.

So what's next in on the horizon?

I'd like to do another book. *Buzzcocks* is back in September and I'd like to do some more stand-up. I also really enjoyed playing Edna in *Hairspray* last year, because it was utterly outside of my comfort zone. I'd love to do something like that again.

How about *Les Mis*?

You know what, I wouldn't say no...



Radio times Phill's new book about his days as a breakfast radio show host is out now

Phill's 10 most-played tracks...



1. ***Radar Detector* – Darwin Deez**
The catchiest record I've heard in ages.
2. ***Happy Slap* – Ashok**
This was Florence before the machine. It became *Kiss With A Fist*, but this is better.
3. ***Broadway* – The Clash**
The last record I played on 6Music, bittersweet memories.
4. ***Duck Soup* – Baba Brooks**
I love Jamaican ska and this is infectiously joyful.
5. ***Cigarettes And Chocolate Milk* – Rufus Wainwright**
Because it's beautiful.



6. ***Pearl's Girl* – Underworld**
I loved playing long tracks on the radio and this is 11 minutes!
7. ***Life On A Chain* – Pete Yorn**
I heard this on the radio driving through Cape Cod and had to pull over to find out what it was!
8. ***Are You There?* – Dawn Penn**
A must-have track from *200% Dynamite*, part of an essential reggae series.



9. ***My Wife's Nightie* – Lord Kitchener**
It's 50s calypso, and a really funny song.
10. ***At The Indie Disco* – The Divine Comedy**
Because it namechecks the Wannadies and I'm very fond of them!

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Announcing New FileMaker Go

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Get your information on the go

View, edit and search FileMaker® Pro records on your iPhone or iPad with FileMaker Go. Check inventory, manage event registration, or update project status while on the go. Get direct access to FileMaker Pro databases hosted on FileMaker Server or FileMaker Pro or copy files locally onto FileMaker Go via File Sharing in iTunes.

Find out more about FileMaker Go:

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www.filemaker.co.uk/fmiphone

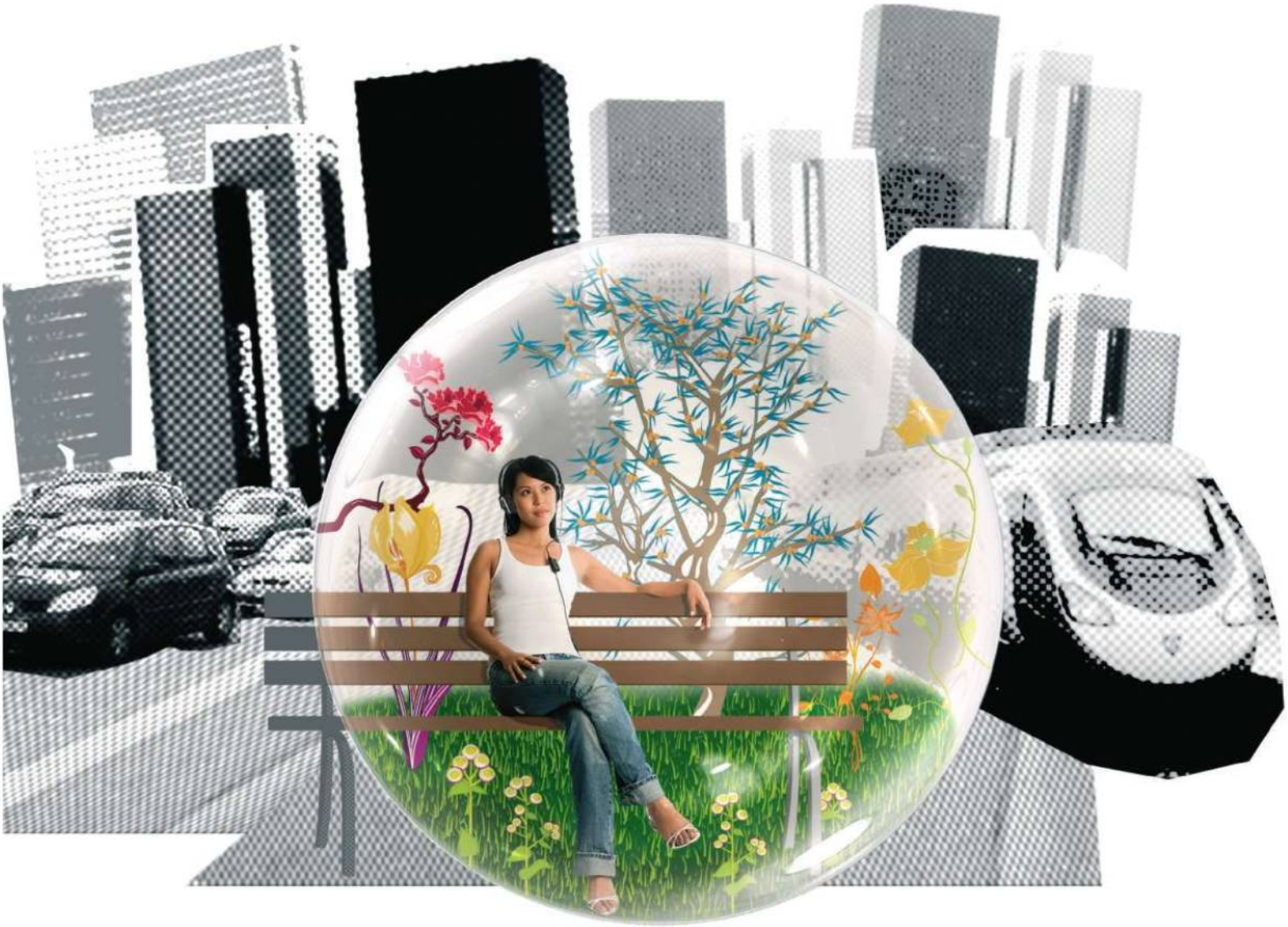
FileMaker Go for iPad

www.filemaker.co.uk/fmipad

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FileMaker

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Soothe your Soul



Wanting some peace and quiet?

Try Audio-Technica's new **ANC1 QuietPoint** headphones and allow yourself to drift into a world of your own.

Like all Audio-Technica QuietPoint headphones, they use an innovative noise cancelling technology which actively monitors and reduces the ambient sounds of your environment.

Whether on a plane, train, tube or noisy city street, the **ANC1 QuietPoint** headphones allow you to listen to crystal clear and great sounding music without interference from the usual sounds around you - perfect to soothe your soul.

Audio-Technica has a range of QuietPoint Active Noise Cancelling headphones priced from £**89.00**.

Visit www.audiotechnicashop.com for more information.

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